

Streams in the Desert 2

by L B Cowman

荒漠甘泉下

考门夫人著

July 1

My words ... will come true at their proper time. (Luke 1:20)

What the Lord has said ... will be accomplished! (Luke 1:45)

The Lord is sure to accomplish those things
A loving heart has waited long to see;
Those words will be fulfilled to which she clings,
Because her God has promised faithfully;
And, knowing Him, she ne'er can doubt His Word;
He speaks and it is done. The mighty Lord!

Bessie Porter

Matthew Henry said, "We can depend on God to fulfill His promise, even when all the roads leading to it are closed. 'For no matter how many promises God has made, they are "Yes" in Christ. And so through Him the "Amen" [so be it] is spoken by us to the glory of God' [2 Cor. 1:20]."

July 2

When you walk, your steps will not be hampered; when you run, you will not stumble. (Proverbs 4:12)

The Lord only builds a bridge of faith directly under the feet of a faithful traveler. He never builds the bridge a few steps ahead, for then it would not be one of faith. "We live by faith, not by sight" (2 Cor. 5:7).

Whether the barrier is a river, a mountain, or a gate, all a child of Jesus must do is head directly toward it. If it is a river, it will dry up as he comes near it, as long as he still forges ahead. If it is a mountain, it will be removed and "cast into the sea" (Mark 11:23 KJV), providing he approaches it with unflinching confidence.

Henry Clay Trumbull

We sit and weep in vain, while the voice of the Almighty tells us to never stop moving upward and onward. Let us advance boldly, whether it is dark and we can barely see the forest in front of us, or our road leads us through the mountain pass, where from any vantage point we can only see a few steps ahead.

God will provide guides and inns along the road, and we will discover food, clothing, and friends at every stage of our journey. And as Samuel Rutherford,

七月一日

「到了时候，这话必然应验。」(路 1:20)

「主.....所说的话，都要应验。」(路 1:45)

主必然会作成那些爱慕之心长久期望得见之事。

她所系挂的话语必得成就，

皆因是她的神信实的应许。

认识祂的她从不怀疑祂的话，

说了便成就的祂，大能的主！

比西·波特

马太·亨利说过：「我们可靠赖神来成就祂的应许，那怕所有引往之路都是闭塞不通。『神的应许，不论有多少，在基督都是是的，所以藉着祂也都是阿们的，叫神因我们得荣耀。』(林后1:20)」

七月二日

「你行走，脚步必不致狭窄。你奔跑，也不致跌倒。」(箴4:12)

主只会在信的旅者足下建筑那信的桥梁。祂永不会在前面几步来建造，否则这就不会是信的桥梁了。「因我们行事为人，是凭着信心，不是凭着眼见。」(林后5:7)

无论阻隔是河流、大山、或是闸门，所有耶稣的儿女定必要作的是向前行。这若是河流，当他走近时河流会干枯，只要他仍然勇往直前。这若是大山，它必会被移去和「投在海里」(可11:23)，只要他以不畏缩的信心向山走去。

亨利·奇里·湛布

当全能者是告诉我们不要停止前行上行时，那么我们坐下哭泣便是枉然。让我们勇往直前，那怕在黑暗中只能仅见前面的森林，那怕前路引领我们在山嶙间穿行，并且我们只能观察到前行的几步。

神必在沿路上提供引导和住宿，我们必能在旅途的每个阶段发现食物、衣着和朋友。正如伟大的

the great Scottish minister, once stated so simply, "Whatever happens, the worst will only be a weary traveler receiving a joyful and heavenly welcome home."

selected

July 3

When a farmer plows for planting, does he plow continually? (Isaiah 28:24)

Oh, if only we would always catch the vision of the abundant harvest when the great Master Farmer comes, as He often does, to plow through our very souls—uprooting and turning under that which we thought most beautiful and leaving only the bare and the unlovely before our agonizing eyes.

selected

Why should I be frightened and surprised by the plow of the Lord, which makes deep furrows in my soul? I know He is not some arbitrary or irrational farmer—His purpose is to yield a harvest.

Samuel Rutherford

July 4

The revelation awaits an appointed time....Though it linger, wait for it; it will certainly come and will not delay. (Habakkuk 2:3)

In the captivating booklet *Expectation Corner*, one of the characters, Adam Slowman, was led into the Lord's treasure-house. Among the many wonders revealed to him there was the "Delayed Blessing Office," where God stored the answers to certain prayers until it was wise to send them.

For some who pray expecting an answer, it takes a long time to learn that delays of answers are not denials. In fact, in the "Delayed Blessing Office," there are deep secrets of love and wisdom that we have never imagined! We tend to want to pick our blessings from the tree while they are still green, yet God wants us to wait until they are fully ripe.

"The Lord longs to be gracious to you....Blessed are all who wait for him!" (Isa. 30:18). The Lord watches over us in all the difficult places, and He will not allow even one trial that is too much for us. He will use His refining fire to burn away our impurities and will then gloriously come to our rescue.

selected

苏格兰传道者塞缪尔·鲁特福有一次曾简明的说：「无论发生何事，最坏的情况不过是疲倦的旅者获得一个喜乐返天家的盛大欢迎。」

选

七月三日

「那耕地为要撒种的，岂是常常耕地呢？」（赛28:24）

噢，在伟大的农夫主人来到翻犁我们灵魂时，就是祂经常作的，愿我们能得见那丰盛收割的异象。祂将我们以为最美的连根拔起和翻动，在我们痛苦的眼睛留下的只有荒芜和不可爱。

选

我何需为着我生命中带来深深犁沟主的耙耕而恐惧和惊奇？我知祂不是那些专横和无理取闹的农夫，祂的目的是要有所收成。

塞缪尔·路德福

七月四日

「因为这默示有一定的日期.....虽然迟延，还要等候，因为必然临到，不再迟延。」（哈2:3）

引人入胜小书《期望角落》的主角亚当·史路文被领到主的藏宝屋，在众多向他彰显的奇事中有一个「延迟祝福办公室」，神在那儿贮存了一些祷告，要等至送出的最佳时机之时才作回应。

祈望祷告蒙垂听的人要长时间才学会延迟垂听并非拒绝。事实上，「延迟祝福办公室」中有的是爱和智慧的极深秘密，是我们从未想过的！我们倾向在我们的祝福在树上还是青绿时便去摘取，然而神想我们等待到他们完全成熟时。

「耶和華必然等候.....凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」（赛30:18）神关顾我们所有的难处，祂永不容许过分的试炼临到我们，一个也不会。祂用炼净的火烧掉我们的杂质，必会昂然来作我们的拯救。

选

July 5

I am now going to allure her; I will lead her into the desert....There I will give her back her vineyards. (Hosea 2:14-15)

The desert is certainly a strange place to find vineyards! “I ... will make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. There she will sing as in the days of her youth.” “Achor” means “troubled,” yet the Valley of Achor is called “a door of hope.”

God knows our need for a desert experience. He knows exactly where and how to produce enduring qualities in us. The person who has been idolatrous, has been rebellious, has forgotten God, and has said with total self-will, “I will go after my lovers” (Hos. 2:5), will find her path blocked by God. “She will chase after her lovers but not catch them; she will look for them but not find them” (Hos. 2:7). And once she feels totally hopeless and abandoned, God will say, “I am now going to allure her; I will lead her into the desert and speak tenderly to her.”

What a loving God we have!

from Crumbs

We never know where God has hidden His streams. We see a large stone and have no idea that it covers the source of a spring. We see a rocky area and never imagine that it is hiding a fountain. God leads me into hard and difficult places, and it is there I realize I am where eternal streams abide.

selected

July 6

We do not know what to do, but our eyes are upon you. (2 Chronicles 20:12)

An Israelite named Uzzah lost his life because he “reached out and took hold of the ark of God” (2 Sam. 6:6). He placed his hand on it with the best of intentions—to steady it, “because the oxen stumbled” (2 Sam. 6:6)—but nevertheless, he had overstepped his bounds by touching the Lord’s work, and “therefore God struck him down” (2 Sam. 6:7). Living a life of faith often requires us to leave things alone.

If we have completely entrusted something to God, we must keep our hands off it. He can guard it better than we can, and He does not need our help. “Be still before the Lord and wait patiently for him; do

七月五日

「后来我必劝导她，领她到旷野.....我必赐她葡萄园。」（何 2:14-15）

旷野肯定找不着葡萄园！「又赐她亚割谷作为指望的门，她必在那里歌唱，与幼年的日子一样。」亚割的意思是麻烦，然而亚割谷被称为「希望之门」。

神知我们在旷野经历上的需要，祂正正知道在那里和怎样在我们里头产生坚忍的素质。拜偶像、背叛和忘记神以完全己意来说「我要随从所爱的」（何 2:5）的人必发现她的道路被神阻隔。「她必追随所爱的，却追不上，她必寻找他们，却寻不见。」（何 2:7）她一旦感到完全无望和被撇弃时，神便会说：「后来我必劝导她，领她到旷野，对她说安慰的话。」

我们有的是何等慈爱的神！

摘自《碎渣儿》

我们从不知神在那里藏起祂的甘泉。我们看见的是大石，全不知它盖在泉源上；所见的是嶙峋之地，永想不到埋藏在下面的活泉。神领我到艰苦之地，身在那里时我才明白到永恒的甘泉就在那儿。

选

七月六日

「我们也不知道怎样行，我们的眼目单仰望祢。」（代下 20:12）

以色列人乌撒失去性命是因他「伸手扶住神的约柜」（撒下 6:6）。他向约柜伸手出于好意，要托住它，「因为牛失前蹄」（撒下 6:6）。无论如何他因触动神之工而越界，「神.....因这错误击杀他」（撒下 6:7）。活出信心生活常需要我们在事情上放手。

我们若将某事完全交托神后，定须撒手。祂比我们更能保存它，祂也不需我们的帮助。「你当默然倚靠耶和华，耐性等候祂。不要因

not fret when men succeed in their ways, when they carry out their wicked schemes” (Ps. 37:7).

Things in our lives may seem to be going all wrong, but God knows our circumstances better than we do. And He will work at the perfect moment, if we will completely trust Him to work in His own way and in His own time. Often there is nothing as godly as inactivity on our part, or nothing as harmful as restless working, for God has promised to work His sovereign will.

A. B. Simpson

July 7

He made me into a polished arrow. (Isaiah 49:2)

Pebble Beach, on the California coast, has become quite famous for the beautiful pebbles found there. These stones are trapped in the arms of the merciless waves day and night. They are tossed, rolled, rubbed together, and ground against the sharp edges of the cliffs. Tourists from around the world flock there to collect the beautiful round stones. They display them in cabinets and use them to decorate their homes.

Yet a little farther up the coast, just around the point of the cliff, the quietness and peace have left the stones as they have always been—rough, unpolished, and devoid of beauty—for polish is the result of difficulties.

Since God knows what niche we are to fill, let us trust Him to shape us to it. And since He knows what work we are to do, let us trust Him to grind us so we will be properly prepared.

Nearly all of God’s jewels are crystallized tears.

July 8

They will soar on wings like eagles. (Isaiah 40:31)

We are the wingless birds, and our duties and tasks are the wings God uses to lift us up and carry us heavenward. We look at our burdens and heavy loads, and try to run from them, but if we will carry them and tie them to our hearts, they will become wings. And on them we can then rise and soar toward God.

There is no burden so heavy that when lifted cheerfully with love in our hearts will not become a

那道路通达的，和那恶谋成就的，心怀不平。」(诗37:7)

我们生命上也许凡事都出错，但神比我们更清楚知道我们的处境。祂必会在完美一刻来作工，只要我们完全信靠祂，以祂的方法和按祂的时间来作工。没有像我们方面的不动更虔诚，也没有像我们不休止地工作更损害，因为神曾应许按祂至高的旨意来作工的。

宣信

七月七日

「祂……使我成为磨亮的箭。」(赛49:2)

在加州海岸的卵石沙滩因那儿的美丽卵石而颇具盛名。这些石头日以继夜地被困在无情浪花的膀臂中，他们被颠簸，翻滚，一起冲擦，撞向崖石的尖边。来自世界各地的游客蜂拥而至，在那里收集美丽的圆形卵石，他们把卵石放在柜中展览，或放在家中作为装饰。

然而在岸上不远处，就在山崖的转角处，宁静和与世无争叫卵石永远是那样粗糙、未被磨光和缺乏美丽，因为困难带来的果效就是磨光。

既然神知我们该填补甚么处境，就让我们信靠祂模造我们。祂既知我们该作何工，就让我们信靠祂来跟磨我们来装备整齐。

几乎所有神的珠宝都是泪的结晶。

七月八日

「他们必如鹰展翅上腾。」(赛40:31)

我们都是无翼的鸟儿，职责和工作是用神给的翅膀乘起我们往天而去。我们眼望负担和重压，尝试逃离他们；若背负他们，把他们系在心中，他们便成为翅膀，乘着他们便起来飞往神那处去。

没有一个重担重至我们欢欣地用心提起时是不变成祝福的。神

blessing to us. God intends for our task to be our helpers; to refuse to bend our shoulders to carry a load is to miss a new opportunity for growth.

J. R. Miller

No matter how overwhelming, any burden God has lovingly placed with His own hands on our shoulders is a blessing.

Frederick William Faber

July 9

I have chosen thee in the furnace of affliction. (Isaiah 48:10 KJV)

Doesn't God's Word come to us like a soft rain shower, dispelling the fury of the flames? Isn't it like fireproof armor, against which the heat is powerless? Then let afflictions come, for God has chosen me. Poverty, you may walk through my door, but God is already in my house, and He has chosen me. Sickness, you may intrude into my life, but I have a cure standing ready—God has chosen me. Whatever occurs in the valley of tears, I know He has chosen me.

“Do not be afraid, for I am with you” (Gen. 26:24) is His unfailing word of promise to His chosen ones who are experiencing “the furnace of affliction.”

Charles H. Spurgeon

The burden of suffering seems to be a tombstone hung around our necks. Yet in reality it is simply the weight necessary to hold the diver down while he is searching for pearls.

Julius Richter

July 10

I called him but he did not answer. (Song of Songs 5:6)

Once the Lord has given us great faith, He has been known to test it with long delays. He has allowed His servants' voices to echo in their ears, as if their prayers were rebounding from a contemptuous sky. Believers have knocked at the heavenly gate, but it has remained immovable, as though its hinges had rusted. And like Jeremiah, they have cried, “You have covered yourself with a cloud so that no prayer can get through” (Lam. 3:44).

True saints of God have endured lengthy times of

本意叫我们的工作成为我们的帮助，那么拒绝弯下我们的肩膀来背负重担就是错过成长的新机会了。

J.R.米勒

任何重担无论如何难以忍受，只要是神亲手慈怜地放在我们肩头上的，必会是一个祝福。

弗雷德里克·威廉·费柏

七月九日

「你在苦难的炉中，我拣选你。」
(赛48:10)

神的话临到我们岂不像轻柔扑灭烈火狂怒的雨露？它岂不像火也无能为力的防火盔甲？神既选上我，就让苦痛来到吧。贫穷你可走过我的门口，但神早已在我屋里，祂已选上我。疾病你可侵入我的生命，但疗药早备在手，神已选上我。无论在流泪谷发生任何事，我知祂已选上我。

「不要惧怕，因为我与你同在。」(创26:24)是祂向祂选上那些经历着「火窑之痛苦」之人的可靠应许说话。

司布真

痛苦的重担似乎是圈挂在我们颈项上的墓碑，但事实上正正是需要那重物来叫潜水员往水底去寻找珍珠。

朱利士·力住他

七月十日

「我呼叫祂，祂却不回答。」(歌5:6)

主一旦给了我们大信心，祂也以长久的延迟来试验这信心而见称。祂容许祂仆人的声音在他们耳中回荡，如同他们的祈祷从那轻蔑的上天弹回一样。信徒已敲响天门，但它依然不动声息，如同门铰已生了锈般。他们如同杰里迈亚般大呼：「你以黑云遮蔽自己，以致祷告不得透入。」(哀3:44)

神的真实圣徒忍受长期的忍

patient waiting with no reply, not because their prayers were prayed without intensity, nor because God did not accept their pleas. They were required to wait because it pleased Him who is sovereign and who gives “according to his good purpose” (Phil. 2:13). And if it pleases Him to cause our patience to be exercised, should He not do as He desires with His own?

No prayer is ever lost, or any prayer ever breathed in vain. There is no such thing as prayer unanswered or unnoticed by God, and some things we see as refusals or denials are simply delays.

Horatius Bonar

July 11

Some time later the brook dried up because there had been no rain in the land. (1 Kings 17:7)

Elijah's brook became completely dry. And only then, to Elijah's patient and faithful spirit, did the word of the Lord come and say, “Go at once to Zarephath” (v. 9).

God will often extricate us from the mess we have made, because “his love endures forever” (1 Chron. 16:34). Yet if we had only been patient and waited to see the unfolding of His plan, we would never have found ourselves in such an impossible maze, seeing no way out. We would also never have had to turn back and retrace our way, with wasted steps and so many tears of shame.

“Wait for the Lord” (Ps. 27:14). Patiently wait!

F. B. Meyer

July 12

He knows the way that I take; when he has tested me, I will come forth as gold. (Job 23:10)

Faith grows during storms. Faith is that God-given ability that, when exercised, brings the unseen into plain view. It deals with the supernatural and makes impossible things possible. It grows through disturbances in the spiritual atmosphere. Storms are caused by conflicts between the physical elements, and the storms of the spiritual world are conflicts with supernatural, hostile elements. And it is in this atmosphere of conflict that faith finds its most fertile soil and grows most rapidly to maturity.

Remember, when you see a person of great

耐而得不着响应，不是因为他们的祈祷作得不够感情，也不是因为神不接受他们的恳求。他们所需的等候是因着这能讨那至高者且是赐恩者的喜悦，「为要成就祂的美意。」(腓2:13)若我们所生发的忍耐能讨祂喜悦，那么祂岂不更可按一己的想望而行事么？

没有祈祷会不知所踪，也没有祈祷徒然呼出。没有祈祷不得应允或不得神留意这回事，我们看为拒绝或否定的祈祷不过是延迟吧了。

可拉蒂斯·邦拿

七月十一日

「过了些日子，溪水就干了，因为雨没有下在地上。」(王上17:7)

伊莱贾的溪流完全干枯了。只有到这时，神的话临到，向伊莱贾忍耐和信实的灵说：「你起身往西顿的撒勒法去」(王上17:9)。

神常救我们脱离我们所造成的困境，因为「祂的慈爱永远长存。」(代上16:34)只要我们忍耐等候来看神开展祂的计划，我们便永不会把自己困在这不能逃脱的迷宫，不见出路。我们也永不需回头，沿我们原路折回，枉废了脚步和那么多羞的眼泪。

「要等候耶和华。」(诗27:14)当忍耐等候！

迈尔

七月十二日

「然而祂知道我所行的路。祂试炼我之后，我必如精金。」(伯23:10)

「信心是在风暴中增长的」。神所加力的信心运作起来时，将那些不可见的平白地显露出来。信心专处理超自然的事，且使不可能的事情变成为可能。信是藉着属灵气氛困扰下来增长的。暴风是在物理因素的冲击下而成的，而属灵世界的风暴则是超自然和敌人因素的冲击而成的。信心就在这冲击的氛围下找到肥沃的泥土来迅速长成。

谨记，当你见着一个属灵伟人

spiritual stature, the road you must travel to walk with him is not one where the sun always shines and wildflowers always bloom. Instead, the way is a steep, rocky, and narrow path, where the winds of hell will try to knock you off your feet, and where sharp rocks will cut you, prickly thorns will scratch your face, and poisonous snakes will slither and hiss all around you.

The path of faith is one of sorrow and joy, suffering and healing comfort, tears and smiles, trials and victories, conflicts and triumphs, and also hardships, dangers, beatings, persecutions, misunderstanding, trouble, and distress. Yet “in all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us” (Rom. 8:37).

E. A. Kilbourne

July 13

God ... calls things that are not as though they were.
(Romans 4:17)

It is the very reason why “Abraham in hope believed” (v. 18). That Abraham would become the father of a child at his advanced age seemed absurd and an utter impossibility, yet God called him “the father of many nations” (Gen. 17:4) long before there was any indication of fulfillment. And Abraham thought of himself as a father, because God had said so. That is genuine faith—believing and declaring what God has said, stepping out on what appears to be thin air and finding solid rock beneath your feet.

from Crumbs

You must be like a young bird beginning to test the air with its untried wings. The fledgling may feel the same way, but it does not fall, for its wings provide support. Yet even if its wings do fail, one of its parents will sweep under it, rescuing it on strong wings.

God will rescue you in the same way. Simply trust Him, for His “right hand sustains” (Ps. 18:35). Do you find yourself asking, “But am I to step out onto nothing?” That is exactly what the bird is seemingly asked to do, yet we know that the air is there and that the air is not nearly as insubstantial as it seems. And you know that the promises of God are there, and they certainly are not insubstantial at all.

“Yes, I tell you” (Luke 12:5). Trust Him!

时，你须和他同行的不是阳光普照，花开常漫的路，而是陟斜、嶙峋和狭窄的路径。地狱之风总试图把你脚绊跌，尖石会割伤你，如针的荆棘会抓伤你面，毒蛇会在你四周爬行和发出嘶声。

信心之路虽忧伤，也喜乐；受苦却也带来医治的安慰；有流泪也有欢笑；有试炼也有得胜；有冲突也有胜利。且有艰难、危险、被打、迫害、误会、困难和悲伤，「然而靠着爱我们的主，在这一切的事上，已经得胜有余了。」(罗8:37)

E.A. 翹邦

七月十三日

「使无变为有的神。」(罗4:17)

亚伯拉罕「因信仍有指望」(罗4:18)就是这原因。亚伯拉罕晚年才成为一个孩子的父亲一事似乎荒诞和绝对不可能，然而神称他为「多国之父」(创17:4)是久在有任何得成就的迹象之前。亚伯拉罕认为他自己就是一个父亲，只因神是如此说。这是真的信心，相信和宣告神所曾说的，踏出走在看来虚无之上，却发觉脚下是坚石来的。

摘自《碎渣儿》

你定须像雏鸟般开始用那未管用的翅膀来试飞。幼鸟也许有同样的感觉，但牠是不会下跌的，因为牠的翅膀提供了支持。就算牠的翅膀不管用，其中一只父母鸟必会伸展强翼在下承接来拯救牠。

神必以相同的方法拯救你。单单信靠祂，因祂的「右手扶持我」(诗18:35)。不要问「但我怎能向无物踏出一步？」，这正是那雏鸟似乎要问的，我们也知空气在，空气且绝不如看似的虚无。你也知道神的应许在，这些应许肯定绝不虚无。

「我实在告诉你们。」(路12:5)当信靠祂！

July 14

Bind the festival sacrifice with cords to the horns of the altar. (Psalm 118:27 NASB)

There are times when life is full of promise and light, and we choose the cross; yet at other times, when the sky is gray, we run from it. Therefore it is wise to be bound to the altar.

selected

A man attended a tent revival meeting and tried to give himself to God. Every night at the altar, he would dedicate himself to the Lord. Yet as he left each evening, the Devil would come to him and convince him that since he did not feel changed, he was not truly redeemed.

Again and again he was defeated by the Adversary. Finally one evening he came to the meeting carrying an ax and a large wooden stake. After dedicating himself once more, he drove the stake into the ground where he had knelt to pray. As he was leaving the tent, the Devil came to him as usual, trying to make him believe that his commitment to God was not genuine. He quickly returned to the stake, pointed to it, and said, "Devil, do you see this stake? This is my witness that God has forever accepted me." Immediately the Devil left him, and he never experienced doubts again.

from The Still Small Voice

July 15

This is the victory that has overcome the world, even our faith. (1 John 5:4)

Trusting even when it appears you have been forsaken; praying when it seems your words are simply entering a vast expanse where no one hears and no voice answers; believing that God's love is complete and that He is aware of your circumstances, even when your world seems to grind on as if setting its own direction and not caring for life or moving one inch in response to your petitions; desiring only what God's hands have planned for you; waiting patiently while seemingly starving to death, with your only fear being that your faith might fail—"this is the victory that has overcome the world"; this is genuine faith indeed.

七月十四日

「理当用绳索把祭牲拴住，牵到坛角那里。」(诗118:27)

当生命充满应许和亮光时，我们会选择十字架，但当天色灰暗时，我们却背向十字架而逃跑。因此被拴在祭坛是明智之举。

选

一个参加营幕复兴会的男子说到他如何尝试把自己献身给神。每晚他到讲台前来委身给主，然而每当他离开时，魔鬼总来到他处，说因着他感觉不到有改变，他便不是真的得救了。

他一次又一次被仇敌打败。在最后一晚他带着一柄斧头和一条大木桩来到会场。他再一次献上自己后，就在他跪下祈祷之处把木桩砍插在地。当他离开营幕时，魔鬼如常来到他那里，试图令他相信委身给神并不真诚。他速速回到桩柱那处，指向它说：「魔鬼，你见否那木桩？这就是神永远接纳我的证据。」魔鬼立刻离开他，他也不再怀疑了。

摘自《那温柔的低声》

七月十五日

「使我们胜了世界的，就是我们的信心。」(约壹5:4)

就算看起来你已被撇弃，祈祷就如同你的说话进入巨大穹苍而没有人听见和没有响应的声音，你仍要信靠；就算当你的世界似乎像按它自定的方向来碾磨，不关心生命，也不因应你的代求而稍为让步一寸时，仍要相信神的爱完全，祂察看你的处境；只渴慕那些神手为你计划好的；在似乎要饿死时仍忍耐等候，你唯一所要害怕的就是你的信心或者失效了。「使我们胜了世界的，就是我们的信心」，这实在是真的信心。

July 16

Because you have done this and have not withheld your son, your only son, I will ... make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky ... because you have obeyed me. (Genesis 22:16-18)

From the time of Abraham, people have been learning that when they obey God's voice and surrender to Him whatever they hold most precious, He multiplies it thousands of times. Abraham gave up his one and only son at the Lord's command, and in doing so, all his desires and dreams for Isaac's life, as well as his own hope for a notable heritage, disappeared. Yet God restored Isaac to his father, and Abraham's family became "as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore" (v. 17). And through his descendants, "when the time had fully come, God sent his Son" (Gal. 4:4).

We surrender all our cherished hopes and die to self—then He sends overflowing joy and His "life ... that [we] might have it more abundantly" (John 10:10 KJV).

The greatest gift of all was Jesus Christ Himself.

Charles Gallaudet Trumbull

We sometimes seem to forget that what God takes from us, He takes with fire, and that the only road to a life of resurrection and ascension power leads us first to Gethsemane, the cross, and the tomb.

"After waiting patiently, Abraham received what was promised." (Heb. 6:15)

Indeed, there is nothing God will not do for those who will dare to step out in faith onto what appears to be only a mist. As they take their first step, they will find a rock beneath their feet.

F. B. Meyer

July 17

I will remain quiet and will look on from my dwelling place. (Isaiah 18:4)

Assyria is marching against Ethiopia, whose people are described as "tall and smooth-skinned" (v. 2). As the army advances, God makes no effort to stop

七月十六日

「你既行了这事，不留下你的儿子，就是你独生的儿子，.....我必叫你的子孙多起来，如同天上的星，.....因为你听从了我的话。」
(创22:16-18)

自亚伯拉罕起，人学会当遵从神的声音，将无论甚么他们看为最宝贵的交给神时，祂必加增他们千倍。亚伯拉罕照神的吩咐放弃他的独生子，他这样作是叫他在艾萨克生命上的渴望和梦想，并他一己期望艾萨克要得的显赫继承权都全归泡影。但神把艾萨克复归他的父亲，因而亚伯拉罕的「子孙多起来，如同天上的星，海边的沙」(创22:17)。且藉这后裔，「及至时候满足，神就差遣祂的儿子。」(加4:4)

我们放下所有我们珍爱的希望和死己时，之后祂便送来满溢的喜乐和得祂「更丰盛的生命。」(约10:10)

最大的恩赐是耶稣基督自己。
查理士·哥洛地·湛布

我们有时似乎忘记了神取走了我们甚么东西了。神是用火来取的，这也是通往永远生命和引领我们先来到客西马尼，经过十字架和来到坟墓的唯一通道。

「亚伯拉罕既恒久忍耐，就得了所应许的。」(来6:15)

对于那些放胆往看似只得雾霭而踏出一步的人，没有东西神不会为他们作。当他们走出第一步时，必会发现足下的是石地呢。

迈尔

七月十七日

「我要安静，在我的居所观看。」
(赛18:4)

被描述为「高大光滑的民」(赛18:2)的亚述大军压境古实。当军队前进时神没有加以阻止，看来他

them, and it appears as though they will be allowed to do as they wish. The Lord is watching from His “dwelling place”, “before the harvest” (v. 5) the entire proud army is defeated as easily as new growth is pruned from a vine.

His silence is not to be confused with passive agreement or consent. He is simply biding His time and will arise at the most opportune moment, just when the plans of the wicked are on the verge of success, in order to overwhelm the enemy with disaster. And as we see the evil of this world, as we watch the apparent success of wrongdoers, and as we suffer the oppression of those who hate us, let us remember those miraculous words of God—“I will remain quiet and will look on.”

Yes, God does have another point of view, and there is wisdom behind His words. Why did Jesus watch His disciples straining at the oars through the stormy night? Why did He, though unseen by others, watch the sequence of anguishing events unfold in Bethany as Lazarus slowly passed through the stages of his terminal illness, succumbed to death, and was finally buried in a rocky tomb? Jesus was simply waiting for the perfect moment when He could intercede most effectively.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

July 18

The eyes of the Lord range throughout the earth to strengthen those whose hearts are fully committed to him. (2 Chronicles 16:9)

And not only is the world waiting but God Himself awaits to see who will be the most completely devoted person who has ever lived: willing to be nothing so Christ may be everything; fully accepting God's purposes as his own; receiving Christ's humility, faith, love, and power yet never hindering God's plan but always allowing Him to continue His miraculous work.

C. H. P.

George Mueller, at more than ninety years of age, in an address to ministers and other Christian workers, said, “I was converted in November 1825, but I didn't come to the point of total surrender of my heart until four years later, in July 1829. It was then I realized my love for money, prominence, position, power, and

们被容许为所欲为。神是从祂的「居所」观看的，就在「收割之先」（赛18:5），他们就像新生葡萄树被砍去一样全军覆没。

我们不要误将神的安静与默许或同意混为一谈。祂只是按兵不动，必会在最合适的时机起来，就在恶人的计划快要胜利之时，为的是以灾难来倾覆敌人。当我们看着今世的罪恶，当我们见着行恶之人的似乎得胜时，当我们忍受那些恨恶我们之人的压逼时，我们当谨记神那些不可思议的说话：「我要安静……观看。」

是的，神有另一个看法。祂话语的背后是有智能的。为何耶稣看着门徒在风暴的晚上奋力荡桨？虽然别人看不见，为何祂却看着百大尼的拉撒路痛苦事件一幕幕的呈现：从他致命的疾病，因病而死，至终被埋于石穴墓中？只因耶稣要等候那完美的一刻来作祂最有效的代祷。

摘自《每日灵修注释》

七月十八日

「耶和華的眼目遍察全地，要显大能帮助向祂心存诚实的人。」（代下16:9）

不单止世人在等候，神自己也等候来看曾活在世上的人中谁才是最完全委身的人，他甘心成为无有，好叫基督得以成为一切；他接受神的目的作为他的目的；他接受基督的谦卑、信、爱和能力，永不阻碍神的计划，却总是容许祂来继续祂奇妙的工作。

C.H.P.

乔治·慕勒在九十多岁时向一群传道者和其它的基督工人说：「我在1825年11月得救，却要到1829年7月，即四年后才来到全心全意降服的地步。那时我才不再贪爱钱财、名誉、地位、权力和世上

worldly pleasure was gone. God, and He alone, became my all in all. In Him I found everything I needed, and I desired nothing else. By God's grace, my understanding of His sufficiency has remained to this day, making me an exceedingly happy man. It has led me to care only about the things of God.

"Before the point at which I surrendered my life, I read a little of the Scriptures but preferred other books. Yet since that time, the truth He has revealed to me of Himself has become an inexpressible blessing. Now I can honestly say from the depth of my heart that God is an infinitely wonderful Being.

selected

My prayer today is that God would make me an extraordinary Christian.

George Whitefield

July 19

Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me? (John 18:11)

To "drink the cup" was a greater thing than calming the seas or raising the dead. The prophets and apostles could do amazing miracles, but they did not always do the will of God and thereby suffered as a result. Doing God's will and thus experiencing suffering is still the highest form of faith, and the most glorious Christian achievement.

Having your brightest aspirations as a young person forever crushed; bearing burdens daily that are always difficult, and never seeing relief; finding yourself worn down by poverty while simply desiring to do good for others and provide a comfortable living for those you love; being shackled by an incurable physical disability; being completely alone, separated from all those you love, to face the trauma of life alone; yet in all these, still being able to say through such a difficult school of discipline, "Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?" —this is faith at its highest, and spiritual success at its crowning point.

Great faith is exhibited not so much in doing as in suffering.

Charles Parkhurst

In order to have a sympathetic God, we must have a suffering Savior, for true sympathy comes from understanding another person's hurt by suffering the

的欲求。神，独有祂成为我一切中的一切。在祂里头我找到凡百所需而无所爱慕。藉神恩典得知有祂便足够至今依然不变，令我成为极快乐的人，这也使我只关心神的事情。」

「在我献上我的生命那时，我是少读圣经多读其它书籍的。但自此之后，真理把祂自己向我显明，这成为一个不可言喻的恩福。如今我能从心底来诚实地说：神是无限奇妙的一位。」

选

我今天的祈祷就是神来使我作一个非凡的基督徒。

乔治·怀特腓

七月十九日

「我父所给我的那杯，我岂可不喝呢？」(约18:11)

「喝杯」比起平静风浪和使死人复活更伟大。先知和使徒能作奇妙的神迹，但他们不能常按神的旨意来行事，因而接受苦果。行神的旨意和经历痛苦仍然是最高状态的信心，也是最荣耀基督徒的成就。

年轻的你最光明的志向被永远破坏；每天担负的总是困难，从不得见舒缓；只渴想别人得益处来行善和为着你所爱的人来提供舒适的生活下发觉你自己被贫困所消蚀；被治不好的身体残疾所羁绊；完全孤单，与全部所爱的人隔离，独自面对生命的创伤。虽然在这一切当中，仍能藉着这样艰难的训练学校来说：「我父所给我的那杯，我岂可不喝呢？」这是最高的信，也是得冠冕程度的属灵胜利。

不是受苦中所展示的信心就不是大信心。

查理士·百赫士

为要得同情的神，我们定须有受苦的救主，因为真的同情是藉着身同感受来明白他人所忍受的伤

same affliction. Therefore we cannot help others who suffer without paying a price ourselves, because afflictions are the cost we pay for our ability to sympathize. Those who wish to help others must first suffer. If we wish to rescue others, we must be willing to face the cross; experiencing the greatest happiness in life through ministering to others is impossible without drinking the cup Jesus drank and without submitting to the baptism He endured.

The most comforting of David's psalms were squeezed from his life by suffering, and if Paul had not been given "a thorn in the flesh" (2 Cor. 12:7 KJV), we would have missed much of the heartbeat of tenderness that resonates through so many of his letters.

July 20

Since we have a great high priest ... , Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess....Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need. (Hebrews 4:14, 16)

Our great Helper in prayer is the Lord Jesus Christ. He is our Advocate, ever pleading our case before the Father. He is our "great high priest," whose primary ministry has for centuries been intercession and prayer on our behalf. It is He who receives our imperfect petitions from our hands, cleanses them of their defects, corrects their error, and then claims their answer from His Father. And He does so strictly on the basis of His worth and righteousness through the sufficiency of His atonement.

He has already entered "the Most Holy Place" (Ex. 26:33) on your behalf, holding up your name on the palms of His hands. The messenger is now on his way to bring you your blessing, and the Holy Spirit simply awaits your act of trust, so He may whisper in your heart the echo of the answer from the throne of God, "It is done" (Rev. 21:6).

A. B. Simpson

The Holy Spirit enlightens our mind so we may clearly see our desires, then softens our heart so we may feel them, and finally He awakens and focuses those desires toward godly things. He gives us a clear view of God's power and wisdom, provides grace "in

害。因此，我们在没有付出一己的代价来受苦之先是不能帮助别人的，因为痛苦是我们得着同情能力所付出的代价。那些想帮助别人的人定须先受苦。我们若想拯救别人，定须乐于面对十字架；没有喝耶稣的杯和没有降服来甘受主所受之洗的人想藉着服事他人来经验人生最大的快乐是不可能的。

大卫所写最令人鼓舞的诗篇都是从他受苦的生命中挤压出来的，若不是藉赐给保罗的那一根加在他肉体上的刺（林后12:7），我们便会大大失去他众多书信中回响着微妙感情的心跳。

七月二十日

「我们既然有一位.....大祭司，就是神的儿子耶稣，便当持定所承认的道。.....所以我们只管坦然无惧的，来到施恩的宝座前，为要得怜恤，蒙恩惠作随时的帮助。」（来4:14,16）

最能帮助我们祈祷的是主耶稣基督。祂是我们的保惠师，常在天父面前在我们的事上作调解。祂是我们的「大祭司」，其首要职务是几千年来替我们祈祷和代求。是祂从我们手中接去我们不完美的祈祷，洗涤当中不足之处，改正我们的错误，之后向祂的父索求祈祷的答复。祂全然藉祂赎罪充足的功效而来的价值和义作为根据来作。

祂已代你进入「至圣所」（出26:33），把你的名字握在祂的手心。传讯者如今正在途中来把恩福带给你，圣灵正等候你简单的信之举动，因此祂也许在你心中将神宝座来的答复轻声相告：「都成了」（启21:6）

宣信

圣灵照明我们的思想，清晰看到我们当爱慕的；之后祂柔软我们的心来感受到这些；至终祂苏醒我们，爱慕聚焦在属神的事上。祂叫我们清晰看见神的能力和智慧，

our time of need,” and strengthens our confidence in His truth so we will never waver.

J. Angell James

July 21

Let me make just one more request. Allow me one more test with the fleece. (Judges 6:39)

There are three levels of faith in the Christian experience. The first is being able to believe only when we see some sign or have some strong emotion. Like Gideon, we feel the fleece and are willing to trust God if it is wet. This may be genuine faith but it is imperfect. It is continually looking to feelings or some other sign instead of the Word of God. We have taken a great step toward maturity when we trust God without relying on our feelings. It is more of a blessing when we believe without experiencing any emotion.

While the first level of faith believes when our emotions are favorable, the second believes when all feelings are absent. And the third level transcends the other two, for it is faith that believes God and His Word when circumstances, emotions, appearances, people, and human reason all seem to urge something to the contrary. Paul exercised this level of faith when he said, “When neither sun nor stars appeared for many days and the storm continued raging, we finally gave up all hope of being saved” (Acts 27:20), then nevertheless went on to say, “Keep up your courage, men, for I have faith in God that it will happen just as he told me” (Acts 27:25).

C. H. P.

July 22

Therefore will the Lord wait, that he may be gracious unto you ... blessed are all they that wait for him. (Isaiah 30:18 KJV)

The very thought of the Lord’s waiting on us will give us renewed motivation and inspiration to “wait for him.” It will also provide inexpressible confidence that our waiting will never be in vain.

“Why is it that He continues to wait longer and longer to offer His grace and to provide the help I seek, even after I have come and waited on Him?” He does so because He is a wise gardener who “waits for the land to yield its valuable crop” and is “patient ... for the autumn and spring rains” (James 5:7). God

「随时帮助」来提供恩惠。祂叫我们更确信真理，永不动摇。

J·安祖娜·雅各布

七月二十一日

「我再说这一次，让我将羊毛再试一次。」(士6:39)

基督徒可经验的信心有三个阶段。首阶段的信是当我们看见令我们产生强烈感情的一些现象而去相信。像基甸一样，我们摸到羊毛，若羊毛是湿时我们便欣然信靠神。这也许是真信，但不完美，因这信持续要看望感觉或一些其它现象，而不是看望神的话。当我们不再倚重感觉来信靠神时，我们已向成功迈进一大步。在没有经历任何情感下的相信是更蒙福的。

第一阶段的信因信和情感相调和，而第二阶段的信是在完全没有感觉下仍相信。第三阶段的信更超越前两阶段，这信心就在环境、感觉、外在现象、人物和有人的理性全都似乎是相违背时仍相信神和祂的话。保罗行使这阶段的信心时说：「太阳和星辰多日不显露，又有狂风大浪催逼，我们得救的指望就都绝了。」(徒27:20)之后仍能说「所以众位可以放心，我信神，祂怎样对我说，事情也要怎样成就。」(徒27:25)

C.H.P.

七月二十二日

「耶和華必然等候，要施恩给你们.....凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」(赛30:18)

神等候我们这思想给我们复苏的动机和感动来「等候祂」。这也会给我们说不出的确信，肯定这等候永不会枉然。

为甚么就算我已来到等候祂时，祂持续要我久等还未给我祂的恩典和我寻求的帮助呢？祂这样是因祂是聪明的园丁，祂「忍耐等候地里宝贵的出产，直到得了秋雨春雨。」(雅5:7)神知道生果未

knows He cannot gather the fruit until it is ripe, and He knows precisely when we are spiritually ready to receive blessings for our gain and His glory. And waiting in the sunshine of His love is what will ripen our soul for His blessings. Also, waiting under the clouds of trials is as important, for they will ultimately produce showers of blessings.

Rest assured that if God waits longer than we desire, it is simply to make the blessings doubly precious. Remember, He waited four thousand years, "but when the time had fully come, God sent his Son" (Gal. 4:4). Our time is in His hands, and He will quickly avenge those He has chosen, swiftly coming to our support without ever delaying even one hour too long.

Andrew Murray

July 23

Sing ... to the Lord, always giving thanks to God the Father for everything. (Ephesians 5:19-20)

No matter the source of the evil confronting you, if you are in God and thereby completely surrounded by Him, you must realize that it has first passed through Him before coming to you. Because of this, you can thank Him for everything that comes your way.

Each of us has many black dots or spots in our life, and we cannot understand why they are there or why God permitted them. But when we allow Him into our life to adjust the dots in the proper way, to draw the lines He desires, and to put rests at the proper places to separate us from certain things, then from the black dots and spots He will compose a glorious harmony.

C. H. P.

Many people owe the grandeur of their lives to their tremendous difficulties.

Charles H. Spurgeon

When an organist presses the black keys of a great organ, the notes are just as beautiful as when he presses the white ones. Yet to fully demonstrate the capabilities of the instrument, he must press them all.

selected

July 24

Then they believed his promises and sang his praise. But they soon forgot what he had done and did not

成熟而不采摘，祂完全知道我们何时灵里准备好，为着我们的益处和神的荣耀来获取恩福。在祂爱的阳光下来等候会叫我们的生命成熟，好蒙祂恩福。更且，在试炼的乌云下等候是同样重要的，因为他们会至终降下恩福的雨露。

若在渴求的事上神久等时，我们该放心，这不过叫恩福加倍宝贵。谨记祂等候了四千年，「及至时候满足，神就差遣祂的儿子」(加 4:4)。我们的时间掌握在祂手中，祂必快快为祂的选民报仇，速来帮助我们，不会迟疑，一刻也不会。

慕安德烈

七月二十三日

「当.....口唱心和的赞美主。凡事.....常常感谢父神。」(弗5:19-20)

只要你在神里头，完全被祂围绕，你必明白到就算邪恶之源就你而来，须先经过神才能来到你处。因此之故，你能为来到你处的每样东西来感谢祂。

我们每个人不明生命中为何神容许有很多黑点斑迹存在。当我们容让神进入我们的生命来用正确的方法调节那些黑点，随祂喜好画上线条，和在适当位置放上休止符把我们与某些事物阻隔时，那么那些黑点斑迹会谱写成荣美乐章。

C.H.P.

多人的生命不能崇高，是因他们欠缺了极大的困难。

司布真

风琴手按动大风琴的黑键与按动白键所发的音调同样美丽。然而要全面展示那乐器的性能，他定须全部琴键都按动。

选

七月二十四日

「那时，他们才信了祂的话，歌唱赞美祂。等不多时，他们就忘了祂

wait for his counsel. In the desert they gave in to their craving; in the wasteland they put God to the test. So he gave them what they asked for, but sent a wasting disease upon them. (Psalm 106:12-15)

Even today we have people who live an inconsistent Christian life because they have become preoccupied with things that are external. Therefore they focus on their circumstances rather than focusing on God. And God desires that we grow in our ability to see Him in everything and to realize the importance of seemingly insignificant circumstances if they are used to deliver a message from Him.

They unabashedly doubted God when they came to the Red Sea, but when He opened the way and led them across and they saw Pharaoh and his army drowned—"then they believed." The Israelites continued to live this kind of up-and-down existence, because their faith was dependent on their circumstances.

The world says that "seeing is believing," but God wants us to believe in order to see. The psalmist said, "I would have despaired unless I had believed that I would see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living" (Ps. 27:13 NASB).

C. H. P.

Faith is believing what we do not see, and the reward for this kind of faith is to see what we believe.
Saint Augustine

July 25

You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand. (John 13:7)

"Wail, O pine tree, for the cedar has fallen ... !" (Zech. 11:2)

We should not be so quick to complain but should follow the gigantic tree as the workmen of "Hiram king of Tyre" (2 Chron. 2:3) take it down the mountainside. From there we should watch it being sailed on rafts along the blue water of the Mediterranean. And finally, we should behold it being placed as a glorious and polished beam in the temple of God. As you contemplate its final destination, seeing it in the Holy of Holies as a jewel in the diadem of the almighty King, can you honestly complain that this "crown jewel of Lebanon" was cut down, removed from the forest, and placed in such a

的作为，不仰望祂的指教，反倒在旷野大起欲心，在荒地试探神。祂将他们所求的赐给他们，却使他们的心灵软弱。」(诗106:12-15)

今天我们有人活在反复无常的基督徒生命中，皆因他们一直被外在事物所占据。因此他们聚焦在环境而不在神身上。神所渴想的是我们成长至我们能够在凡事上看见祂；和明白到就算看来如何不足道的处境，只要是被用作传递神讯息的都有其重要性。

他们来到红海时便毫无羞愧地质疑神，但当祂开启了道路，领他们渡过红海，见着法老和他的全军都淹没时，「那时，他们才信」。以色列人继续活在这种起伏不平的生活方式中，因为他们的信取决于环境。

世人说「看见才信」，但神想我们的信是为了有所看见。诗人说：「我若不信在活人之地得见耶和华的恩惠，就早已丧胆了。」(诗27:13)

C.H.P.

信是相信所不见的，这种信的赏赐就是得见我们所相信的。
奥古斯丁

七月二十五日

「你如今不知道，后来必明白。」(约13:7)

「松树阿，应当哀号，因为香柏树倾倒。」(亚11:2)

我们不应埋怨太快，却应随着「推罗王希兰」(代下2:3)的工人们把这棵大树从山边往下带走。从那里我们该看到它在木筏上沿蓝色的地中海水道漂流。至终我们应看到它被放在神的殿中成为那荣美和光亮的殿柱。当你细看它的至终目的地时，见到它在至圣所中如同全能王的冠冕上的珠宝，老实说你会否再为着这「利巴嫩的冠冕珠宝」被砍倒、从森林中被移除和放在如此尊贵之处而埋怨？这香

noble setting? The cedar had once stood majestically in nature's sanctuary, but "the glory of this present house will be greater than the glory of the former house" (Hag. 2:9).

"You will be a crown of splendor in the Lord's hand, a royal diadem in the hand of your God" (Isa. 62:3).

J. R. Macduff

July 26

By faith we eagerly await through the Spirit the righteousness for which we hope. (Galatians 5:5)

When we have an empty place in our heart yet will not allow it to be filled with anything less than God's best—that is the greatest kind of patience in the universe. It is the story of Job in the midst of the storm, Abraham on the road to Moriah, Moses in the desert of Midian, and the Son of Man in the Garden of Gethsemane. And there is no patience as strong as that which endures because we see "him who is invisible" (Heb. 11:27). It is the kind of patience that waits for hope. Dear Lord, You have made waiting beautiful and patience divine.

Father, give me Your divine power—the power of Gethsemane. Give me the strength to wait for hope—to look through the window when there are no stars. Even when my joy is gone, give me the strength to stand victoriously in the darkest night and say, "To my heavenly Father, the sun still shines."

George Matheson

July 27

Test me in this ... and see if I will not throw open the floodgates of heaven and pour out so much blessing that you will not have room enough for it. (Malachi 3:10)

I will never forget my mother's concise paraphrase of Malachi 3:10. The actual Bible text begins with the words "Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse" and ends with "I will ... pour out so much blessing that," in effect, "you will be embarrassed over your lack of space to receive it." But my mother's paraphrase was this: "Give all He asks and take all He promises."

Samuel Dickey Gordon

God's ability to perform is far beyond our

柏树曾尊贵地站在大自然的神殿中，然而「这殿后来的荣耀，必大过先前的荣耀。」(该2:9)

「你在耶和華的手中要作為華冠，在你神的掌上必作為冕旒。」(賽62:3)

J.R.麦道夫

七月二十六日

「我們靠著聖靈，凭着信心，等候所盼望的義。」(加5:5)

當我們的心中有空位時，不要容許任何東西來填滿，除了是神給最好的東西，就是在宇宙中最大的那種忍耐。例子有在沖擊中的喬布、去摩利亞路上的亞伯拉罕、在米甸曠野的摩西、和在客西馬尼園的人子。沒有忍耐是強如他們所堅忍的，因為我們得見「那不能看見的主。」(來11:27)。這種就是等待盼望的忍耐。

父啊，將祢神聖的力量——客西馬尼的力量——給我；把等候盼望——當沒有星星時仍從窗往外看——的力量給我；在最暗黑的夜晚給我力量來凱旋地站立來說：「我的天父使太陽仍在照耀。」

喬治·馬得勝

七月二十七日

「你們.....以此試試我，是否為你們敞開天上的窗戶，傾福與你們，甚至無處可容。」(瑪3:10)

我永不會忘記我母親對瑪3:10的簡潔的釋義。聖經文本開首的字眼是：「將當納的十分之一全然送入倉庫」，和以「我必會傾福與你們」為結束。到頭來，「你必會因無處可容而感無地自容」。但我母親的釋義是這樣的：「全給祂所要求的，全取祂所承諾的。」

塞繆爾·迪奇·哥頓

神能力的展現远超我们那怕

prayers—even our greatest prayers! I have asked for a cupful, while He owns the entire ocean! I have asked for one simple ray of light, while He holds the sun! My best asking is far beyond what we could ever ask.

John Henry Jowett

July 28

His way is in the whirlwind and the storm. (Nahum 1:3)

One day I sat on the side of the mountain and watched a storm as it moved through the valley. The skies were filled with darkness, and thunder began to shake the earth. It seemed as though the lush landscape were completely changed, and its beauty gone forever. But the storm passed quickly and soon moved out of the valley.

If I had sat in the same place the following day and said, “Where is that intense storm and all its terrible darkness?” the grass would have said, “Part of it is in me.” The beautiful daisy would have said, “Part of it is in me.” And all the other flowers, fruits, and everything that grows in the ground would have said, “Part of the storm has produced the radiance in me.”

Have you ever asked the Lord to make you like Him? Have you ever desired the fruit of the Spirit and prayed for sweetness, gentleness, and love? If so, then never fear the fierce storms that even now may be blowing through your life. Storms bring blessings, and rich fruit will be harvested later.

Henry Ward Beecher

July 29

Have you entered the storehouses ... which I reserve for times of trouble? (Job 38:22-23)

Our trials are great opportunities, but all too often we simply see them as large obstacles. If only we would recognize every difficult situation as something God has chosen to prove His love to us, each obstacle would then become a place of shelter and rest, and a demonstration to others of His inexpressible power.

God’s most beautiful jewels are often delivered in rough packages by very difficult people, but within the package we will find the very treasures of the King’s palace and the Bridegroom’s love.

A. B. Simpson

是最大的祈祷！我祈求一杯水，祂拥有的却是一整个海洋！我祈求一丝光线，祂却掌管着太阳！天父所给的远超我们从来所祈求的。

约翰·亨利·祖屈

七月二十八日

「祂乘旋风和暴风而来。」(鸿1:3)

有一天我坐在山边，看着一个暴风如何移扫一山谷。天空满布黑暗，雷电开始摇动大地。繁盛的景致就像要完全改变，美丽要永远失掉一样。但风暴去得极快，不久便离开了山谷。

若我在第二日坐在同一地方时便会说：「那强烈风暴和它恐怖的黑暗在那里呢？」草儿会说：「它一部分在我里头。」美丽的雏菊会说：「它一部分在我里头。」所有其它的花儿、生果、和在地上种植的每一样东西都会说：「暴风的一部分在我里头产生了作用。」

你曾否求主使你像祂？你曾否渴慕圣灵的果子，祈求亲切、温柔和爱？若有，那么总不要害怕猛烈的风暴了，那怕可能正在吹袭你生命的那一场。风暴带来恩福，过后便会有丰盛果子的收成。

亨利·华德·比查

七月二十九日

「你曾进入雪库……么？这雪霭乃是我为降灾……的日子所预备的。」(伯38:22-23)

试炼于我们是非常的机会，我们却一再看他们为大障碍。我们只要认清神其实选择每个困难处境来向我们证明祂的爱，那么每个障碍物便成为荫凉安息之处，也向别人展示祂说不尽的权能。

神最美丽的珠宝常在粗糙的包装下经十分难相处之人的手送来，但在包装内我们必能发现王的宫殿中和新娘所爱的非常珍宝。

宣信

July 30

If anyone gives even a cup of cold water ... , he will certainly not lose his reward. (Matthew 10:42)

I expect to pass through this world but once. Therefore any good work, kindness, or service I can render to any person or animal, let me do it now. Let me not neglect or delay to do it, for I will not pass this way again.

an old Quaker saying

Give what you have, for you never know—to someone else it may be better than you can even dare to think.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow

July 31

With skillful hands he led them. (Psalm 78:72)

When you are unsure which course to take, totally submit your own judgment to that of the Spirit of God, asking Him to shut every door except the right one. But meanwhile keep moving ahead and consider the absence of a direct indication from God to be the evidence of His will that you are on His path.

God often guides us through our circumstances. One moment, our way may seem totally blocked, but then suddenly some seemingly trivial incident occurs, appearing as nothing to others but speaking volumes to the keen eye of faith. And sometimes these events are repeated in various ways in response to our prayers. They certainly are not haphazard results of chance but are God opening up the way we should walk, by directing our circumstances. And they begin to multiply as we advance toward our goal, just as the lights of a city seem to increase as we speed toward it while traveling at night.

F. B. Meyer

August 1

Offer yourselves to God, as those who have been brought from death to life. (Romans 6:13)

In a sermon on consecration, the preacher knelt to pray, he said, "O Lord, You know we can trust the Man who died for us."

Upon arriving home, I went straight to my room, fell on my knees, and saw my life pass before my

七月三十日

「无论何人.....只把一杯凉水给这小子里的一个喝，.....这人不能不得赏赐。」(太10:42)

我会走完今世，但只得一次。因此有甚么善事、仁慈、对任何人或动物要作甚么服务就要如今来作了。我不要忽略或延迟来作，因为我必不能重回这路。

一个古老贵格会的谚语

将你所有的送出去，因为你永不知道，对于收到的人来说所送出的总会比你以为的更好。

亨利·华士和夫·朗法劳

七月三十一日

「祂.....用手中的巧妙，引导他们。」(诗78:72)

当你不肯定要选那条路走时，将你一切的判断完全呈献给神的灵吧，求祂关上正确之门以外的每一道门。但在保持前行的那刻，要将没有从神而来的直接指引看为你正在祂旨意的路径上的明证。

神常时藉处境带领我们。有时我们的前路也许似乎完全被阻塞，但随后突然一些似乎琐碎的事件出现，别人视为不以为然的，但在信心锋利的眼中看为充足的明证。有时这些事件以不同的方法重复出现来回应我们的祈祷。他们肯定不是偶发的机缘巧合，而是神藉环境的指引来开路，好叫我们来行上。当我们向着目标前行时他们越发增多，如同在我们晚上驾车向城市前行时的灯光不断增加一样。

迈尔

八月一日

「倒要像从死里复活的人，将自己献给神。」(罗6:13)

有一个论及献身的讲道，传道者跪下祈祷说：「主啊，祢知我们可信赖为我们死的那一位。」

当抵家时，我直入房间，双膝跪下，过往的人生在眼前经过。我

eyes. I was a Christian, an officer in the church, and a Sunday school superintendent, but I had never yielded my life to God with a definite act of my will. Yet as I thought of my own “precious” plans that might be thwarted, my beloved hopes to be surrendered, and my chosen profession that I might have to abandon—I was afraid.

I completely failed to see the better things God had for me, so my soul was running from Him. And then for the last time, with a swift force of convicting power to my inmost heart, came that searching message: “My child, you can trust the Man who died for you. If you cannot trust Him, then whom can you trust?”

J. H. M.

Life is not wreckage to be saved out of the world but an investment to be used in the world.

August 2

I will turn all my mountains into roads. (Isaiah 49:11)

God will make our obstacles serve His purposes. We all have mountains in our lives, and often they are people and things that threaten to block the progress of our spiritual life. The obstacles may be untruths told about us; a difficult occupation; “a thorn in [the] flesh” (2 Cor. 12:7); or our daily cross. And often we pray for their removal, for we tend to think that if only these were removed, we would live a more tender, pure, and holy life.

“How foolish you are, and how slow of heart ... !” (Luke 24:25). These are the very conditions we need for achievement, and they have been put in our lives as the means of producing the gifts and qualities for which we have been praying so long. We pray for patience for many years, and when something begins to test us beyond our endurance, we run from it. The only way genuine patience can be acquired is by enduring the very trials that seem so unbearable today.

Turn from your running and submit. Claim by faith to be a partaker in the patience of Jesus and face your trials in Him. There is nothing in your life that distresses or concerns you that cannot become submissive to the highest purpose. Remember, they are God’s mountains. He puts them there for a reason,

是一名基督徒，在教会中有职事，且是一个主日学校长，但我还未曾用我意志上的明确行动来将生命呈献给神。但当我想到我一己宝贵的计划可能受阻碍，我心爱的希望可能要放弃，可能要抛弃我所选择的职业时，我是害怕的。

我完全没有看到神给我更好的东西，因此我的魂是想逃避祂的。至终有一说服力彻底的信息这时临到我心至深处：「我儿啊，你若不能信靠祂可信靠为你死的那一位，你还可信靠谁呢？」

J.H.M.

生命不是从世上要救回的碎片，乃是用作世上的投资。

八月二日

「我必使我的众山成为大道。」(赛49:11)

神必会使阻碍我们的成就祂的目的。我们全都有生命中的大山，常威胁要阻碍我们属灵生命的人和物。障碍可能是我们的谎话、一个麻烦的职业、「一根加在我肉体上的刺」(林后12:7)、或我们每天的十字架。我们常祈求除去他们，总以为只要除去他们便可活出更温柔、更纯洁和更神圣的生命。

「无知的人哪.....你们的心，信得太迟钝了。」(路24:25)这正是我们所需改进的，他们早已放在我们生命中，为叫我们一直祈求要得的恩赐和素质。我们多年祈求忍耐，当有超乎我们忍受的东西开始试验我们时，我们却逃跑。得着真忍耐的唯一方法就是忍受今天那些似乎不能忍耐的试炼。

从逃离转过来降服。用信心支取有分于耶稣的忍耐，和在祂里头面对试炼。在你的生命中没有苦恼或挂心会使你不能在最高的旨意上顺服。谨记，神把祂的高山放在那里是有目的的，为叫我们认识到

and we know He will never fail to keep His promise.

“God understands the way to it and he alone knows where it dwells, for he views the ends of the earth and sees everything under the heavens” (Job 28:23-24). So when we come to the foot of the mountains, we will find our way.

from Christ in Isaiah, by F. B. Meyer

August 3

Be men of courage; be strong. (1 Corinthians 16:13)

Never pray for an easier life—pray to be a stronger person! Never pray for tasks equal to your power—pray for power equal to your tasks. Then doing your work will be no miracle—you will be the miracle.

Phillips Brooks

We must remember that Christ will not lead us to greatness through an easy or self-indulgent life. An easy life does not lift us up but only takes us down. Heaven is always above us, and we must continually be looking toward it.

Some people always avoid things that are costly, or things that require self-denial, self-restraint, and self-sacrifice. Yet it is hard work and difficulties that ultimately lead us to greatness, for greatness is not found by walking the moss-covered path laid out for us through the meadow. It is found by being sent to carve out our own path with our own hands.

selected

August 4

Jesus looked up and said, “Father, I thank You that You have heard me.” (John 11:41)

Lazarus was still in his tomb, yet Jesus' thanksgiving preceded the miracle of raising him from the dead. It seems that thanks would only have been lifted up once the great miracle had been accomplished and Lazarus had been restored to life. But Jesus gave thanks for what He was about to receive. His gratitude sprang forth before the blessing had arrived, in an expression of assurance that it was certainly on its way. The song of victory was sung before the battle had been fought. It was the Sower singing the song of harvest—it was thanksgiving before the miracle!

祂永不会不恪守祂所应许。

「神明白智慧的道路，晓得智慧的所在，因祂鉴察直到地极，遍观普天之下。」(伯28:23-24)因此当我们来到山脚时，我们必能找到去路。

迈尔着《以赛亚书中的基督》

八月三日

「要作大丈夫，要刚强。」(林前16:13)

永不要祈求舒适的生活，却要祈求成为更强壮的人！永不要要求那些等同你能力的工作，却要祈求你工作的能力，那么你所作的工必不会是奇迹，你必会就是奇迹。

腓力斯·布鲁克

我们定须谨记基督必不会藉舒适或自我放纵的生活给我们伟大。一个安乐的生活不会提升我们，却只会把我们拉低。天堂总在我们的上头，我们定须持续望天。

有人总逃避要付代价的东西，或是那些需要自我否定、自我约束和自我牺牲的东西。然而艰辛和困难领我们成为伟大，因为走经草坪上铺满苔藓的小径不会找到伟大，而是藉我们的手开辟一己的路径才能找到。

选

八月四日

「耶稣举目望天说：父阿，我感谢祢，因为祢已经听我。」(约11:41)

拉撒路虽仍在坟墓里，耶稣的感恩却先于死人复活这神迹。似乎当在伟大的神迹得成就，拉撒路得回生命之后才来感谢。但耶稣为着祂将获取的来感谢。在恩福来临之前祂便涌出感谢，确实地表述恩福正在来临中的肯定。在争战完结前所唱得胜之歌，是播种者唱颂的收割之歌——在神迹之前先有谢恩！

Praise is actually the most vital preparation to the working of miracles. Miracles are performed through spiritual power, and our spiritual power is always in proportion to our faith. John

Henry Jowett

August 5

My grace is sufficient for you. (2 Corinthians 12:9)

“God was pleased” (1 Cor. 1:21) to take my youngest child from this world, under circumstances that caused me severe trials and pain.

I found that the verse “My grace is sufficient for you” was the text of next week’s Sunday school lesson, yet while trying to write the sermon, I found that in all honesty, I could not say that the words were true in my life. Therefore I knelt down and asked the Lord to make His grace sufficient for me. While I was pleading in this way, I opened my eyes and saw this exact verse framed and hanging on the wall. My mother had given it to me a few days before.

The word “is” was highlighted in bright green, while the words “my” and “you” were painted in yet another color. In a moment, a message flashed straight to my soul, coming as a rebuke for having prayed such a prayer as, “Lord, make Your grace sufficient for me.” His answer was almost an audible voice that said, “How dare you ask for something that is? I cannot make My grace any more sufficient than I have already made it. Get up and believe it, and you will find it to be true in your life.”

H. W. Webb Peploe

August 6

Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. (Song of Songs 4:16)

It is rooted in the fact that in the same way beautiful fragrances may lie hidden in a spice plant, certain gifts may lie unused or undeveloped in a Christian’s heart. Many seeds of a profession of faith may be planted, but from some the air is never filled with the aroma of holy desires or godly deeds. The same winds blow on the thistle and the spice plant, but only one of them emits a rich fragrance.

Sometimes God causes severe winds of trial to blow upon His children to develop their gifts. Just as a

赞美事实上是运作神迹的最重要预备；神迹是藉属灵能力行出来的，而我们的属灵能力是与我们的信心成正比例的。

约翰·亨利·祖屈

八月五日

「我的恩典够你用的。」(林后12:9)

「神乐意」(林前1:21)从这世界取走我最年幼的孩子，这处境带给我严峻的试炼和痛苦。

我知道「我的恩典是够你用的」这经文是下星期日主日学的课题，然而当我尝试来写讲章时，老实说，我发觉在我的生命上我不能说这是对的。因此我跪下求主来使祂的恩典足够我用。当我这样求时，我张眼看见挂在墙上的字框正是这经文，是母亲几日前给我的。

「是」字标以鲜绿色，而「我的」和「你」则用上别的颜色。那一刻，有一信息直闪入我魂，来谴责我竟作祈祷如：「主，使祢的恩典够我用。」而祂的响应几乎是一可听之声，说：「你岂敢求这个？我不能使我的恩典比我已作的更够用。起来相信吧，你必会发觉这在你生命中是对的。」

H.W.韦伯·伯卢

八月六日

「北风阿，兴起。南风阿，吹来。吹在我的园内，使其中的香气发出来。」(歌4:16)

美丽的香气藏于香料植物是一个事实，同样地基督徒心中也许会藏有某些未用或未发展的恩赐。也许播种了很多信仰的种子，但其中一些种子不能使空气充满神圣渴望和虔诚行为的香气。风同时吹过蓟草和一些香料植物，但只有其中一棵发出一阵浓浓的香气。

有时神使猛烈的试炼之风疾吹祂的孩子，为的是扩展他们的恩

torch burns more brightly when waved back and forth, and just as a juniper plant smells sweetest when thrown into the flames, so the richest qualities of a Christian often arise under the strong winds of suffering and adversity. Bruised hearts often emit the fragrance that God loves to smell.

August 7

After they prayed, the place where they were meeting was shaken. And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God boldly....With great power the apostles continued to testify to the resurrection of the Lord Jesus. (Acts 4:31, 33)

Christmas Evans, a Welsh preacher of the late-eighteenth and early-nineteenth centuries, once wrote the following account in his diary.

“One Sunday afternoon I was traveling by horseback to an appointment. Suddenly as I went along a very lonely road, I was convicted of having a cold heart. I dismounted, tethered my horse to a tree, and found a secluded spot. Then, walking back and forth in agony, I reviewed my life. I waited before God in brokenness and sorrow for three hours. Finally a sweet sense of His forgiving love broke over me, and I received a fresh filling of His Holy Spirit.

“As the sun was setting, I walked back to the road, found my horse, and rode on to my appointment. The following day I preached with so much new power, to a vast gathering of people on a hillside, that revival broke out and ultimately spread through all of Wales.”

The born-again—the password of the early church—“Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?” (Acts 19:2).

August 8

You are my King and my God, who decrees victories for Jacob. (Psalm 44:4)

There are no enemies to your growth in grace, or to your Christian work, that were not included in your Savior's victory. Remember, “The Lord said to Joshua, ‘Do not be afraid of them, because ... I will hand all of them over to [you]’” (Josh. 11:6). Also recall the fact that when you resist your enemies, they “will flee from you” (James 4:7). And remember what Joshua said to the people: “Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged. Be strong and courageous” (Josh. 10:25). The Lord is

赐。火把来回摇动是会烧得更明亮的，同样地当将一株红柳植物抛入火焰中烧时，会发出最甜美香气，因此在受苦和逆境之强风中的基督徒常激起最丰硕的素质。受伤的心常散发出神爱闻的馨香。

八月七日

「祷告完了，聚会的地方震动，他们就都被圣灵充满，放胆讲论神的道.....使徒大有能力，见证主耶稣复活。众人也都蒙大恩。」（徒4:31,33）

十八世纪末十九世纪初的威尔士传道人克瑞斯马·伊凡思在他的日记中有以下的记事：

「一个星期日下午我骑马去赴会。当我在幽静的路上走时，我为着冰冷的心认罪。我下马，把马系绑在一棵树，之后找到一僻静之处。那时在痛苦中踱步，来来回回，检视我的生命，用了三小时在沮丧和忧愁中在神面前等候。最后祂饶恕的爱这甜美的感觉忽尔临到，我便从新得着神圣灵的充满。」

「当太阳下山时，我按原路而回，找回马匹，驰马赴会。之后一日的传讲是满有新能力，山边聚满群众，复兴爆发，至终延展至整个威尔士。」

「重生」是早期教会的入门密码——「你们信的时候，受了圣灵没有？」（徒19:2）

八月八日

「神阿，祢是我的王，求祢出令，使雅各布得胜。」（诗44:4）

你在恩中成长和为主作工都不会有敌人，因这些都不包含在救主的胜利中。谨记「耶和華对乔舒亚说：不要因他们惧怕.....我必将他们交付以色列人全然杀了。」（书11:6）也要回想当你抗拒敌人时，他们便「离开你们逃跑了」（雅4:7）这事实。当记取乔舒亚对民众说：「不要惧怕，也不要惊惶。应当刚

with you, “mighty men of valour” (Josh. 1:14 KJV), and you are mighty because you are one with the Mightiest. So claim victory!

Count Christ’s victory as yours and gather the spoils of the war. Neither the giant “descendants of Anak” (Num. 13:33) nor fortified cities need intimidate or defeat you. You are a part of the conquering army. Claim your share in the Savior’s victory.

from Joshua, by F. B. Meyer

August 9

Blessed are those whose strength is in you....As they pass through the Valley of Baca, they make it a place of springs. (Psalm 84:5-6)

Comfort is not given to us when we are lighthearted and cheerful. We must travel the depths of emotion in order to experience comfort—one of God’s most precious gifts. And then we must be prepared to become coworkers with Him.

When the shadows of night—needed night—gather over the garden of our souls, when leaves close up and flowers no longer reflect any sunlight within their folded petals, and when we experience even the thickest darkness, we must remember that we will never be found wanting and that the comforting drops of heavenly dew fall only after the sun has set.

August 10

Yet when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days. (John 11:6)

“Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus” (v. 5). It is as if God were teaching us that at the very heart and foundation of all His dealings with us, no matter how dark and mysterious they may be, we must dare to believe in and affirm His infinite, unmerited, and unchanging love. Yet love permits pain to occur.

Mary and Martha never doubted that Jesus would quickly avert every obstacle to keep their brother from death, “yet when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days.”

Jesus refrained from going not because He did not love them but because He did love them. It was His love alone that kept Him from hurrying at once to their beloved yet grief-stricken home.

强壮胆。」(书10:25)「一切大能的勇士」(书1:14)啊，主与你们同在，你们有能力因与你们同在的最大能。那么索取胜利吧！

以基督的胜利为你的胜利来聚敛战利品。「伟人的后裔」(民13:33)或坚城不能恫吓或击败你，你是得胜军队的一部分。在基督的得胜中索求你的分吧！

摘自迈尔著的《乔舒亚》

八月九日

「靠祢有力量.....的，这人便为有福。他们经过流泪谷，叫这谷变为泉源之地。」(诗84:5-6)

安慰不是在我们心情愉快和欢欣时才给我们的。我们定须进入感情的深处才能经验安慰，就是神其中一个最宝贵的恩赐。之后我们定须准备好成为祂的同工。

当夜影——难过的晚上——笼罩我们的生命花园时，当叶儿闭合，花儿不再在他们折合的花瓣中反照日光，甚至当我们所经历的是最厚密的黑暗时，我们定须谨记我们永不会落在缺乏中，安慰的天露滴湿只会在日落后降下。

八月十日

「(然而)听见拉撒路病了，就在所居之地，仍住了两天。」(约11:6)

「耶稣素来爱马大，和她妹子，并拉撒路。」(约11:5)就如神教导我们，在心中的祂处理我们一切事件的基础上，无论他们如何黑暗和神秘，我们定须敢于相信和确知祂的爱无限、不求回报和不变的，然而爱也容许痛苦发生。

马利亚和马大在耶稣会排除万难赶快来叫她们兄弟不死上毫无怀疑，「(然而)听见拉撒路病了，就在所居之地，仍住了两天。」

耶稣忍住不去，不是因为祂不爱他们，相反正因祂真的爱他们，就是只因祂这爱使祂不立时赶到他们这可爱却极为悲痛之家。

August 11

Though the fig tree does not bud and there are no grapes on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though there are no sheep in the pen and no cattle in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will be joyful in God my Savior. (Habakkuk 3:17-18)

It is as if the writer were actually saying, "Even if I am forced to undergo the extreme condition of not knowing where to find my next meal, and although my house is empty and my fields yield no crops and I see the evidence of divine pestilence where I once saw the fruits of God's plentiful provision, 'yet I will rejoice in the Lord.'"

Oh, by God's grace, may they be deeply etched on the tablets of each of our hearts! Although the above verse is very concise, it nevertheless implies or expresses the following thoughts of the writer: that in his time of distress he would flee to God; that he would maintain his spiritual composure under the darkest of circumstances; and that in the midst of everything, he would delight himself with a sacred joy in God and have cheerful expectations of Him.

Heroic confidence! Glorious faith!
Unconquerable love!

Philip Doddridge

August 12

He has given us his very great and precious promises. (2 Peter 1:4)

A shipbuilder erects a boat to sail the seas and to weather the storms.

Do you believe that some of His promises are counterfeit, similar to a life vest that looks good in the store but is of no use in the sea?

We have all seen swords that are beautiful but are useless in war, or shoes made for decoration but not for walking. Yet God's shoes are made of iron and brass, and we can walk all the way to heaven in them, without ever wearing them out. And we could swim the Atlantic a thousand times in His life vest, with no fear of ever sinking. His Word of promise is meant to be tried and tested.

There is nothing Christ dislikes more than for His

八月十一日

「虽然无花果树不发旺，葡萄树不结果，橄榄树也不效力，田地不出粮食，圈中绝了羊，棚内也没有牛。然而我要因耶和华欢欣，因救我的神喜乐。」（哈3:17-18）

这就如同作者真的说：「就算我被逼来经受不知在何处找到下一餐，虽然我家徒四壁，田地不出土产，从前见到神丰富供应果子之处如今但见神而来的祸害，这等严峻的情况，『然而我要因耶和华欢欣』。」

噢，愿神施恩，让这些深深蚀刻在我们每人心中匾额上！虽然文首经节是这样简洁，但它毕竟道出或表达作者的心意：在他绝望之时可逃往神处；在最黑暗的处境下仍持守他属灵的沉静；在万事万物中，因着在神里头有神圣的喜乐和对祂有欢欣的期望而高兴。

这是崇高的确信！荣耀的信心！不可征服的爱！

腓力·托德瑞

八月十二日

「祂已将又宝贵又极大的应许赐给我们。」（彼后1:4）

造船者装嵌一艘船是要启航出海，抵御暴风的。

你是否以为神的应许虚假，如同一些救生衣在仓存时看起来合用，但在海上却一无是处？

我们全都见过美丽但在战场上毫无用处的剑器，也见过只合装饰不合走路的鞋子。神的鞋子是用铁用铜来制造的，穿上他们叫我们直奔天家去，总不会穿破。穿上祂的救生衣能泳渡大西洋一千遍，总不怕溺没。祂应许的话是经得起试验和试炼的。

没有像公开承认祂却不用祂

people to publicly profess Him and then not use Him.

Charles H. Spurgeon

How can God say no to something He has promised?

August 13

If clouds are full of water, they pour rain upon the earth. (Ecclesiastes 11:3)

It is true that for a while the dark clouds hide the sun, but it is not extinguished and it will soon shine again. Meanwhile those clouds are filled with rain, and the darker they are, the more likely they are to bring plentiful showers.

How can we have rain without clouds? Our troubles have always brought us blessings, and they always will, for they are the dark chariots of God's bright and glorious grace. Before long the clouds will be emptied, and every tender plant will be happier due to the showers. Our God may drench us with grief, but He will refresh us with His mercy. Our Lord's love letters often come to us in dark envelopes. His wagons may rumble noisily across the sky, but they are loaded with benefits. And His rod blossoms with sweet flowers and nourishing fruits. So let us not worry about the clouds. Instead, let us sing because May flowers are brought to us through April clouds and showers.

O Lord, "clouds are the dust of [your] feet" ! (Nah. 1:3).

Charles H. Spurgeon

August 14

You would have no power over me if it were not given to you from above. (John 19:11)

Someone who was passing through the deep water of affliction wrote a friend:

Isn't it glorious to know that no matter how unjust something may be, even when it seems to have come from Satan himself, by the time it reaches us it is God's will for us and will ultimately work to our good?

"And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him" (Rom. 8:28). Think of what Christ said even as He was betrayed: "Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?" (John 18:11).

Hannah Whitall Smith

的子民更叫基督不喜悦。

司布真

神怎会在应许的事上说不？

八月十三日

「云若满了雨，就必倾倒在地球上。」
(传11:3)

黑云会把太阳一时藏起来是真的，但不是要熄灭它，它仍会再次照耀。这时那些云满载雨水，雨云越乌黑，他们便越发可能带来大量的雨洒。

我们怎会有无雨的云？我们的困惑总会为我们带来恩福，总会，因他们是神光明荣耀恩典的黑暗战车。不多久云儿必清空，每棵娇嫩植物会因雨露而变得高兴。我们的神会用忧伤浸泡我们，但祂必会用怜悯叫我们复苏。我们主充满爱的信件常在黑暗信封中寄来，祂的马车也许横过天际隆隆作响，但满载恩泽。祂的杖必芬芳花开，结成果实，因此让我们不要担忧云儿了，反而我们来歌唱吧，因为四月的云雨必会带来五月的花儿。

主啊，「云彩是祢脚下的尘土。」(鸿1:3)

司布真

八月十四日

「若不是从上头赐给你的，你就毫无权柄办我。」(约19:11)

有一个正经历苦痛之深水的人写给一个朋友以下的话：

无论事情看起来如何不公，甚或似乎是出于撒但自己的，就在它临到我们之时，它必然是神的旨意，至终必会带给我们益处。

「我们晓得万事都互相效力，叫爱神的人得益处。」(罗8:28)
「我父所给我的那杯，我岂可不喝呢？」(约18:11)

汉纳·韦滔·史勿夫

August 15

We must go through many hardships to enter the kingdom of God. (Acts 14:22)

The best things in life are the result of being wounded. Wheat must be crushed before becoming bread, and incense must be burned by fire before its fragrance is set free. The earth must be broken with a sharp plow before being ready to receive the seed. And it is a broken heart that pleases God.

If you aspire to be a person of consolation, if you want to share the priestly gift of sympathy, if you desire to go beyond giving commonplace comfort to a heart that is tempted, and if you long to go through the daily exchanges of life with the kind of tact that never inflicts pain, then you must be prepared to pay the price for a costly education—for like Christ, you must suffer.

Frederick William Robertson

August 16

I waited patiently for the Lord. (Psalm 40:1)

Waiting is much more difficult than walking, for waiting requires patience, and patience is a rare virtue. We enjoy knowing that God builds hedges around His people, when we look at the hedge from the aspect of protection. But when we see it growing higher and higher until we can no longer see over it, we wonder if we will ever get out of our little sphere of influence and service, where we feel trapped. Sometimes it is hard for us to understand why we do not have a larger area of service, and it becomes difficult for us to “brighten the corner” where we are. But God has a purpose in all of His delays. “The steps of a good man are ordered by the Lord” (Ps. 37:23 KJV).

Next to this verse, in the margin of his Bible, George Muellermade this note: “And the stops too.” It is a sad mistake for someone to break through God’s hedges. It is a vital principle of the Lord’s guidance for a Christian never to move from the spot where he is sure God has placed him, until the “pillar of cloud” (Ex. 13:21) moves.

from Sunday School Times

It requires much more courage to stand and wait and still not lose heart or lose hope, to submit to the

八月十五日

「我们进入神的国，必须经历许多艰难。」（徒14:22）

生命中最好的东西都是受伤所致的。麦子在作成面包前定须压碎，香料定须被燃烧才会释放芬芳，泥土定须被尖犁所耕耙才准备好接收种子。同样地一个破碎的心才会讨神喜悦。

你若立志作一孤独的人，你若想有分于传教士尝受的同情，你若渴望超越那些向受试炼的心灵给予平常安慰的人，你若期望用从不带来痛苦的老练来过每日的交往时，那么你定须准备好付上学习上的沉重代价，因为若要像基督的话，你定须受苦。

弗雷德里克·威廉·鲁宾斯坦

八月十六日

「我曾耐性等候耶和華。」（诗40:1）

等候比起走路难得多，因为等候需要忍耐，而忍耐是稀有的品德。我们乐于见到神在祂子民四围筑起树篱，因我们看这树篱为某方面的保护。但当树篱越发增高，叫我们不能越篱外望时，因着感到被困，我们便会想着离开我们这细小的影响和服事范围了。有时我们很难明白我们为何不能有更大的服事领域，对我们来说要在所在处「照明角落」是困难的。但神在祂所有的迟延上总是有目的的。「义人的脚步，被耶和華立定。」（诗37:23）

在乔治·慕勒的圣经写着这笔记：「停步也是。」有人破树篱而出，这是一无可救药的错误。神引导一个基督徒时是永不会把他从神放置之处挪移的，这是一不可或缺的原则，除非「云柱」（出13:21）移动。

摘自《主日学报》

站稳等待且不沮丧或失去盼望，降服于神的旨意，放弃工作的

will of God, to give up opportunities for work and leave honors to others, and to be quiet, confident, and rejoicing while the busy multitude goes happily along their way.

The greatest life is: "after you have done everything, to stand" (Eph. 6:13).

J. R. Miller

August 17

I have faith in God that it will happen just as he told me. (Acts 27:25)

A steamship captain who was a very devoted Christian said, "I had been on the bridge for twenty-four straight hours when George Mueller of Bristol, England, who was a passenger on board, came to me and said, 'Captain, I need to tell you that I must be in Quebec on Saturday afternoon.' 'That is impossible,' I replied. 'Very well,' Mueller responded, 'if your ship cannot take me, God will find some other way, for I have never missed an engagement in fifty-seven years. Let's go down to the chartroom to pray.'

"'Mr. Mueller,' I said, 'do you realize how dense the fog is?' 'No,' he replied. 'My eye is not on the dense fog but on the living God, who controls every circumstance of my life.'

"He then knelt down and prayed one of the most simple prayers I've ever heard. As I looked at him, he said, 'Captain, I have known my Lord for fifty-seven years, and there has never been even a single day that I have failed to get an audience with the King. Get up, Captain, and open the door, and you will see that the fog is gone.' I got up, and indeed the fog was gone. And on Saturday afternoon George Mueller was in Quebec for his meeting."

selected

August 18

The Lord alone led him. (Deuteronomy 32:12)

*A little while, and we will meet again
The loved and lost; but in the rapturous joy
Of greetings, such as here we cannot know,
And happy song, and heavenly embraces,*

*And tender recollections rushing back
Of life now passed, I think one memory*

机会，将荣誉让与别人，在繁忙群众沿途上开心行走时来安静和确信所需的勇气大得多。

「成就了一切，还能站立得住。」(弗6:13)是最伟大的生命。

J.R.米勒

八月十七日

「我信神，祂怎样对我说：事情也要怎样成就。」(徒27:25)

一十分虔诚的基督徒蒸气船船长说：「当来自英国布里斯托的乘客乔治·慕勒来跟我说话时，我已站在驳桥上足有二十四小时。他说：『船长，我需告诉你我必须在星期六下午去到奎北克。』我回答说：『这是没有可能的。』慕勒响应说：『既是这样，你的船若不能载我去，神必会找到别的方法，因为五十年来我未曾失过一次约。让我们下去海图室祈祷吧！』」

「我说：『慕勒先生，你知否雾现在多浓密？』『不，』他答道：『我眼不看浓雾，只看永活神，掌管我生命每个处境的那位。』」

「之后他便跪下作了一个我从未听过很简单的祈祷。当我望着他时，他说：『船长，我认识我的主有五十多年了，未曾有一日我不能与我的王到会众处。起来吧，船长，打开门，你必会见到云雾已散。』于是我起来，雾真的散了。在星期六下午乔治·慕勒去到奎北克他的聚会处。」

选

八月十八日

「耶和华独自引导他。」(申32:12)

不多久我们必会与
所爱和失去之人重聚，
与如今我们不认识的人相见。
快乐之歌，天上的拥抱。

如今掠过的是生命温馨的回忆。
我想有一比其余更珍贵

*More dear and sacred than the rest, will rise,
And we who gather in the golden streets,
Will oft be stirred to speak with grateful love
Of that dark day Jesus called us to climb
Some narrow steep, leaning on Him alone.*

There is never a majestic mountain without a deep valley, and there is no birth without pain.

Daniel Crawford

August 19

Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing. (2 Corinthians 6:10)

Sorrow was beautiful, but his beauty was the beauty of the moonlight shining through the leafy branches of the trees in the woods.

Joy was beautiful, too, but hers was the radiant beauty of a summer morning.

Sorrow longingly said, "We can never be united as one." Yet even as Sorrow spoke, he and Joy became aware of someone standing beside them. In spite of the dim light, they sensed a kingly Presence, and suddenly a great and holy awe overwhelmed them. They then sank to their knees before Him.

"I see Him as the King of Joy," whispered Sorrow, "for on His head are many crowns, and the nailprints in His hands and feet are the scars of a great victory. And before Him all my sorrow is melting away into deathless love and gladness. I now give myself to Him forever."

"No, Sorrow," said Joy softly, "for I see Him as the King of Sorrow, and the crown on His head is a crown of thorns, and the nailprints in His hands and feet are the scars of terrible agony. I also give myself to Him forever, for sorrow with Him must be sweeter than any joy I have ever known."

"Then we are one in Him," they cried in gladness, "for no one but He could unite Joy and Sorrow." Therefore they walked hand in hand into the world, to follow Him through storms and sunshine, through winter's severe cold and the warmth of summer's gladness, and to be "sorrowful, yet always rejoicing."

August 20

Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him till daybreak. (Genesis 32:24)

As Jacob "fell" from his old life, he fell into the

*更神圣的回忆会升起，
就是我们聚集在黄金街道的人
必会常因感恩的爱激动下来说到
耶稣呼召我们在黑暗之日登
又窄又陟斜的山路，独倚祂同行。*

永不会有没深谷的高山，也没有不经历痛苦而诞生的生命。

但以理·哥馥

八月十九日

「似乎忧愁，却是常常快乐的。」
(林后6:10)

忧愁是美丽的，但那是月光穿越林中树木树叶枝桠般的美丽。

喜乐是美丽的，但她的美丽是散发夏日清晨之美丽的光芒。

忧伤渴望地说：「我们永不能合而为一。」就在忧愁说着时，他和喜乐都察觉到有人站在旁边。虽然光线暗淡，他们感知是王者的来临，一个大而神圣的敬畏忽尔漫过他们，他们于是屈膝跪在祂面前。

忧伤轻声说：「我见到的祂是喜乐之王，在祂头上有极多冠冕，祂手脚上的钉痕都是重大胜利的伤痕。在祂面前我所有的忧伤正在溶化和成为不死的爱和欢欣，我如今将我自己永远呈献给祂。」

喜乐柔声说：「忧伤呀，不，我见到的祂是忧伤之王，在祂头上的冠冕是荆棘之冕，祂手祂脚的钉痕都是极度痛苦的伤痕。我也叫我自己永远献给祂，因为与祂一起的忧伤总比我认识的喜乐更甜美。」

他们同声欢呼：「那么我们在祂里头是合一的了，因独有祂能叫喜乐忧伤连合。」于是他们牵手步向世界，随祂经过风暴和阳光，经过凛冽的寒冬和欢欣暖夏，成为「似乎忧愁，却是常常快乐的。」

八月二十日

「只剩下雅各布一人。有一个人来和他摔跤，直到黎明。」(创32:24)

当雅各布跌离他的旧生命时，

arms of God, clinging to Him but also wrestling until his blessing came. His blessing was that of a new life, so he rose from the earthly to the heavenly, the human to the divine, and the natural to the supernatural. From that morning forward, he was a weak and broken man from a human perspective, but God was there. And the Lord's heavenly voice proclaimed, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men and have overcome" (v. 28).

If God has called us to His highest and best, each of us will have a time of crisis, when all our resources will fail and when we face either ruin or something better than we have ever dreamed. But before we can receive the blessing, we must rely on God's infinite help. We must be willing to let go, surrendering completely to Him, and cease from our own wisdom, strength, and righteousness. We must be "crucified with Christ" (Gal. 2:20) and yet alive in Him. God knows how to lead us to the point of crisis, and He knows how to lead us through it.

And may it bring you into all that is meant by the revelation of "the Mighty One of Jacob" (Isa. 60:16)! There is no way out but God.

August 21

He brought me out into a spacious place; he rescued me because he delighted in me. (Psalm 18:19)

What is this "spacious place"? What can it be but God Himself—the infinite Being through whom all other beings find their source and their end of life? God is indeed a "spacious place." And it was through humiliation, degradation, and a sense of worthlessness that David was taken to it.

Madame Guyon

I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to myself. Exodus 19:4

August 22

The rest were to get there on planks or on pieces of the ship. In this way everyone reached land in safety. (Acts 27:44)

It is a common misconception that the Christian's walk of faith is strewn with flowers and that when God intervenes in the lives of His people, He does so in such a wonderful way as to always lift us out of our

是跌在神的手臂中，既缠且摔跤，直至他的祝福来到为止。他的祝福是一新生命，因此他从属地升进属灵；由属人升进神圣；由自然升进超自然。从那一刻起，于人看他是软弱和破碎的人，但神在那里。神自天上宣布说：「你的名不要再叫雅各布，要叫以色列，因为你与神与人较力，都得了胜。」(创32:28)

神若呼召我们到祂至高至荣美之处，我们每一个便来到所有倚靠都失效的关键时刻，所面对的不是败落便是比从来能梦想更好的东西。在我们得着祝福前，定须靠赖神无限的帮助。我们须放手，完全降服于祂，停止一己智慧、力量和义。我们必须「与基督同钉十字架」(加2:20)，却仍在祂里面活。神知如何领我们来到这关键时刻，祂也知如何领我们经过。

但愿这把你领进「雅各布的大能者」(赛60:16)所启示的全面意义！除了神之外别无出路。

八月二十一日

「祂又领我到宽阔之处。祂救拔我，因祂喜悦我。」(诗18:19)

「宽阔之处」是甚么？除了所有存在物从中得着他们的供应和生命归宿的神自己这位无限者之外，还会是谁？神真的是「宽阔之处」。大卫是藉着屈辱、贬降和感到无价值来被带到那处的。

盖恩夫人

「我如鹰将你们背在翅膀上，带来归我。」(出19:4)

八月二十二日

「其余的人，可以用板子，或船上的零碎东西上岸。这样众人都得了救上了岸。」(徒27:44)

常有误解以为基督徒信心之路花香常漫，以为有神介入其生命之人亦一样在困难的环境中总会因神奇的方法而得以脱离。但事实

difficult surroundings. In actual fact, however, the real experience is quite the opposite.

Because of his testimony given in Damascus, Paul was hunted down by persecutors and forced to flee for his life. God worked a simple way of escape for Paul: "His followers took him by night and lowered him in a basket through an opening in the wall" (Acts 9:25).

We see him left for days to toss upon a stormy sea and compelled to protect a treacherous sailor. And finally, once his deliverance comes, it is not by way of some heavenly ship sailing from the skies to rescue this illustrious prisoner. Nor is there an angel who comes walking on the water to still the raging sea. There is no supernatural sign at all of surpassing greatness being carried out, for one man is required to grab a piece of the mast to survive, another a floating timber, another a small fragment of the shipwreck, and yet another is forced to swim for his life.

God's promises and His providence do not lift us from the world of common sense and everyday trials, for it is through these very things that our faith is perfected. And it is in this world that God

loves to interweave the golden threads of His love with the twists and turns of our common, everyday experiences.

from Hard Places in the Way of Faith

August 23

By faith Abraham ... obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going. (Hebrews 11:8)

This is faith without sight. Seeing is not faith but reasoning. When crossing the Atlantic by ship, how had our course been so precisely plotted? Every day, our captain had taken his instruments, looked to the sky, and determined his course by the sun. He was sailing using heavenly lights, not earthly ones.

And the steps of faith often lead to total uncertainty or even darkness and disaster, but the Lord will open the way and often makes the darkest of midnight hours as bright as the dawning of the day.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

Remember, after the words "In the beginning" (Gen. 1:1) comes the word "God." It is our first step

上，经验上倒是恰恰相反的。

因着大马色所作的见证，保罗被迫害者追捕，被逼逃命。神用一简单的方法来叫保罗得逃脱：「他的门徒就在夜间，用筐子把他从城墙上缙下去。」（徒9:25）

我们见到他多日来在风暴的海洋中抛来抛去，被迫要保护一个不忠的水手。最终他的解救来到，却不是藉差来的天船来拯救这著名的囚犯，亦不是藉着在水上走来的天使来平静风浪。没有显赫事件，没有超自然的景象发生，只见一人需抓住桅杆来保命，另一个抓着一根浮木，又一个抓着船只残骸的破件，更有人逼住要泅水保命。

神的应许和带领不会叫我们脱离世人的常理和每天的试炼，因为正正是藉着这些东西来叫我们的信心得完全的。神就喜爱在今世用祂爱的金线与我们日常共同经历的线拧扭在一起。

摘自《信心之路》的《艰难之地》

八月二十三日

「亚伯拉罕因着信……遵命出去，……出去的时候，还不知往哪里去。」（来11:8）

这是不见的信心。看见不是信心，而是情理。有一次我乘船横渡大西洋。我们的走向何以如此精确计算？原来船长每天用仪器望向天际，藉太阳决定方向。他不是利用地上而是天上的光来航行的。

信心的步履时常引往全不肯定，甚至黑暗和灾难中去，然而主必会开辟前路，时常使午夜最黑暗的时刻变成如日出之光明。

摘自《在地若天的生活》

谨记「起初」之后就是「神」这个字（创1:1）。这就是我们信

of faith that turns the key in the lock of His powerhouse. It is true that God helps those who help themselves, but He also helps those who are helpless. So no matter your circumstance, you can depend on Him every time.

August 24

I have received full payment and even more. (Philippians 4:18)

There are Christians who seem to blossom when their material circumstances become the most harsh and severe. They grow in the darkness and shade.

When he wrote the above verse, he was a prisoner in Rome. The primary mission of his life appeared to have been broken. But it was in this persistent darkness that flowers began to show their faces in bright and fascinating glory.

Among those treasures were such wonderful things as Christ's grace, love, joy, and peace, and it seemed as though they had needed the circumstance of darkness to draw out their secret and inner glory. The dark and dingy prison had become the home of the revealed truth of God, and Paul began to realize as never before the width and the wealth of his spiritual inheritance.

"The desert and the parched land will be glad; the wilderness will rejoice and blossom" (Isa. 35:1).

John Henry Jowett

August 25

Before this faith came, we were held prisoners ... , locked up until faith should be revealed. (Galatians 3:23)

God still causes us to be "locked up until faith" is learned. Our own nature, circumstances, trials, and disappointments all serve to keep us submissive and "locked up" until we see that the only way out is His way of faith. Moses attempted the deliverance of his people by using self-effort, his personal influence, and even violence. So God "locked [him] up" for forty years in the wilderness before he was prepared for His work.

Paul and Silas were called of God to preach the gospel in Europe. In Philippi they were "severely flogged, they were thrown into prison, and the jailer ... fastened their feet in the stocks" (Acts 16:23-24). They were "locked up" to faith. They trusted God and

心的第一步，转动锁匙来开启祂能源库之门。神帮助那些帮助自己的人是对的，但祂也帮助那些无助之人。因此无论你环境如何，你也能在每刻倚靠祂。

八月二十四日

「但我样样都有，并且有余。」(腓4:18)

有基督徒在他们物质环境变得严峻和艰难时生命似乎更璀璨。他们在漆黑和幽暗中生长。

当他写以上的经文时，他是在罗马作囚犯的。他生命的首要任务似乎已被破坏了。但就在这持久的黑暗中花儿开始展现他们脸上的光明和使人艳羡的荣耀。

在这些宝藏中有美妙的东西，例如基督的恩惠、爱、喜乐与和平，这些似乎都需要黑暗的环境来提取出他们奥妙和内里的荣耀。黑暗和肮脏的囚牢已成为神彰显真理的居室。保罗开始明了到他属灵生命从来未知晓的深度和丰盛。

「旷野和干旱之地，必然欢喜；沙漠也必快乐，又像玫瑰开花。」(赛35:1)

约翰·亨利·祖屈

八月二十五日

「但这因信得救的理还未来以先，我们被看守在律法之下，直圈到那将来的真道显明出来。」(加3:23)

神一直使我们被看守直至学会信。我们自己的天性、环境、试炼和失望全都使我们降服和被看守，直至我们得见唯一的出路就是信神这路。摩西尝试藉一己之力，个人的影响力甚至藉暴力来拯救他的人民，因此神把他看守在旷野四十年，来准备作祂的工作。

保罗和西拉被呼召到欧洲传福音。他们在腓立比被「打了许多棍，便将他们下在监里，嘱咐禁卒严紧看守。……两脚上了木狗。」(徒16:23-24) 他们被看守至信。就在

sang praises to Him in their darkest hour, and God brought deliverance and salvation.

The apostle John was also “locked up” to faith, when he was banished to the Isle of Patmos. And if he had never been sent there, he would never have seen such glorious visions of God.

Praise Him “that in all things God works for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28) and that He “acts on behalf of those who wait for Him” (Isa. 64:4). God will send you blessings and help, and will reveal truths to you that otherwise would never have come your way. And many others will also receive great insights and blessings because you were “locked up” to learn the way of faith.

C. H. P.

August 26

It is not in me. (Job 28:14)

You can never expect to keep an eagle in the forest. You might be able to gather a group of the most beautiful birds around him, provide a perch for him on the tallest pine, or enlist other birds to bring him the choicest of delicacies, but he will reject them all. He will spread his proud wings and, with his eye on an Alpine cliff, soar away to his own ancestral halls of rock, where storms and waterfalls make their natural music.

Our soul longs to soar as an eagle and will find rest with nothing short of the Rock of Ages. Its ancestral halls are the halls of heaven, made with the rock of the attributes of God. And the span of its majestic flight is eternity! “Lord, YOU have been our dwelling place throughout all generations” (Ps. 90:1).

J. R. Macduff

August 27

He took him aside, away from the crowd. (Mark 7:33)

Even the most majestic bird, which soars higher than all others and endures the longest flights, will sink into despair when placed in a cage, where it is forced to helplessly beat its wings against its prison bars.

To see Paul in prison is to see another side of life. He even signed his name to his letters—not as the prisoner of Festus, nor of Caesar, and not as a victim of the Sanhedrin, but as “a prisoner for the Lord” (Eph. 4:1).

他们最黑暗之时他们信靠神而歌唱赞美祂，神也带给他们释放和拯救。

当使徒约翰被放逐到拔摩海岛时，他也被看守在信里头。他若不是送到那里，他永远不得看见神如此荣耀的异象。

为着「我们晓得万事都互相效力，叫爱神的人得益处」(罗8:28)和「为等候祂的人行事」(赛64:4)来赞美祂。神必会差来恩福和帮助，必会向你揭示真理，否则困难永不会临到你。也有多人因着你在被看守而学会信的方法，和得着极大的领悟。

C.H.P.

八月二十六日

「不在我内。」(伯28:14)

你从未曾想到在森林中饲养鹰鸟。你也许能聚集一群最美丽的鸟儿来环绕牠，为牠提供最高的松树作为牠的栖木，或征募其它雀鸟为牠带来最上选的美味，但牠会全部拒绝。牠必会伸展其骄傲之翼，把眼目注视阿尔卑斯其中一个山崖，飞向牠祖上的群石礼堂，那里风暴和瀑布成为牠们天然的音乐。

我们的灵魂期望如鹰翔，除了万古磐石外，便找不到安息之所。鹰儿的古老礼堂是天家的礼堂，是用神属性之石造成的，其王者之飞翔延展至永远！「主阿，祢世代代作我们的居所。」(诗90:1)

J.R.麦道夫

八月二十七日

「耶稣领他离开众人，到一边去。」(可7:33)

当比其它雀鸟飞得更高更长更尊贵的雀鸟被放进鸟笼时也会堕进绝望中，被逼无助地用翅膀拍打笼枝。

看着在囚房中的保罗得见生命的另一面。他在信件中的署名不是非斯都的囚犯，不是该撒的囚犯，也不是公会所逼害的，而是「为主被囚的」(弗4:1)。

For twelve long years, John Bunyan's voice was silenced in an English jail in Bedford. Yet it was there he wrote the greatest work of his life, *Pilgrim's Progress*—read by more people than any other book except the Bible. He once said, "I was at home in prison, and my great joy led me to sit and write and write." And the darkness of his long captivity became a wonderful dream to light the path of millions of weary pilgrims.

Madam Guyon, the sweet-spirited French saint, endured a lengthy time behind prison walls. And like the sounds of some caged birds whose songs are more beautiful as a result of their confinement, the music of her soul has traveled far beyond her dungeon walls to remove the sadness of many discouraged hearts.

S. C. Rees

August 28

There He tested them. (Exodus 15:25)

I once visited the testing room of a large steel mill. I was surrounded by instruments and equipment that tested pieces of steel to their limits and measured their breaking point. Some pieces had been twisted until they broke, and then were labeled with the level of pressure they could withstand. Some had been stretched to their breaking point, with their level of strength also noted. Others had been compressed to their crushing point and measured. Because of the testing, the manager of the mill knew exactly how much stress and strain each piece of steel could endure if it was used to build a ship, building, or bridge.

God wants us to be like these toughened pieces of steel, able to endure twisting and crushing pressure to the utmost without collapse.

J. H. M.

It is quite easy for us to talk and to theorize about faith, but God often puts us into His crucible of affliction to test the purity of our gold and to separate the dross from the metal. How happy we are if the hurricanes that blow across life's raging sea have the effect of making Jesus more precious to us! It is better to weather the storm with Christ than to sail smooth waters without Him.

J. R. Macduff

本仁·约翰因着囚于英国百得福监狱十二年而闭口，然而他就在那里写下他生命中最伟大的著作《天路历程》，读者人数除了圣经外比任何书籍更多。有一次他说：「在狱中就像在家一样，我的大喜乐使我坐下写完又写。」他长期囚禁的黑暗成为一奇妙的梦来照明百万计疲乏天路客的路途。

美好灵性的法国圣徒盖因夫人在囚室中忍受很长的年日，就像被囚笼中的鸟因牢笼的缘故使他们的歌儿越发美妙，盖因夫人生命的旋律越过囚牢的围墙而行，除去众多受挫心灵的忧伤。

S.C.利士

八月二十八日

「耶和华在那里……试验他们，」
(出15:25)

有一次我走访一间大钢铁工场的测试房。环绕我的仪器和器材，都是用来测试每件钢铁的极限和量度他们的折破点。有一些被扭曲至折断，之后标上他们能耐得住的压力程度，有一些被压和量度他们的毁坏点。藉着测试，工场的经理便清楚知道用来造船、大厦或桥梁的每件钢铁能耐上多少力度和拉力。

神想我们像那些强韧的钢铁件，能耐得住扭动和挤压至极而不至崩断。

J.H.M.

引经据典来谈及信颇容易，但神常把我们放入祂痛苦的熔炉中来测试我们金子的纯度，和将金属中的浮渣分隔出来。吹袭我们生命怒海上的飓风叫耶稣于我们更珍贵时，这是何等快乐啊！与基督一起来经受暴风总好过祂不同在的情况下风平浪静的航行。

J.R.麦道夫

August 29

Carrying his own cross. (John 19:17)

A weary woman who thought that the cross she must bear surely was heavier than those of other people, so she wished she could choose another person's instead. The most beautiful one was covered with jewels and gold. "This I could wear with comfort," she said. So she picked it up, but her weak body staggered beneath its weight. The jewels and gold were beautiful, yet they were much too heavy for her to carry.

The next cross she noticed was quite lovely, with beautiful flowers entwined around its sculptured form, but beneath the flowers were large thorns that pierced and tore her skin.

Finally she came to a plain cross without jewels or any carvings and with only a few words of love inscribed on it. When she picked it up, it proved to be better than all the rest, and the easiest to carry. And as she looked at it, she noticed it was bathed in a radiance that fell from heaven. Then she recognized it as her own old cross. She had found it once again, and it was the best of all, and the lightest for her.

from Glimpses through Life's Windows

August 30

Others went out on the sea in ships; they were merchants on the mighty waters. They saw the works of the Lord, his wonderful deeds in the deep. (Psalm 107:23-24)

Remember, our faith is always at its greatest point when we are in the middle of the trial, and confidence in the flesh will never endure testing. Fair-weather faith is not faith at all.

Charles H. Spurgeon

August 31

Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed. (John 20:29)

How important it is for God to keep us focused on things that are unseen, for we are so easily snared by the things we can see! If a bird is going to fly, it must stay away from fences and trees, trusting the buoyancy of its wings. And if it tries to stay within easy reach of the ground, it will never fly very well.

God had to bring Abraham to the end of his own

八月二十九日

「*背着自己的十字架。*」(约19:17)

一个疲惫的妇人想到她所背负的肯定重过他人的十字架，因此她想望能选择别人的十字架。她选择那最美丽的一个是镶满珠宝和黄金的。她便说：「这个我能舒服地背负。」于是她去拿起，但她软弱的身躯在其重量下摇晃。珠宝和金子是美丽的，但于她来说背负实在太沉重了。

第二个她所留意的十字架颇为可爱，四围刻满美丽的花儿，但在花儿下面有大荆棘刺破她的皮肤。

最后她来到一个平平无奇，既没珠宝或雕刻，只写上几个爱的字词的十字架。她拿起它，证实好过其余一切，也最轻易背负。她看见和注意到它沐浴在从天来的光中，之后她察觉它就是她本来的旧十字架。她再次找着它，它也是众多十字架中最好，最轻省的。

摘自《窥探生命之窗》

八月三十日

「*在海上坐船，在大水中经理事务的。他们看见耶和华的作为，并祂在深水中的奇事。*」(诗107:23-24)

谨记，我们的信总是在我们来到试炼时才去到顶峰，肉体中的确定永不能忍受试炼。风平浪静的信心完全不是信心。

司布真

八月三十一日

「*那没有看见就信的，有福了。*」(约20:29)

我们太容易陷在我们可见事物的圈套中，因此神叫我们持续聚焦在不可见事物何等重要！雀鸟要飞翔便须离开树篱，相信牠双翼的浮力；牠若尝试与地面保持可触碰的距离时，便永不会飞得好。

神要领亚伯拉罕来到他能力

strength and let him see that with his own body he could do nothing. He had to consider his own body “as good as dead” (Heb. 11:12) and then trust God to do all the work. When he looked away from himself and trusted only God, he became “fully persuaded that God had power to do what he had promised” (Rom. 4:21).

A. B. Simpson

September 1

I will build you with stones of turquoise. (Isaiah 54:11)

The stones in the wall said, “We have come from mountains far away—from the sides of rugged cliffs. Fire and water have worked on us for ages but have only produced crevices. Yet human hands like yours have made us into homes where children of your immortal race are born, suffer, rejoice, find rest and shelter, and learn the lessons that our Maker and yours is teaching. But to come to the point of being used for this purpose, we have endured much. Dynamite has torn at our very heart, and pickaxes have broken and split us into pieces. Often as we lay disfigured and broken in the quarry, everything seemed to be without design or meaning. But gradually we were cut into blocks, and some of us were chiseled with sharper instruments until we had a fine edge. Now we are complete, are in our proper places, and are of service.

September 2

It has been granted to you ... to suffer for him. (Philippians 1:29)

Richard Baxter, the seventeenth-century Puritan preacher, once said, “O God, I thank You for the discipline I have endured in this body for fifty-eight years.” And he certainly is not the only person who has turned trouble into triumph. Soon the school of our heavenly Father will close for us, for the end of the school term is closer every day. May we never run from a difficult lesson or flinch from the rod of discipline. Richer will be our crown, and sweeter will heaven be, if we cheerfully endure to the end. Then we will graduate in glory.

Theodore L. Cuyler

的尽头，让他得见他自己身体无可作为了。他必须看他一己的身体「彷彿已死的人」(来11:12)，便在一件事上完全信靠神了。当他不再看自己，只信靠神时，他便变得「满心相信，神所应许的必能作成。」(罗4:21)

宣信

九月一日

「我必以彩色安置你的石头，以蓝宝石立定你的根基。」(赛54:11)

墙上的石头说：「我们来自远方高山那巍峨的悬崖边。火与水世纪以来作工在我们身上，但只做成裂缝。然而像你有的人手把我们改造，放进家室中，你不朽种族的儿女在那里出生、受苦、欢欣，找到安息和荫庇，学会了造你造我之创造主的教训。但若要进一步去到在这目的下被使用这点时，我们定须忍受更多。炸药在我们心中炸裂，鹤咀铤把心锄开，破成碎片。我们在石坑中长时在破相和碎裂下摊放着，每一个似乎都没设计和意义。但渐渐地我们被分割成石料，我们有些被更锋利的器具削凿，直至我们边锤圆滑了。如今我们完备了，安放合适的地方，有用武之地了。

九月二日

「因为你们蒙恩.....要为祂受苦。」(腓1:29)

十七世纪清教徒传道者李察·巴克斯特曾说：「神啊，为着五十八年来祢叫我在這身体上所忍受的管教来感谢祢。」肯定他不是唯一一人能把困难变成胜利。不久天父的学校会为我们而关闭，因为学期结束一天近似一天了。愿我们永不逃避困难的课堂，在管教杖下退缩；我们若欢欣忍耐到底，那么冠冕便更荣美，天家必会甜美了，那时我们便会在荣耀中毕业。

西奥多·L·佳拿

The world's finest china is fired in ovens at

世上最优美的瓷器最少在炉

least three times, and some many more. It is necessary to fire the china three times so the gold, crimson, and other colors are brighter, more beautiful, and permanently attached.

Cortland Myers

September 3

He saw the disciples straining at the oars. (Mark 6:48)

Straining and striving does not accomplish the work God gives us to do. Only God Himself, who always works without stress and strain and who never overworks, can do the work He assigns to His children. When we restfully trust Him to do it, the work will be completed and will be done well. And the way to let Him do His work through us is to so fully abide in Christ by faith that He fills us to overflowing.

A man who learned this secret once said, "I came to Jesus and drank, and I believe I will never be thirsty again. My life's motto has become 'Not overwork but overflow,' and it has already made all the difference in my life."

There is no straining effort in an overflowing life, and it is quietly irresistible. It is the normal life of omnipotent and ceaseless accomplishment into which Christ invites each of us to enter—today and always.

from Sunday School Times

September 4

When you hear them sound a long blast on the trumpets, have all the people give a loud shout; then the wall of the city will collapse and the people will go up, every man straight in. (Joshua 6:5)

Of all "the secret[s] of the Lord" (Ps. 25:14 KJV), I do not believe there are any more valuable than the secret of this "loud shout" of faith. "The Lord said to Joshua, 'See, I have delivered Jericho into your hands, along with its king and its fighting men'" (Josh. 6:2).

No one would normally believe that a shout could cause city walls to fall. Yet the secret of their victory lay precisely in just that shout, for it was the shout of faith.

God had declared, "I have delivered Jericho into your hands," and faith believed this to be true. And many centuries later the Holy Spirit recorded this triumph of faith in the book of Hebrews as follows: "By faith the walls of Jericho fell, after the people had

中烧过三遍，有些更多。需要火烧三次来使金色、绯红色和其它颜色更鲜明、更美丽和更永久黏附。

科特兰·迈尔斯

九月三日

「看见门徒，因风不顺，摇橹甚苦。」(可6:48)

劳苦和奋力不能作成神给我们作的工。惟有从来在没有压力和紧张下作工和永不会过劳的神自己能作成祂指派给祂儿女的工作。当我们安心信靠祂来作时，那工必会完成，且会做得好。让祂藉我们作成祂工，就是用信来完全住在基督里，让祂充满我们至溢泻。

一个学会这秘诀之人曾说：「我来到耶稣处饮用，相信我永不再渴。我生命的座右铭『不是过劳，而是满溢』，自此我生命便完全改变了。」

满溢生命中没有劳苦拉力，而有静中坚强。基督邀请我们每个进入事事皆能和不停成就工夫的正常生命，今日如是，永远如是。

摘自《主日学报》

九月四日

「他们吹的角声拖长，你们听见角声，众百姓要大声呼喊，城墙就必塌陷，各人都要往前直上。」(书6:5)

在「耶和華的秘密」(诗25:14)中，没有比耶和華对乔舒亚所说信的呼喊更有价值。「看哪！我已经把耶利哥和耶利哥的王，并大能的勇士都交在你手中。」(书6:2)

通常没有人会相信呼喊能叫城墙倒塌。然而他们得胜的秘密正正在于呼喊，因为那是信心的呼喊。

神曾宣告：「我已经把耶利哥交在你手中。」信心相信这是真的。多个世纪后圣灵在希伯来书记录这信心的得胜：「以色列人因着信，围绕耶利哥城七日，城墙就倒

marched around them for seven days” (Heb. 11:30).
Hannah Whitall Smith

September 5

Blessed are all who wait for him! (Isaiah 30:18)

We often hear about waiting on God, which actually means that He is waiting until we are ready. There is another side, however. When we wait for God, we are waiting until He is ready.

Some people say, and many more believe, that as soon as we meet all His conditions, God will answer our prayer. They teach that He lives in an eternal now, that with Him there is no past or future, and that if we can fulfill all He requires to be obedient to His will, immediately our needs will be met, our desires satisfied, and our prayers answered.

A petition presented to God is like a seed dropped into the ground. Forces above and beyond our control must work on it until the actual accomplishment of the answer.

from The Still Small Voice

And Patience was willing to wait.

from Pilgrim's Progress

September 6

You remain. (Hebrews 1:11)

There are so many people sit alone so much, but there is someone who is unseen and just within their reach. But for some reason, they don't realize His presence. The rain or thick fog outside, the lack of sleep and the intense pain, seem to affect their mood and blur their vision so they do not realize His presence.

So recognize the presence of the Master. He is here, close to you, and His presence is real. Recognizing will also help your ability to realize but is never dependent upon it.

Samuel Dickey Gordon

September 7

God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. (Psalm 46:1)

“Why didn't God help me sooner?” “I will be with him in trouble, I will deliver him and honor him” (Ps.

塌了。」(来11:30)
汉纳·韦滔·史勿夫

九月五日

「凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」(赛30:18)

我们常听人说等候神，其实是祂等候我们，直到我们准备好。但有另一方面的。当我们等候神时，我们是在等候直至祂准备好。

有人说和多人相信，我们一旦符合神的条件时，祂必会垂听我们的祈祷。他们教导说祂活在永存的现今，就是说于祂来说是没有过去和未来的；并且我们若能在一切事上服从祂的旨意时，我们必立时得所需，愿望得满足，祈祷得回应。

向神献上的祈求就像落在地上的种子一样，必须有在我们上头和我们控制能力以外的能力来作工，直到这代求得着实在的成就。

摘自《那温柔的微声》

忍耐是乐意等候的。

摘自《天路历程》

九月六日

「祢却要长存。」(来1:11)

有太多人久久独坐，然而有一个看不见却在他们可接触的范围内。但为着某些原因，他们不知道祂的同在。外头的雨水或厚雾、睡眠不足和剧烈痛楚似乎都影响到他们的情绪，弄至他们视觉模糊，因而不知道祂的同在。

承认主的同在吧。祂就在这里，与你相近，因此祂的同在是真实的。承认也必会使你有知道的能力，不过不用再倚赖它吧了。

塞缪尔·迪奇·哥顿

九月七日

「神是我们的避难所，是我们的力量，是我们在患难中随时的帮助。」(诗46:1)

「为何神不早点来帮助我？」
「他在急难中，我要与他同在。我

91:15). He will be with you in trouble all day and through the night. Afterward He will take you out of it, but not until you have stopped being restless and worried over it and have become calm and quiet. Then He will say, "It is enough."

There is a sweet joy and a real value in difficulties, for He regards them not as difficulties but as opportunities.

selected

When God tests you, it is a good time to test Him by putting His promises to the test and then claiming from Him exactly what your trials have made necessary.

There are two ways of getting out of a trial. One is simply to try to get rid of the trial, and then to be thankful when it is over. The other is to recognize the trial as a challenge from God to claim a larger blessing than we have ever before experienced, and to accept it with delight as an opportunity of receiving a greater measure of God's divine grace.

In this way, even the Adversary becomes a help to us, and all the things that seem to be against us turn out to assist us along our way. "In all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us" (Rom. 8:37).

A. B. Simpson

September 8

Thou hast enlarged me when I was in distress. (Psalm 4:1 KJV)

The psalmist is declaring that the sorrows of life have themselves been the source of life's enlargement.

When Joseph, who had only experienced the glitter of gold, was in the dungeon, "iron entered his soul."

Your life will be enlarged in proportion to the amount of iron you have endured, for it is in the shadows of your life that you will find the actual fulfillment of your dreams of glory.

George Matheson

If Joseph had never been Egypt's prisoner, he would have never been Egypt's governor. The iron chain that bound his feet brought about the golden chain around his neck.

要搭救他，使他尊贵。」(诗91:15) 你遇上困难时祂终日终夜必与你同在，把你从中带出来，就在你停止坐立不安和终日担忧，已平静安稳之时。那时祂必说：「够了。」

困惑中是有甜美的喜乐和其价值的，因为祂不以他们为困难，而是机会。

选

当神试炼我时，这也是试验祂的好时机，试验一下祂的应许。正照所受的试炼来向祂索求便变得有其需要。

有两个方法得脱离试炼。其一简单不过，尝试除去那试炼，当试炼过去后便献上感谢。另一方法是认定那试炼是来自神的挑战，叫你索求我们从未经验过的大恩福，欣然接受那试炼作为一个机遇来获取神更大程度的圣恩。

这样的话，连仇敌魔鬼也成为我们的帮助，所有似乎与我们作对的东西转过来沿途帮助我们。「然而靠着爱我们的主，在这一切的事上，已经得胜有余了。」(罗8:37)

宣信

九月八日

「我在困苦中，祢曾使我宽广。」(诗4:1)

诗人宣称人生忧伤本身成为人生扩展之源。

当前期只经历过金子光辉的约瑟在囚牢中时，「铁进入了他的生命」。

你生命的扩展与你曾受的苦成正比，因为是你生命中所投的黑影才能找着你梦想荣耀的真正成就。

乔治·马得胜

若约瑟未曾作过埃及的囚犯，他便永不能成为埃及的宰相。是锁铐他的铁链为他带来围绕他颈项的金炼。

September 9

Some [seed] fell on rocky places, where it did not have much soil. It sprang up quickly, because the soil was shallow. (Matthew 13:5)

The shallow people are those who “did not have much soil”—those who have no real purpose in life and are easily swayed by a tender appeal, a good sermon, or a simple melody.

When a Roman soldier was told by his guide that if he insisted on taking a certain journey, it would probably be fatal, he answered, “It is necessary for me to go—it is not necessary for me to live.”

Once God has deepened us, He can give us His deepest truths, His most profound secrets, and will trust us with greater power.

September 10

The Lord will fulfill his purpose for me. (Psalm 138:8)

When a person who suffers reaches a point where he can be calm and carefree, inwardly smiling at his own suffering, and no longer asking God to be delivered from it, then the suffering has accomplished its blessed ministry, perseverance has “finish[ed] its work” (James 1:4), and the pain of the Crucifixion has begun to weave itself into a crown. It is in this experience of complete suffering that the Holy Spirit works many miraculous things deep within our soul. In this condition, our entire being lies perfectly still under the hand of God; every power and ability of the mind, will, and heart are at last submissive; a quietness of eternity settles into the entire soul.

He can now let the circumstances be what they may, and continue to seek only God and His will, with the calm assurance that He is causing everything in the universe, whether good or bad, past or present, to work “for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28).

from Soul Food

The main thing is to suffer without becoming discouraged.

François Fénelon

九月九日

「有落在土浅石头地上的。土既不深，发苗最快。」(太13:5)

浅薄的人「土既不深」，他们没真正的生命目标，轻易被一个亲切的呼吁、一堂好讲道、或一简单的旋律所动摇。

当一个罗马士兵被指挥官问到若硬要他走某个可能致命的旅程时会如何，他回答说：「我必须要去，但我不是必须去活。」

神一旦使我们进深，必会给我们祂最深的真理和最深度秘诀，也必会把更大的能力交托我们。

九月十日

「耶和華必成全关乎我的事。」(诗138:8)

当一个受苦的人来到他能够平静和处之泰然，内里笑向他一己的受苦，不再求神来叫他得脱离这苦时，那么这苦已成就它赐恩的任务，坚忍已「成功」(雅1:4)，钉十字架的痛楚已开始把自己编织成为一个冠冕了。就是这样经历完全的受苦叫圣灵在我们的生命深处作成很多奇妙的工作。在这情况下，我们的整位完全在神的手下静止，思想、意志和心的每一个力量和能力都至终呈献，一个永恒的宁静居住在整個生命之中。

他如今能任让环境如何，继续但但寻求神和祂的旨意，平实确定是祂使宇宙中的无论善恶、过去或现在的万事万物，作成「叫爱神的人得益处」(罗8:28)

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摘自《灵魂的食物》

在不致沮丧下受苦才是大事。

范哥·费尼南

September 11

After waiting patiently, Abraham received what was promised. (Hebrews 6:15)

Abraham was tested for a very long time, but he was richly rewarded. The Lord tested him by delaying the fulfillment of His promise. Satan tested him through temptation, and people tested him through their jealousy, distrust, and opposition to him. Sarah tested him through her worrisome temperament. Yet he patiently endured, not questioning God's truthfulness and power or doubting God's faithfulness and love. Instead, Abraham submitted to God's divine sovereignty and infinite wisdom. And he was silent through many delays, willing to wait for the Lord's timing. Having patiently endured, he then obtained the fulfillment of the promise.

selected

September 12

Who is this coming up from the desert leaning on her lover? (Song of Songs 8:5)

As one man prayed, he asked the Lord for various blessings, just as you or I would, and he thanked the Lord for many blessings already received, just as you or I would. But he closed his prayer with this unusual petition: "And O Lord, support us! Yes, support us on every leaning side!"

He saw God as always walking alongside the Christian, ready to extend His mighty arm to steady the weak on "every leaning side."

September 13

In the morning ... come up.... Present yourself to me there on top of the mountain. (Exodus 34:2)

Blessed is the day when the morning is sanctified—set apart to God! Successful is the day when the first victory is won in prayer! Holy is the day when the dawn finds me on the mountaintop with God!

Joseph Parker

My mother made it a habit every day, immediately after breakfast, to spend an hour in her room, reading the Bible, meditating over it, and praying to the Lord. That hour was like a blessed fountain from which she drew the strength and

九月十一日

「这样，亚伯拉罕既恒久忍耐，就得了所应许的。」(来6:15)

亚伯拉罕被试炼了一段长时间，但得的也是丰富的奖赏。主藉迟延成就祂所应许的来试炼他，撒但藉引诱来试探他，人们也试探他，是藉他们对他的嫉妒、猜疑和反对。撒拉藉着使人厌烦的脾气来试探他。然而他耐性地忍受，不质问神的诚信和权力，也不质疑神的信实和爱。反之，亚伯拉罕降服于神的神圣主权和无限智慧。在众多的迟延中他都是沉默的，甘心按主的定时来等候。因着耐性的忍受，他便得着应许的成就。

选

九月十二日

「那靠着良人从旷野上来的，是谁呢？」(歌8:5)

有一个人祈祷，像你我一样为着不同的恩福来祈求主；像你我一样为众多已得的恩福来感谢主。但他祷告的结束有这不寻常的祈求：「主啊，支持我们！是的，在每一个倾跌的那边支持我们！」

他见到神如常的傍着基督徒在行走，准备好伸出祂大能的膀臂在「倾跌的那边」稳托每个弱者。

九月十三日

「明日早晨，你要预备好了，上西乃山，在山顶上站在我面前。」(出34:2)

因早晨拨留给神而得圣化之日是何等蒙福！藉祈祷而得第一项胜利的那日是何等成功的一日！黎明时在山顶与神相会的一日是何等神圣的一日！

约瑟·柏加

我母亲有一个每天的习惯，在早餐后立即用一个小时进到她的房子中，读圣经，默想和祷告主。这小时就像一个恩泉，使她从中汲取力量和甜美，叫她准备好来完成

sweetness that prepared her to complete all her tasks. It also enabled her to maintain a genuine peacefulness in spite of the normal trying worries and pettiness that so often accompany life in a crowded neighborhood.

I never saw her lose her temper or speak even one word in anger. I never heard her participate in idle gossip or make a disparaging remark about another person. In fact, I never saw in her even the hint of an emotion unbecoming to someone who had drunk from "the river of the water of life" (Rev. 22:1) and who had eaten of "the living bread that came down from heaven" (John 6:51).

Frederick William Farrar

Give God the fresh blossom of the day. Never make Him wait until the petals have faded.

September 14

If anyone would come after me, he must deny himself and take up his cross and follow me. (Mark 8:34)

The cross that my Lord calls me to carry may assume many different shapes. I may have to be content with mundane tasks in a limited area of service, when I may believe my abilities are suited for much greater work. I may be required to continually cultivate the same field year after year, even though it yields no harvest whatsoever. I may be asked of God to nurture kind and loving thoughts about the very person who has wronged me and to speak gently to him, take his side when others oppose him, and bestow sympathy and comfort to him. I may have to openly testify of my Master before those who do not want to be reminded of Him or His claims. And I may be called to walk through this world with a bright, smiling face while my heart is breaking.

He draws close to me in order to mature my wisdom, deepen my peace, increase my courage, and supplement my power. All this He does so that through the very experience that is so painful and distressing to me, I will be of greater use to others. And then I will echo these words of one of the Scottish Covenantors of the seventeenth century, imprisoned for his faith by John Graham of Claverhouse—"I grow under the load."

Alexander Smellie

她所有的工作。这也使她能保持一真正的平安，就算在拥挤的邻舍中，生活伴随的日常难忍焦虑和琐事中也能够。

我从没见过她发脾气，甚至一个发怒的字词也未曾出过她口。我从未听过她讲别人是非，或作出贬损他人的描述。事实上我从未见她有任何不体面的感情流露，她就是这样的一个饮于「一道生命水的河」(启22:1)和吃「从天上降下来生命的粮」(约6:51)的人。

弗特烈·威廉·法拉

将一日之清新绽放给神，不要使祂等到花瓣都凋残之时。

九月十四日

「若有人要跟从我，就当舍己，背起他的十字架来跟从我。」(可8:34)

主呼召我去背负的十字架可能有很多不同的体现。我可能满足于在有限范围下的尘世事务，而我也许相信我的能力是适合于多得多的工作。我也许需要年复一年持续耕种同一块田地，甚或它毫无收成。神也许要求我向误解我的人培育仁慈和爱心的思想，和柔声跟他说话，在他人反对他时站在他那方，给予他同情和安慰。我也许要在那些不愿提及神和祂主张的人面前公开见证我的主。我也许被呼召在心碎时以光明和微笑在世上行走。

祂就近来为的是使我在智慧上成熟，在平安上深进，增加我的勇气，增补我的能力。祂作的这一切为叫我藉着这些如此痛苦和苦恼的经历来叫我于别人更有用。那时我便不断重复一个十七世纪被囚苏格兰长老会拥护者加拿候士之约翰·加威的信心宣言：「我在重担下成长。」

亚历山大·史美利

September 15

Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. (Song of Songs 4:16)

The juice of the aloe plant has a bitter taste but is soothing when applied to the skin, so it tells us of the sweetness of bitter things, the bittersweet, having an important application that only those who have used it will understand. Myrrh is symbolic of death, having been used to embalm the dead. It represents the sweetness that comes to the heart after it has died to self-will, pride, and sin.

What inexpressible charm seems to encircle some Christians, simply because they carry upon their pure countenance and gentle spirit the imprint of the cross! It is the holy evidence of having died to something that was once proud and strong but is now forever surrendered at the feet of Jesus.

Finally, frankincense was a fragrance that arose only after being touched with fire. It symbolizes a person's heart whose sweetness has been brought forth by the flames of affliction until the holy, innermost part of the soul is filled with clouds of praise and prayer.

from The Love-Life of Our Lord

September 16

Hide in the Kerith Ravine. (1 Kings 17:3)

And happy is the person who can reply to the Lord, "Your will is also mine. Therefore I run to hide myself in You. 'I long to dwell in your tent forever and take refuge in the shelter of your wings' [Ps. 61:4]."

Lancelot Andrews, a bishop of the Church of England and one of the translators of the King James Bible of 1611, experienced his "Kerith Ravine," in which he spent five hours of every day in prayer and devotion to God. John Welsh, a contemporary of Andrews, and a Presbyterian who was imprisoned for his faith by James VI of Scotland, also had his "ravine." He believed his day to be wasted if he did not spend eight to ten hours of isolated communion with God. David Brainerd's "ravine" was the forests of North America while he served as a pioneer missionary to the American Indians during the eighteenth century. And Christmas Evans, a preacher of the

九月十五日

「北风阿，兴起。南风阿，吹来。吹在我的园内，使其中的香气发出来。」（歌4:16）

沉香植物的汁液味苦，但当敷用在皮肤上时却能减轻痛楚，因此它向我们述说苦物中的甜美——苦甜，于那些明白之人来说有着重要的应用价值。没药象征死亡，一直以来用来裹尸防腐，它描绘临到在一己意愿、骄傲和罪上死的心中的甜美。

有一些基督徒有似乎说不出的魅力，只因他们展露他们十字架所刻划的纯洁面容和温驯的灵！这是在从前是骄傲和强悍下已死的明证，如今已永远降服在耶稣的脚前。

最后，乳香是只有在火烧下才发出其香气的。这象征着某人心中的甜美已因哀伤的火焰被带到充满赞美和祈祷烟云的神圣，生命最深入之处。

摘自《爱——我们主的生命》

九月十六日

「藏在约但河东边的基立溪旁。」（王上17:3）

能对主说「祢的旨意就是我的旨意，因此我跑来把自己藏在祢里头」的是快乐的人。「我要永远住在祢的帐幕里。我要投靠在祢翅膀下的隐密处。」（诗61:4）

其中一个1611年圣经英皇钦定本的翻译者圣公会的兰斯洛特·加龙省·安德鲁斯（Lancelot Andrews）主教，每天花五小时去祈祷敬拜神来经历基立溪旁。与他同时代的长老会约翰·威尔殊，为信仰被苏格兰的詹姆士六世囚禁也成了他的深溪。他以为没花八至十小时与神单独相交的是浪费的一天。大卫·布莱纳的溪旁就在北美洲的森林，他在十八世纪那时作为先驱服事那些美国印第安人。而十八世纪末，十九世纪初的传道者

late-eighteenth and early-nineteenth centuries, had his long and lonely journeys through the hills of Wales.

The Isle of Patmos, the solitude of the Roman prisons, the Arabian Desert, and the hills and valleys of Palestine are all as enduringly memorable as those experienced by the people who have shaped our modern world.

Our Lord Himself lived through His “Kerith Ravine” in Nazareth, in the wilderness of Judea, amid the olive trees of Bethany, and in the solitude of the city of Gadara. So none of us is exempt from a “ravine” experience, where the sounds of human voices are exchanged for the waters of quietness that flow from the throne of God, and where we taste the sweetness and soak up the power of a life “hidden with Christ” (Col. 3:3).

From Elijah, by F. B. Meyer

September 17

He is the Lord; let Him do what is good in His eyes. (1 Samuel 3:18)

Perhaps the circumstances causing my sorrows will not be removed and my situation will remain the same, but if Christ is brought into my grief and gloom as my Lord and Master, He will “surround me with songs of deliverance” (Ps. 32:7). To see Him and to be sure that His wisdom and power never fail and His love never changes, to know that even His most distressing dealings with me are for my deepest spiritual gain, is to be able to say in the midst of bereavement, sorrow, pain, and loss, “The Lord gave and the Lord has taken away; may the name of the Lord be praised” (Job 1:21).

Seeing God in everything is the only thing that will make me loving and patient with people who annoy and trouble me. Then I will see others as the instruments God uses to accomplish His tender and wise purpose for me, and I will even find myself inwardly thanking them for the blessing they have become to me. Nothing but seeing God will completely put an end to all complaining and thoughts of rebellion.

Hannah Whitall Smith

September 18

克瑞斯马·伊凡思在威尔士的山间作他长长孤单的旅程。

拔摩海岛、偏僻的罗马监狱、阿拉伯旷野、巴勒斯坦的山区和山谷，全都永志不忘，这些人的经验也曾塑造我们现今的世界。

我们主自己活在拿撒勒、犹太旷野、伯大尼的橄榄树间，和独自在加大拉城祂自己的基立溪旁。因此我们无人可免于溪旁的经历，那儿人声换作静静的流水，从神的宝座流出来；在那儿我们得尝甜美，汲取「与基督一同藏在神里面」(西 3:3) 的生命大能。

摘自迈尔著的《伊莱贾》

九月十七日

「这是出于耶和华，愿祂凭自己的意旨而行。」(撒 3:18)

也许致使我忧伤的环境没有被移除，我所处的处境依然不变，若带我进入忧伤和悲哀的是作为我主和主人的基督时，祂必会「以得救的乐歌，四面环绕我。」(诗 32:7) 得见和确定祂的智慧和能力永不失误，祂的爱永不改变，认识祂最叫我苦痛的举动必是为着我最深属灵的益处，以致在丧亲、忧伤、痛苦和损失中能说「赏赐的是耶和华，收取的也是耶和华。耶和华的名是应当称颂的。」(伯 1:21)

唯一使我们爱和忍耐那些使我愁烦和苦恼的人的是在凡事上得见神。那么我必会看别人为神用来叫我成就祂亲切和智慧目的的工具，我甚至察觉到我内里为着他们来感谢，因为他们已成为我的祝福。除了得见神之外，没有别的东西能完全结束所有埋怨和反叛的思想。

汉纳·韦滔·史勿夫

九月十八日

Where there is no vision, the people perish. (Proverbs 29:18 KJV)

Waiting upon God is vital in order to see Him and receive a vision from Him. And the amount of time spent before Him is also critical. For God's vision to be impressed on our hearts, we must sit in stillness at His feet for quite a long time. Remember, the troubled surface of a lake will not reflect an image.

Seeing God always transforms human life. Jacob "crossed the ford of the Jabbok" (Gen. 32:22), saw God, and became Israel. Seeing a vision of God transformed Gideon from a coward into a courageous soldier. And Thomas, after seeing Christ, was changed from a doubting follower into a loyal, devoted disciple.

William Carey, English pioneer missionary of the eighteenth century who is considered by some to be the Father of Modern Missions, saw God and left his shoemaker's bench to go to India. David Livingstone saw God and left everything in Britain behind to become a missionary and explorer, following the Lord's leading through the thickest jungles of Africa during the nineteenth century.

Dr. Pardington

And whenever the sounds of the world subside in our soul, we hear the whispering of God. Yes, He continues to whisper to us, but we often do not hear Him because of the noise and distractions caused by the hurried pace of our life.

Frederick William Faber

September 19

My Father is the gardener. (John 15:1)

And whenever a time of deep pruning comes and the knife cuts deeply and the pain is severe, what an inexpressible comfort it is to know: "My Father is the gardener."

When the new gardener came to a large greenhouse here, he cut them completely down to the stalk. I allowed him to do so, and we had no grapes for two years, but now clusters of luscious grapes are hanging on each side."

J. R. Miller

September 20

Did I not tell you that if you believed, you would see the

「没有异象，民就放肆。」（箴 29:18）

若要想得见神和得着从祂而来的异象，等候神是必不可少的。在祂面前所用时间的多寡也是关键的，因神的异象印在我们心中，我们定须长时间静坐祂脚前。谨记，弄皱的湖面必不能反照影像。

得见神总能改换人生。雅各布「过了雅博渡口」（创32:22）后得见神，成为以色列。得见神的异象改换基甸，由一个懦夫变成一个勇敢的士兵。多马得见基督之后便由一猜疑的追随者变成一个忠心、献身的门徒。

被认为是现代宣教工作之父十八世纪的英国宣教士先驱威廉·克理，得见神和离开造鞋的工作枱而往印度去。十九世纪的大卫·李文斯敦得见神和离开英国的一切东西，成为一个宣教士和探险家，跟着主的引导穿越厚密的非洲森林。

栢定剩博士

每当世界的声音在我们的魂里沉寂下来时，便得听神的微声。是的，祂持续向我们细语，但我们常时听不到祂，因我们生命中急促的步伐造成噪音和分心。

弗雷德里克·威廉·费柏

九月十九日

「我父是栽培的人。」（约15:1）

每当修剪至深的时刻来到时，刀锋深切，痛苦剧烈，但当知道「我父是栽培的人」时是说不出的安慰。

当新园丁来到大温室时，完全割下所有葡萄直至留下梗枝，两年来都没有葡萄，带来如今两旁挂满甘甜的葡萄串。」

J.R.米勒

九月二十日

「我不是对你说过，你若信，就必

glory of God? (John 11:40)

Mary and Martha could not understand what their Lord was doing. Each of them had said to Him, "Lord, if you had been here, my brother would not have died." (vv. 21,32).

Abraham could not understand why God would ask him to sacrifice his son, but he trusted Him. Then he saw the Lord's glory when the son he loved was restored to him. Moses could not understand why God would require him to stay forty years in the wilderness, but he also trusted Him. Then he saw when God called him to lead Israel from Egyptian bondage.

Joseph could not understand his brothers' cruelty toward him, the false testimony of a treacherous woman, or the long years of unjust imprisonment, but he trusted God and finally he saw His glory in it all. And Joseph's father, Jacob, could not understand how God's strange providence could allow Joseph to be taken from him. Yet later he saw the Lord's glory when he looked into the face of his son, who had become the governor for a great king and the person used to preserve his own life and the lives of an entire nation.

J. H. M.

September 21

I consider everything a loss compared to the surpassing greatness of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. (Philippians 3:8)

This is its solemn message: "You must die in order to live. You must refuse to consider your own comfort and well-being. You must be crucified, not only to your desires and habits that are obviously sinful but also to many others that may appear to be innocent and right. If you desire to save others, you cannot save yourself, and if you desire to bear much fruit, you must be buried in darkness and solitude."

When the words are from Jesus, may I remind myself that it is my great privilege to enter into "the fellowship of sharing in his sufferings" (Phil. 3:10) and I am therefore in great company. May I also remind myself that all the suffering is designed to make me a vessel suitable for His use. And may I remember that His Calvary blossomed into abundant fruitfulness, and so will mine.

看见神的荣耀么？」(约11:40)

马利亚和马太不明白主所作的。他们各自曾对祂说：「你若早在这里，我兄弟必不死。」(约11:21,32)

亚伯拉罕不能明白为何神要他献上他的儿子，但他信靠祂。之后他得见主的荣耀，就在他得回所爱的儿子之时。摩西不明白为何神需要他留在旷野四十年，但他也信靠祂。之后祂得见神，就在祂被呼召去领以色列人脱离埃及为奴之家时。

约瑟不明白他的兄弟为何如何残忍对待他，那个奸诈妇人的假见证，和长年不公平的囚禁；但他信靠神和最终得见这一切当中神的荣耀。而约瑟的父亲雅各布不明白神何等奇妙的旨意能容许约瑟从他处被带离，然而之后他得见主的荣耀，就在他得见他儿子的脸面时，他已成为一个伟大国王的宰相，也成为保存他自己和整个国度的生命之人。

J.H.M.

九月二十一日

「我也将万事当作有损的，因我以认识我主基督耶稣为至宝。」(腓3:8)

其严肃信息是：「你定须死才能得生，你定须拒绝想到你一己的舒适和好处。不只在你的热爱和习惯所作明显的罪恶上，在众多可能似乎是无害和正直的事上你也定须钉十字架。你若渴想拯救别人，你便不能救自己；你若渴想结更多果子，你定须被埋在黑暗和孤独中。」

既然话是出于耶稣的口，那么我当提醒自己「晓得和祂一同受苦」(腓3:10)是我的重大殊荣，我也因此有众多的同路人。我也当提醒自己这一切的痛苦是设计来使我成为一合祂用的器皿。我当谨记祂的加略山最终能长出累累的果子，我的加略山也是一样。

Pain leads to plenty, and death to life—it is the law of the kingdom!

from In the Hour of Silence

Do we call it dying when a bud blossoms into a flower?

selected

September 22

Satan has asked to sift you as wheat. But I have prayed for you, Simon, that your faith may not fail. (Luke 22:31-32)

Our faith is the center of the target God aims at when He tests us, and if any gift escapes untested, it certainly will not be our faith. There is nothing that pierces faith to its very marrow—to find whether or not it is the faith of those who are immortal—like shooting the arrow of the feeling of being deserted into it. And only genuine faith will escape unharmed from the midst of the battle after having been stripped of its armor of earthly enjoyment and after having endured the circumstances coming against it that the powerful hand of God has allowed.

Faith must be tested, and the sense of feeling deserted is “the furnace heated seven times hotter than usual” (Dan. 3:19) into which it may be thrown. Blessed is the person who endures such an ordeal!

Charles H. Spurgeon

Paul said, “I have kept the faith” (2 Tim. 4:7), but his head was removed! They cut it off, but they could not touch his faith. This great apostle to the Gentiles rejoiced in three things: he had “fought the good fight,” he had “finished the race,” and he had “kept the faith.” So what was the value of everything else? The apostle Paul had won the race and gained the ultimate prize—he had won not only the admiration of those on earth today but also the admiration of heaven. So why do we not live as if it pays to lose “all things ... that [we] may gain Christ” (Phil. 3:8)? Why are we not as loyal to the truth as Paul was? It is because our math is different—he counted in a different way than we do. What we count as gain, he counted as loss. If we desire to ultimately wear the same crown, we must have his faith and live it.

痛苦带来丰富，死亡带来生命，这就是天国的律！

摘自《宁静时刻》

我们会否称花蕾盛放开花为死亡呢？

选

九月二十二日

「西门·西门·撒但想要得着你们，好筛你们，像筛麦子一样。但我已经为你祈求，叫你不至于失了信心。」（路22:31-32）

当神试验我们时，我们的信就是祂瞄准的靶心，若有任何恩赐是未经试验的话，这肯定不会是出于我们的信心。为要找寻那些人的信是否不死的信时，能刺入信心精髓的没有像将自情感拔出的箭反射出去。唯一的真信能叫人在战场上被剥去其地上欢乐的军装，和在神权能之手的容许下，在与他为敌的环境上坚忍后能全身而退和毫无损伤。

信定须受试炼，被抛弃的感觉要被抛进比寻常更加七倍烧热的火窑（但3:19）中。能忍受如此严峻考验的人是有福的！

司布真

说「所信的道我已经守住了」（提后4:7）的保罗是被斩头的！他们能斩他头，但不能触碰他的信。这伟大的外邦人使徒在三件事上欢欣：他打过美好的仗，跑尽当跑的路，守住所信的道。万事于他还有甚么价值？使徒保罗已胜出赛跑，赢得至终奖赏。不单得今地上众人的，且得天上的钦佩。为何我们活的不是丢弃「万事……为要得着基督」（腓3:8）的生命？为何不能像保罗般持守真理？是因我们有不同算计，他算计的方法跟我们不相同。我们看为得的他看为失。我们若渴慕至终得戴上相同的冠冕，就定须有和活出他的信。

September 23

Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, streams of living water will flow from within him. (John 7:38)

If you will give the blessing you have received, planning your life around greater service and being a blessing to those around you, then you will quickly find that the Holy Spirit is with you. He will bestow blessings to you for service, giving you all He can trust you to give away to others.

No music is as heavenly as that made by an aeolian harp. As the breath of heaven floats over the strings, notes that are nearly divine float upon the air, as if a choir of angels were wandering about and touching the strings.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

When the apostles “were filled with the Holy Spirit” (Acts 2:4), they did not lease the Upper Room and stay there to hold holiness meetings. They went everywhere, preaching the gospel.

Will Huff

Where is your brother Abel? Genesis 4:9

September 24

When they came to the border of Mysia, they tried to enter Bithynia, but the Spirit of Jesus would not allow them to. (Acts 16:7)

There have been times when I have experienced the same thing. Sometimes I have been interrupted in what seemed to be quite productive work. And at times, opposition came and forced me to go back, or sickness came and forced me to rest in some isolated place.

During such times, it was difficult for me to leave my work unfinished when I believed it was service done in the power of His Spirit. But I finally remembered that the Spirit requires not only a service of work but also a service of waiting. I came to see that in the kingdom of Christ, there are not only times for action but times to refrain from action. And I also came to learn that a place of isolation is often the most useful place of all in this diverse world. Its harvest is more rich than the seasons when the corn

九月二十三日

「信我的人，就如经上所说：从他腹中要流出活水的江河来。」(约 7:38)

你要施出已得的恩福，在生命上计划去作更大的服事，和成为你四围之人的祝福，那么你必会很快便发觉圣灵就在你里头。祂必会给予你恩福来服事，尽将祂所能托付你的给你，为叫你送出给别人。

没有像风竖琴所生成的音乐那么属天。当天之气息流经弦线时，空中便泛起几乎是神圣的音符，如同一队漫游的天使在弹拨弦线。

摘自《在地若天的日子》

当使徒们「被圣灵充满」(徒 2:4)后，他们不是永久租用那上面的楼房，留在那里举行那神圣的聚会，而是到处去传扬福音。

韦理·胡夫

「你兄弟埃布尔在哪里？」
(创4:9)

九月二十四日

「到了每西亚的边界，他们想要往庇推尼去，耶稣的灵却不许。」(徒 16:7)

我也曾多次经历相同的情况。有时是在看来颇为有建设性的工作上受干扰。反对时不时来到强逼我折返，或是病痛来到强逼我在僻静之处休息。

在那些时候，要我留下我相信是以圣灵的能力来作的工作未完成是困难的。但至终我相信圣灵所需求的不单止是工作上的服事，且是等待上的服事。我渐渐明白到到在基督的国度中不单止有行动的时刻，且有不行动的时刻。我亦学会了一个独处的地方通常是在这形形色色的世界中最有用的地方。谷物和酒最丰盛的季节都不及收割

and wine were the most abundant. So I have learned to thank the blessed Holy Spirit that many a beautiful Bithynia had to be left without a visit from me.

Dear Holy Spirit, my desire is still to be led by You. Nevertheless, my opportunities for usefulness seem to be disappointed, for today the door appears open into a life of service for You but tomorrow it closes before me just as I am about to enter. Teach me to see another door even in the midst of the inaction of this time. Help me to find, even in the area of service where You have closed a door, a new entrance into Your service. Inspire me with the knowledge that a person may sometimes be called to serve by doing nothing, by staying still, or by waiting. And when I remember the power of Your “gentle whisper” (1 Kings 19:12), I will not complain that sometimes the Spirit allows me not to go.

George Matheson

September 25

Why must I go about mourning? (Psalm 42:9)

Can you find any reason why you are so often mourning instead of rejoicing? Why do you allow your mind to dwell on gloomy thoughts? Who told you that night will never end in day? Who told you that the winter of your discontent would continue from frost to frost and from snow, ice, and hail to even deeper snow and stronger storms of despair?

Don't you know that day dawns after night, showers displace drought, and spring and summer follow winter? Then, have hope! Hope forever, for God will not fail you!

Charles H. Spurgeon

September 26

We live by faith, not by sight. (2 Corinthians 5:7)

As believers, “we live by faith, not by sight”—God never wants us to live by our feelings. Our inner self may want to live by feelings, and Satan may want us to, but God wants us to face the facts, not feelings. He wants us to face the facts of Christ and His finished and perfect work for us. And once we face these precious facts, and believe them simply because God says they are facts, He will take care of

来得丰富，因此我学会了感谢施恩圣灵，就在祂叫我留下众多的美丽庇推尼不去时。

亲爱的圣灵啊，我仍渴望得着祢的带领。虽然显为有用的机会似乎幻灭，因着为祢而作的生命服事的门今天似乎是打开的，但明天当我要进去时就在我面前关闭。教导我得见另一道门，甚或祢叫我在这时要落在毫无活动中。帮助我就算在祢已关上门的事奉领域中找到服事祢的新门口。以人所认知的也许人有时会被呼召来不作事或保持不动或等待来服事来指示我。当我记取祢「微小的声音」（王上 19:12）时，我便不会埋怨为何有时圣灵不许我前行了。

乔治·马得胜

九月二十五日

「我为何因仇敌的欺压时常哀痛呢？」（诗42:9）

你能否找到为何你经常悲伤而非欢笑的原因？为何你容许意念停驻在沮丧的思绪中？是谁告诉你黑夜不会完结转为白日？是谁告诉你你不快的冬天会持续结霜又结霜，又雪又冰又雹，甚至是更厚的雪和更凛冽的绝望风暴？

你既知黑夜尽头便是黎明，雨露必取代干旱，冬天过后便是春天夏天，那么，当心存盼望！永远盼望，因为神是不会辜负你的。

司布真

九月二十六日

「因我们行事为人，是凭着信心，不是凭着眼见。」（林后5:7）

神从不希望作为凭信不凭眼见之信徒的我们活在感觉中。我们内里的己也许想靠感觉而活，撒但亦如是，但神希望我们面对事实，并非感觉。祂想我们面对基督的事实和祂为我们作祂作成及完美的的工作。我们一旦面对这些珍贵的事实，因着神如是说而简单相信，那

our feelings.

Yet God never gives us feelings to enable or encourage us to trust Him, and He never gives them to show us that we have already completely trusted Him. God only gives us feelings when He sees that we trust Him apart from our feelings, resting solely on His Word and His faithfulness to His promise. And these feelings that can only come from Him will be given at such a time and to such a degree as His love sees best for each individual circumstance.

Therefore we must choose between facing our feelings or facing the facts of God. Our feelings may be as uncertain and changing as the sea or shifting sand. God's facts, however, are as certain as the Rock of Ages Himself—"Jesus Christ ... the same yesterday and today and forever" (Heb. 13:8).

September 27

I have found a ransom for him. (Job 33:24)

Divine healing is actually divine life. It is the lordship of Christ over the body—or the life of Christ in the framework of the human body. It is the union of the parts of our bodies with His very body, exhibiting His life flowing throughout our bodies. It is as real as His risen and glorified body. And it is as reasonable as the fact that He was raised from the dead, is a living person with an actual body, and sits today as an understanding soul at God's right hand.

That same Christ, with all His attributes and mighty power, belongs to us. We are members of His body, His flesh, and His bones, and if we will only believe this and receive it, we may actually draw our life from the very life of the Son of God. Dear God, help me to know and to live this verse: "The body is ... for the Lord, and the Lord for the body" (1 Cor. 6:13).

A.B. Simpson

"The Lord your God is with you, He is mighty to save" (Zeph. 3:17). This was the verse that initially brought the truth of divine healing to my mind and my worn-out body more than twenty years ago.

"The Lord your God" (Luke 10:27). If the Lord is my God, then all that is in almighty God is mine. It all resides within me to the extent that I am willing and able to appropriate Him and all that belongs to Him. "God, whose name is the Lord Almighty" (Jer. 32:18),

么祂必会也顾到我们的感觉。

神从不为叫和鼓励我们信靠祂而给我们感觉，也从不为要显给我们看我们已完全信靠祂而给予感觉。神只会在祂得见我们在感觉以外来信靠祂时给我们感觉，因那时我们单单安息在应许的话语和信实上。而这些来自祂的感觉只会在每一个别情况按祂的爱所认为是合适的时间和程度来给予的。

因此我们必须在面对我们的感觉还是神的事实之间取舍。我们的感觉像海洋或流沙般不稳定和变动；神的事实却稳如「耶稣基督，昨日今日一直到永远是一样的」（来13:8）万古磐石祂自己。

九月二十七日

「我已经得了（他的）赎价。」（伯33:24）

神圣医治其实是神圣生命，是让主掌管身体，或者说基督的生命进入体中。这是我们的身体与祂身体的联合，藉我们的身体来流露祂的生命，这就与祂活出荣耀的身体同样的真实。这也如同祂已从死里复活，有一实在身体的活人，今天以一颖悟的生命坐在神右边的事实同样合情合理。

属于我们的是有着祂一切属性和大能的同一位基督。我们是祂骨肉身子的肢体，只要我们相信和接受这个，便能实在由神子的生命中提取我们的生命。神啊，帮助我们认识和活出「身子……乃是为主；主也是为身子」（林前6:13）。

宣信

二十多年前「耶和华你的神，是施行拯救，大有能力的主。」（番3:17）这经文首次将这神圣医治的真理带进我的思想和衰残的身体。

「主你的神」（路10:27）。主若是我的神，那么全能神的一切都属我。甚至可以说所有属神的东西只要我愿意也能够向祂取为己用了。「是至大全能的神，耶和华

is indeed the all mighty God and is my inside God.

September 28

In me ... peace. (John 16:33)

There is a vast difference between pleasure and blessedness. Paul experienced imprisonment, pain, sacrifice, and suffering to their very limits, yet through it all he was blessed. All the beatitudes became real in his heart and life, in the midst of his difficult circumstances.

Paganini, the great Italian violinist, once stepped onstage only to discover there was something wrong with his violin.

Then he played as never before, and beautiful music flowed from that inferior instrument until the audience was so enraptured that their enthusiastic applause nearly lifted the ceiling of the concert hall.

Dear tested and tried believer, it is your mission to walk onto the stage of this world in order to reveal to all of heaven and earth that the music of life lies not in your circumstances or external things but in your own soul.

September 29

I am a man of prayer. (Psalm 109:4)

All too often we are in a “holy” hurry in our devotional time. How much actual time do we spend in quiet devotion on a daily basis? Can it be easily measured in minutes?

George Whitefield, the English preacher who was one of the leading figures in the eighteenth-century American revival known as the Great Awakening, once said, “I have spent entire days and weeks lying prostrate 伏 on the ground, engaged in silent or spoken prayer.” And the words of another person, whose life confirmed his own assertion, were these: “Fall to your knees and grow there.”

It has been said that no great work of literature or science has ever been produced by someone who did not love solitude. It is also a fundamental principle of faith that no tremendous growth in holiness has ever been achieved by anyone who has not taken the time frequently, and for long periods, to be alone with God.

from The Still Hour

是祢的名。」(耶32:18)全能的神真是我里头的神。

九月二十八日

「在我里面有平安。」(约16:33)

快乐和蒙福有着偌大的差别。保罗经历监禁、痛苦、牺牲和受苦至极，然而这一切是叫他蒙福的。所有的恩福是在他心中、生命和困难环境中成真的。

伟大的小提琴手巴格利尼(Paganini)有一次在踏出表演台前发觉他的小提琴出了问题。

之后他如同无事发生般演奏，悠扬的音乐从那次等的乐器中流出，听众因狂喜致使热烈掌声几乎把音乐厅的天花板都揭开。

受试炼的亲爱的信徒啊，你的任命就是走到今世的台前来向天和地揭示不是在四围的环境和外在的事物中，而是在你自己生命中的音乐。

九月二十九日

「我专心祈祷。」(诗109:4)

我们常在灵修时刻中「神圣」忽忽。我们实在每天花上多少时间来作宁静灵修？会否只是数分钟？

被称为大复兴的十八世纪美国复兴中其中一个领导人物乔治·怀特腓有一次说：「我曾花上数天甚至数星期伏在地上，从事无声或开声的祈祷。」另一个生命证明他一己确信的人说：「屈膝祷告来成长。」

曾有人说，不爱独处的人从不会生产出伟大的文学或科学之工。信心的基本原则亦相同，未曾恒常花长时间来与神独处的人是不能达至神圣上惊人的成长的。

摘自《宁静时刻》

September 30

He guarded him ... like an eagle that stirs up its nest and hovers over its young, that spreads its wings to catch them and carries them on its pinions. The Lord alone led him; no foreign god was with him. (Deuteronomy 32:10-12)

Our almighty God is like a parent who delights in leading the tender children in His care to the very edge of a precipice and then shoving them off the cliff into nothing but air. He does this so they may learn that they already possess an as-yet-unrealized power of flight that can forever add to the pleasure and comfort of their lives. Yet if, in their attempt to fly, they are exposed to some extraordinary peril, He is prepared to swoop beneath them and carry them skyward on His mighty wings.

from The Song of Victory

When God places a burden upon you, He places His arms underneath you. There once was a little plant that was small and whose growth was stunted, for it lived under the shade of a giant oak tree. The little plant valued the shade that covered it and highly regarded the quiet rest that its noble friend provided. Yet there was a greater blessing prepared for this little plant.

Do you understand that God may take away your comforts and privileges in order to make you a stronger Christian? Is He developing in you the qualities of a soldier by shoving you into the heat of the battle? Should you not then use every gift and weapon He has given you to become a conqueror?

Charles H. Spurgeon

October 1

It was good for me to be afflicted. (Psalm 119:71)

One of the finest arrays of living color I have ever seen was just above the great Saint Bernard Hospice near the ten-thousand-foot summit of Mont Cenis in the French Alps. The entire face of one expansive rock was covered with a strikingly vivid yellow lichen, which shone in the sunshine like a golden wall protecting an enchanted castle.

As I write these words, I have two specimens of the same type of lichen before me. One is from this Saint Bernard area, and the other is from the wall of a

九月三十日

「耶和华.....保护他.....又如鹰搅动巢窝，在雏鹰以上两翅搦展，接取雏鹰，背在两翼之上。这样，耶和华独自引导他，并无外邦神与他同在。」（申32:10-12）

我们全能的神就像一个喜悦引导幼弱儿女的父母，悉心带他们到悬崖边，猛然推他们离崖堕空。祂这样作为使他们学会早已拥有却还未知晓的能力，就是能叫他们的生命永远添上欢愉和安慰的飞翔能力。然而在他们尝试飞行中若面对某些不寻常的危险时，祂是随时准备好扑接他们，用大力双翼载他们冲天飞的。

摘自《得胜之歌》

当神安置重担在你身上时，祂同时将祂双臂放在你下面。从前有一株细小植物，矮小并发育不良，因它长在一棵大橡树的荫下。那株小植物珍爱那遮蔽它的荫庇，高度评价那宁静的平安是它这尊贵的朋友所提供的。然而有一更大的祝福早已为这株弱小植物预备。

你知不知神取走你的舒适和善待，也许为使你成为更强壮的基督徒呢？祂是否藉推你进入炽烈战事中来孕育你士兵的素质？你岂不应从此用每一个祂给你的恩赐和武器来成为一个得胜者么？

司布真

十月一日

「我受苦是与我有益，为要使我学习祢的律例。」（诗119:71）

我所见其中展现最美活泼的色彩就是在法国阿尔卑斯山脉仙尼斯山万呎山峰附近的圣班纳德救济院之上，在一大块盘石上的整个表面都布满夺目生趣盎然的黄色苔藓，在阳光照耀下就像魔幻城堡的护城金墙。

当我记下这些时，前面就放着两种同类苔藓的样本，一个来自圣班纳德，另一个来自苏格兰城堡墙

Scottish castle, which is surrounded by sycamore trees. The difference in their form and coloring is quite striking. The one grown amid the fierce storms of the mountain peak has a lovely yellow color of a primrose, a smooth texture, and a definite form and shape. But the one cultivated amid the warm air and the soft showers of the lowland valley has a dull, rusty color, a rough texture, and an indistinct and broken shape.

Until the storms and difficulties allowed by God's providence beat upon a believer again and again, his character appears flawed and blurred. Yet the trials actually clear away the clouds and shadows, perfect the form of his character, and bestow brightness and blessing to his life.

October 2

He took them with him and they withdrew by themselves. (Luke 9:10)

In order to grow in grace, we must spend a great deal of time in quiet solitude. Contact with others in society is not what causes the soul to grow most vigorously. In fact, one quiet hour of prayer will often yield greater results than many days spent in the company of others. It is in the desert that the dew is freshest and the air is the most pure.

Andrew Bonar

October 3

After the earthquake came a fire....And after the fire came a gentle whisper. (1 Kings 19:12)

God's voice is directed to the ear of love, and true love is intent upon hearing even the faintest whisper. Yet there comes a time when His love ceases to speak, when we do not respond to or believe His message. "God is love" (1 John 4:8), and if you want to know Him and His voice, you must continually listen to His gentle touches.

So when you are about to say something in conversation with others, and you sense a gentle restraint from His quiet whisper, heed the restraint and refrain from speaking. And when you are about to pursue some course of action that seems perfectly clear and right, yet you sense in your spirit another path being suggested with the force of quiet conviction, heed that conviction.

God will seem to work against Himself, so simply

上被篠悬树所围绕的。他们形态上和色彩的不同也颇令人侧目。生在烈风山巅之中的有着报春花可爱的黄色，有平滑的素质和明确的轮廓和形状。但那个在温暖空气和低地山谷微雨滋养的苔苏有的却是不起眼像生的颜色，质地粗糙，形态破损不起眼。

信徒一次又一次受神旨意临到的风暴和难处时，他的外表看来是残缺和斑污。但试炼更能把黑云阴暗除去，叫他的性格得以完全，赋与他生命的光明和恩福。

十月二日

「耶稣就带他们暗暗的离开那里。」(路9:10)

我们若要在恩典中成长，定须花大量时间在静处中。在社会上与人的交往并非造成生命越发变得富有活力的原因，事实上一小时安静的祈祷常能产生比与众人同伙多日更大的果效。沙漠中的露水是最清新的，空气是最纯洁的。

安德鲁·邦立

十月三日

「地震后有火.....火后有微小的声音。」(王上19:12)

神的声音向爱之耳讲说，真爱叫人连最细小的微声也能听见，但有时祂的爱停止说话，因我们不响应或相信「神就是爱」(约壹4:8)祂这信息。你若想认识祂和祂的声音，你定须持续聆听祂那温柔安慰之声。

因此，当你想与人交谈而自祂安静微声中感到神的禁止时，就听从这禁止来不再说话吧。当你要采取似乎是完全清楚和正直的行动时，但在你灵内感到那静中制止之力提议你另辟蹊径时，听从这制止吧。

神会作似乎违背祂自己的工，

listen, obey, and trust Him, even when it appears to be the greatest absurdity to do so. Ultimately, “we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28).

from Way of Faith

October 4

The Lord blessed the latter part of Job's life more than the first. (Job 42:12)

Job found his legacy through the grief he experienced. He was tried that his godliness might be confirmed and validated. At last he cried, “Now my eyes have seen you” (v. 5).

If I experience the presence of God in His majesty through my pain and loss, so that I bow before Him and pray, “Your will be done” (Matt. 6:10), then I have gained much indeed. God gave Job glimpses of his future glory, for in those weary and difficult days and nights, he was allowed to penetrate God's veil and could honestly say, “I know that my Redeemer lives” (Job 19:25). So truly: “The Lord blessed the latter part of Job's life more than the first.”

from In the Hour of Silence

Trouble never comes to someone unless it brings a nugget of gold in its hand. Apparent adversity will ultimately become an advantage for those of us doing what is right, if we are willing to keep serving and to wait patiently.

selected

It is from suffering that the strongest souls ever known have emerged; the world's greatest display of character is seen in those who exhibit the scars of sorrow; the martyrs of the ages have worn their coronation robes that have glistened with fire, yet through their tears and sorrow have seen the gates of heaven.

Chapin

October 5

Some time later the brook dried up. (1 Kings 17:7)

The education of our faith is incomplete if we have yet to learn that at God's providence works through loss, that there is a ministry to us through failure and the fading of things, and that He gives the gift of

所以只管聆听，顺服和信靠祂，哪怕这看起来是绝对荒谬。到底「我们晓得万事都互相效力，叫爱神的人得益处」（罗8:28）。

摘自《信心之路》

十月四日

「这样，耶和华后来赐福给乔布比先前更多。」（伯42:12）

乔布经历忧伤后有所得，他的被试炼叫他的敬虔得以确立和认同。他最终呼叫说：「现在亲眼看见祂。」（伯42:5）

我若在痛苦和损失中经验神君尊的同在来俯伏祂面前说「愿祂的旨意成就」（太6:10）时，我真的多有得着。神让乔布瞥见他将来的荣耀，就在他那些疲惫和困难的日与夜，他获许穿透神的帕子而能诚实地说：「我知道我的救赎主活着」（伯19:25），诚然「耶和华后来赐福给乔布比先前更多」。

摘自《聆静一刻》

困难不会临到某人，除非困难带同金矿块。外在的不幸终会成为我们这些作得对之人的裨益，只要我们愿意一直事奉和忍耐等候。

选

忍受苦难才能冒出人所认知最坚强的生命。世上最伟大性格的展示显在那些有伤痛疤痕的人身上。过往世代的殉教者已穿上他们有火光闪烁的加冕礼袍子，而透过他们的眼泪和忧伤得见天家之门。

泽宾

十月五日

「过了些日子，溪水就干了。」（王上17:7）

若我们还要藉损失来学习神供应之工，就是我们要作藉失败和失去世物作的职事，而祂所赐的是空无一物时，我们在信上还未受

emptiness. It is, in fact, the material in securities of life that cause our lives to be spiritually established. The dwindling brook at the Kerith Ravine, where Elijah sat deep in thought, is a true picture of each of our lives. "Sometime later the brook dried up" —this is the history of our yesterdays, and a prophecy of our tomorrows.

One way or the other, we must all learn the difference between trusting in the gift and trusting in the Giver. The gift may last for a season, but the Giver is the only eternal love. The Kerith Ravine was a difficult problem for Elijah until he arrived at Zarephath, and suddenly everything became as clear as daylight to him. God's hard instructions are never His last words to us, for the woe, the waste, and the tears of life belong to its interlude, not its finale. If the Lord had led Elijah directly to Zarephath, he would have missed something that helped to make him a wiser prophet and a better man—living by faith at Kerith.

F. B. Meyer

October 6

He did not open his mouth. (Isaiah 53:7)

If we could only see the blessings that lie hidden in our trials, we would say like David, when Shimei cursed him, "Let him curse....It may be that the Lord will ... repay me with good for the cursing I am receiving today" (2 Sam. 16:11-12).

Some Christians are easily turned away from the greatness of their life's calling by pursuing instead their own grievances and enemies. May God grant us more of the Spirit of Christ, who, "when they hurled their insults at him, ... did not retaliate....Instead, he entrusted himself to him who judges justly" (1 Peter 2:23). "Consider him who endured such opposition from sinful men, so that you will not grow weary and lose heart" (Heb. 12:3).

A. B. Simpson

October 7

Who among you fears the Lord and obeys the word of his servant? Let him who walks in the dark, who has no light, trust in the name of the Lord and rely on his God. (Isaiah 50:10)

The first thing to do is nothing. This is a difficult thing for our lowly human nature to do. There is a

教。事实上这些失去就是我们赖以维生的东西，使我们属灵的生命得以建立。坐在基立谷快要流干的溪旁沉思的伊莱贾是我们每一个人生命的真实写照。「过了些日子，溪水就干了。」这是我们昨天的故事，也是我们明天的预告。

无论如何，我们定须学会信赖恩赐与和信赖赐恩者的分别。恩赐也许持续一时，但赐恩者给的是永恒的爱。基立溪旁是伊莱贾的困难，直至他来到撒勒法，所有事情便明如日光。神严厉的指引总不是祂给我们未了的话，因生命中的悲痛、荒凉和眼泪都属插曲，而非终曲。若主直接领伊莱贾到撒勒法，他便错过那些能帮助他成为更智慧的先知和在基立活在信上更得神喜悦的人了。

迈尔

十月六日

「祂却不开口。」(赛53:7)

我们若能看见藏于试炼背后的恩福，便会像大卫在被示每咒诅时说：「由他咒骂吧.....或者耶和華见我遭难，为我今日被这人咒骂，就施恩与我。」(撒下16:11-12)

一些基督徒很容易背离他们人生伟大的呼召，反去追求他们一己的不满和仇敌。愿神给我们更多基督的灵，祂是「被骂不还口，受害不说威吓的话，只将自己交托那按公义审判人的主」(彼前2:23)的那位。那忍受罪人这样顶撞的，你们要思想，免得疲倦灰心。」(来12:3)

宣信

十月七日

「你们中间谁是敬畏耶和華听从他仆人之话的。这人行在暗中，没有亮光，当倚靠耶和華的名，仗赖自己的神。」(赛50:10)

首要作的就是不要作，于我们这些卑微的人类天性来说，作任何

saying, "When you're rattled, don't rush."

The right thing is simply to trust God, however, prevents Him from doing anything for us. If the darkness covering us strikes terror in our hearts and we run back and forth, seeking in vain to find a way of escape from the dark trial where God's providence has placed us, then the Lord cannot work on our behalf. Only the peace of God will quiet our minds and put our hearts at rest. We must place our hand in His as a little child and allow Him to lead us into the bright sunshine of His love. He knows the way out of the dense, dark forest, so may we climb into His arms, trusting Him to rescue us by showing us the shortest and most reliable road.

Dr. Pardington

October 8

Do not be anxious about anything. (Philippians 4:6)

Worry only destroys the effectiveness of lives that would otherwise be useful and beautiful. Being restless and having worries and cares are absolutely forbidden by our Lord, who said, "So do not worry, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?'" (Matt. 6:31).

Darlow Sargeant

"Be still, and know that [Jehovah is] God" (Ps. 46:10)! "The Holy One of Israel" (Ps. 89:18) will defend and deliver His own. We can be sure that His every word will stand forever, even though the mountains may fall into the sea. He deserves our total confidence.

selected

October 9

The Lord longs to be gracious to you; he rises to show you compassion. (Isaiah 30:18)

Dear Christian, do not say, "Where are all the swallows? They are all gone—they are dead." No, they are not dead. They have simply skimmed across the deep, blue sea, flying to a faraway land; but they will be back again soon.

Child of God, do not say, "All the flowers are dead—the winter has killed them, so they are gone." No! Although the winter has covered them with a white coat of snow, they will push up their heads again and will be alive very soon.

事都是困难的。

该作的不过是信靠神，但忧虑阻止祂为我们作工。若覆盖我们的黑暗叫我们的心惊恐而进退失据，寻找种种方法逃离神定旨给我们这黑暗的试诱上徒劳时，这时神不能为我们作甚么。惟有神的平安才能安静我们的心思，使我们的心安稳。我们定须像小孩般把我们的手放在神手中，让祂带领我们进入祂爱的明光中。祂知迷雾和黑暗森林的出路，所以让我们爬上祂的手臂，信靠祂来拯救我们，指示我们那最短和最可靠之路。

栢定剩博士

十月八日

「应当一无挂虑。」(腓4:6)

担忧只会破坏生命的效率，而不是有用和美丽。坐立不安、担忧和为世事操劳绝对是神所禁止的，祂说：「所以不要忧虑，说：吃甚么？喝甚么？穿甚么？」(太6:31)

达劳·沙展

「你们要休息，要知道我是神。」(诗46:10)「以色列的圣者」(诗89:18)必保护拯救属祂的人。即使大山往海中下沉，我们肯定祂的每一句话必永远立定，祂配得我们完全的信靠。

选

十月九日

「耶和華必然等候，要施恩给你们；必然兴起，好怜悯你们。」(赛30:18)

亲爱的基督徒，不要说「所有燕子去了那里？牠们全都不在，都死了。」不，牠们不是死了，牠们只不过擦过那既深且蓝的海洋飞向那遥远之地，不久便会再次回来。

神的孩子啊，不要说「所有花儿都死了，冬天已杀死它们。所以它们都不在了。」不，虽然冬天在它们上面盖了一袭白雪之衣，但它们会再次伸出头儿，不久生气再现。

O believer, do not say that the sun has burned out, just because a cloud has hidden it. No, it is still there, planning a summer for you; for when it shines again, it will have caused those clouds to have dropped their April showers, each of them a mother to a sweet mayflower.

Above all, remember—when God hides His face from you, do not say that He has forgotten you. He is simply waiting for a little while to make you love Him more. And once He comes, you will rejoice with the inexpressible “joy of the Lord” (Neh. 8:10). Waiting on Him exercises your gift of grace and tests your faith. Therefore continue to wait in hope, for although the promise may linger, it will never come too late.

Charles H. Spurgeon

October 10

Do not fret. (Psalm 37:1)

I believe that this verse is as much a divine command as “You shall not steal” (Ex. 20:15).

When we worry and fret, we are a constant annoyance. This psalm not only says, “Do not fret because of evil men” but leaves no room for fretting whatsoever.

Any physician can tell you that a fit of anger is more harmful to your system than a fever and that a disposition of continual fretting is not conducive to a healthy body. The next step down from fretting is being quick-tempered, and that amounts to anger. May we set it aside once and for all and simply be obedient to the command “Do not fret.”

Margaret Bottome

October 11

... dying, and yet we live on. (2 Corinthians 6:9)

When an early frost came, I found that the radiant beauty of the blossoms had withered. It appeared that every plant I thought the winter had destroyed had replanted fifty to take its place.

As it is in the plant world, so it is in God's kingdom. Through death came everlasting life. Through crucifixion and the tomb came the throne and the palace of the eternal God. Through apparent defeat came victory.

So do not be afraid of suffering or defeat. It is through being “struck down, but not destroyed” (2

信徒啊，不要说太阳已烧尽，它不过是被云儿遮盖，它仍在，为你安排了要来的夏天呢。当它再次照耀时，必会使那些云儿滴下它们四月的骤雨，每次雨露都是甜美五月之花的母亲。

最要紧谨记当神向你藏起祂的脸面时，不要说祂已忘记你，祂只稍等一会儿来使你爱祂更多，祂一旦归来，你必乐在口舌不能说尽的「主的喜乐」(尼8:10)中。等待祂给你恩典和试验你的信心。所以要持续在盼望中等待，虽则应许也许徘徊未到，但它总不会迟来。

司布真

十月十日

「不要.....心怀不平。」(诗37:1)

我相信本节与「不可偷盗」(出20:15)的命令同等神圣。

当我们忧心和烦躁时，便多时落在烦恼中，诗篇不单说「不要为作恶的心怀不平」，且总不给烦躁留地步。

任何一个医生都会告诉你发一阵怒比起发烧更损害身体，持续烦躁的性格不会带来健康的身体。低烦躁一级的是急躁，等同于愤怒。我们何不一次过把烦躁丢在一旁，就来顺从这命令吧。

玛嘉烈·博滕美

十月十一日

「似乎要死却是活着的。」(林后6:9)

初霜来临，我发现焕美的花儿已凋谢，我以为冬天所摧毁的每颗植物已有五十棵重新长在原处。

在植物的世界如何，在神国亦如何。永生是经过死亡才来到的。经过钉十字架和坟墓后，来到的是永生神的宝座和宫殿。经过外表的失败后要来的就是胜利。

所以不要害怕受苦和失败，是「打倒了，却不至死亡。」(林后

Cor. 4:9) and through being broken to pieces, and those pieces being torn to shreds, that we become people of strength. And it is the endurance of one believer that produces a multitude.

Henry Ward Beecher

October 12

Joseph's master took him and put him in prison....But ... the Lord was with him ... and gave him success in whatever he did. (Genesis 39:20-21, 23)

When God allows us to go to prison because of our service to Him, it is nearly the most blessed place in the world that we could be, because He goes with us. Joseph seems to have known this truth. He did not sulk, become discouraged and rebellious, or engage in self-pity by thinking "everything was against him." If he had done so, the prison warden would never have trusted him.

Lord Jesus, when the prison door closes behind me, keep me trusting in You with complete and overflowing joy. Give Your work through me great success, and even in prison make me "free indeed" (John 8:36).

selected

October 13

Do not be anxious about anything. (Philippians 4:6)

"Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God." We are to take everything, living all day long in holy fellowship with our heavenly Father and our precious Lord Jesus.

"By prayer and petition"—earnestly pleading, persevering and enduring, and waiting, waiting, waiting on God.

"With thanksgiving"—always laying a good foundation. Even if we have no possessions, there is one thing for which we can always be thankful—that He has saved us from hell. We can also give thanks that He has given us His Holy Word, His Holy Spirit, and the most precious gift of all—His Son.

"And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus" (Phil. 4:7).

George Mueller, from Life of Trust

4:9) 是经过破成断片，这些断片再被捣碎，我们才能成为有力的人。一个信徒的忍耐能生出众人的忍耐。

亨利·华德·比查

十月十二日

「(约瑟的主人)把约瑟下在监里.....但耶和华与约瑟同在.....耶和华使他所作的尽都顺利。」(创39:20-21,23)

当神因为我们服事祂而容许我们下监时，这几乎是世上我们能到最蒙福的地方，因为祂是与我们同去的。约瑟似乎懂得了这真理，他没有因为沮丧、叛逆、或想到「事事与他作对」便在自怜中而愠怒。若他是这样，司狱便不会信任他了。

主耶稣啊，当监门在我后面关上时，保守我以完全和充溢的欢欣来信靠祢。藉我作成祢伟大成功的工作，就算在狱中也使我「真自由」(约8:36)。

选

十月十三日

「应当一无挂虑。」(腓4:6)

「应当一无挂虑，只要凡事藉着祷告、祈求和感谢，将你们所要的告诉神。」(腓4:6)要带去的是凡事，整天活在与我们的天父和我们宝贵的主耶稣的神圣契合中。

「藉着祷告和祈求」——诚挚地恳求，坚持，忍耐和在神面前等候，等候，等候。

「感谢」总是一个好的根基。那怕我们一无所有，仍有一事我们总可感谢的，就是祂已救我们出离地狱。我们也可因祂曾给我们祂的圣言、祂的圣灵、和其中最宝贵的——祂的儿子来感谢祂。

「神所赐出人意外的平安，必在基督耶稣里，保守你们的心怀意念。」(腓4:7)

摘自慕勒的《信靠的生命》

October 14

Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared and a light shone in the cell. He struck Peter on the side and woke him up. "Quick, get up!" he said, and the chains fell off Peter's wrists. (Acts 12:7)

This is the way God works. In our darkest hour, He walks to us across the waves, just as an angel came to Peter's cell when the day of Peter's execution dawned. And when the scaffold was completed for Mordecai's execution, the king's sleeplessness ultimately led to his action favoring God's favored race. (See Est. 6.)

F. B. Meyer

In Joseph's life, we see God work through a fellow prisoner, later through a dream, and finally through lifting Joseph from a prison to the position of governor. And the length of Joseph's prison stay gave him the strength and steadiness he needed as governor. It is always safe to trust God's methods and to live by His clock.

Samuel Dickey Gordon

God in His providence has a thousand keys to open a thousand different doors in order to deliver His own, no matter how desperate the situation may have become. May we be faithful to do our part, which is simply to suffer for Him, and to place Christ's part on Him and then leave it there.

George MacDonald

Difficulty is actually the atmosphere surrounding a miracle, or a miracle in its initial stage. Yet if it is to be a great miracle, the surrounding condition will be not simply a difficulty but an utter impossibility. And it is the clinging hand of His child that makes a desperate situation a delight to God.

October 15

The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not despise. (Psalm 51:17)

It was not until Jacob's natural strength was broken, when "his hip was wrenched" (Gen. 32:25) at Peniel, that he came to the point where God could clothe him with spiritual power. And it was not until Moses struck the rock at Horeb, breaking its surface,

十月十四日

「忽然有主的一个使者，站在旁边，屋里有光照耀。天使拍彼得的肋旁，拍醒了他，说：快快起来。那铁链就从他手上脱落下来。」(徒12:7)

这是神工作的方法，在我们最无望时，祂像天使在行刑早上之前来到彼得的囚室般在波涛上向我们处走来。当末底改的行刑架装嵌好时，王的无法入睡至终带来有利于神喜悦的民族之举(参斯6章)。 迈尔

从约瑟的人生中我们得见神是藉着一名囚犯来作工，之后藉着梦，最终藉着提约瑟出监来到作宰相之位。约瑟坐监的年月给他的是作为宰相的力量和坚毅。信靠神的方法和活在祂的安排上总是稳妥的。

塞缪尔·迪奇·哥顿

按神旨意祂有千条钥匙开启千扇门扉，为叫属祂的人得拯救，那怕他们所处的环境多么恶劣。我们所当作的分就是信靠，简单来说就是为祂受苦，并将基督的分放回祂身上，之后便留它在那处好了。

乔治·麦当劳

困难其实是环绕神迹的气氛，或是神迹的最初阶段。若这是一大神迹，那么周围的情况便不止是困难，且是绝对不可能了。这是祂儿女依赖能令那恶劣的处境变成神所喜悦的东西的牵手了。

十月十五日

「神所要的祭，就是忧伤的灵。神阿，忧伤痛悔的心，祢必不轻看。」(诗51:17)

雅各布若不是在毘努伊勒「大腿窝.....扭了」(创32:25)，就是他的天然能力被破坏，神便不会用圣灵的能力披在他身上。摩西若不是在何烈击打盘石，击碎盘石的表

that cool “water [came] out of it for the people to drink” (Ex. 17:6). It was not until Gideon’s three hundred specially chosen soldiers “broke the jars that were in their hands” (Judg. 7:19), which symbolized brokenness in their lives, that the hidden light of the torches shone forth, bringing terror to their enemies. It was once the poor widow broke the seal on her only remaining jar of oil and began to pour it that God miraculously multiplied it to pay her debts and thereby supplied her means of support. (See 2 Kings 4:1-7.) It was not until Esther risked her life and broke through the strict laws of a heathen king’s court that she obtained favor to rescue her people from death. (See Est. 4:16.) It was once Jesus took “the five loaves ... and broke them” (Luke 9:16) that the bread was multiplied to feed the five thousand. Through the very process of the loaves being broken, the miracle occurred. It was when Mary broke her beautiful “alabaster jar of very expensive perfume” (Matt. 26:7), destroying its future usefulness and value, that the wonderful fragrance filled the house. And it was when Jesus allowed His precious body to be broken by thorns, nails, and a spear that His inner life was poured out like an ocean of crystal-clear water, for thirsty sinners to drink and then live. It is not until a beautiful kernel of corn is buried and broken in the earth by DEATH that its inner heart sprouts, producing hundreds of other seeds or kernels. And so it has always been, down through the history of plants, people, and all of spiritual life—God uses BROKEN THINGS.

Those who have been gripped by the power of the Holy Spirit and are used for God’s glory are those who have been broken in their finances, broken in their self-will, broken in their ambitions, broken in their lofty ideals, broken in their worldly reputation, broken in their desires, and often broken in their health. Yes, He uses those who are despised by the world and who seem totally hopeless and helpless, just as Isaiah said: “The lame will carry off plunder” (Isa. 33:23).

October 16

Let us throw off everything that hinders and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us. (Hebrews 12:1)

面，水便不会流出来使百姓可以喝了（出17:6）。基甸和他三百个特选的精兵若不「打破手中的瓶」（士7:19）（这瓶象征他们的生命），那么隐藏的火把便不能照耀，叫敌人惊惧了。从前那寡妇若不揭开她仅余的油瓶和开始倒油，神便不会奇妙地将油倍增来叫她可以还债，因而她维生所需得以供应。（参王下4:1-7）若以斯帖不去冒生命危险来违例闯进不信神之王的宫廷，那么她便不能蒙恩典来拯救她的百姓出离死亡了。（参斯4:16）那一次耶稣若不是「拿着这五个饼……擘开」（路9:16），那么这些饼不能倍增喂饱那五千人了。藉饼被擘开的过程，神迹便出现了。马利亚若不是打破那「瓶至贵的真哪哒香膏」（可14:3），摧毁它将来的用处和价值，那么那香气便不会充满房子。耶稣若不让祂宝贵的身体为荆棘、钉子和枪所刺破，那么祂内里的生命便不会倒出，像一明亮如水晶之汪洋的水便不会叫干渴的罪人得喝而得活了。一粒美丽的麦子若不被埋在泥土上死去，那么它里面便不会萌生上百的种子子粒来了。这同样也发生在植物、人类和所有属灵生命上，神是使用破碎了的东西的。

被圣灵能力抓住的是为神的荣耀而被神使用的人，他们在他们的经济、己意、雄心、崇高的理想、世界的声望、愿望和常时在他们的健康上都是破碎的。是的，神用那些世人所藐视，似乎完全绝望、无助的人，正如以赛亚说：「瘸腿的把掠物夺去了。」（赛33:23）

十月十六日

「我们当放下各样的重担，脱去容易缠累我们的罪，存心忍耐，奔那摆在我们前头的路程。」（来12:1）

A heavy heart is indeed a weight that will surely drag us down in our holiness and usefulness. The failure of the children of Israel to enter the Promised Land began with their complaining, or as the Word says it, "All the Israelites grumbled" (Num. 14:2). It may have started with a faint desire to complain and be discontent, but they allowed it to continue until it blossomed and ripened into total rebellion and ruin.

We should never give ourselves the freedom to doubt God or His eternal love and faithfulness toward us in everything.

selected

The Devil has two very masterful tricks. The first is to tempt us to become discouraged, for then we are defeated and of no service to others, at least for a while. The other is to tempt us to doubt, thereby breaking the bond of faith that unites us with the Father. So watch out! Do not be tricked either way.

G. E. M.

I like to cultivate the spirit of happiness! It retunes my soul and keeps it so perfectly in tune that Satan is afraid to touch it. Satan is always wary of interfering with me when my heart is full of the happiness and joy of the Holy Spirit. My plan is simply to shun the spirit of sadness as I would normally shun Satan, but unfortunately I am not always successful.

October 17

May I never boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. (Galatians 6:14)

They were people who were living to themselves. Their hopes, promises, and dreams still controlled them, but the Lord began to fulfill their prayers. They had asked for a repentant heart and had surrendered themselves with a willingness to pay any price for it, and He sent them sorrow. They had asked for purity, and He sent them sudden anguish. They had asked for meekness, and He had broken their hearts. They had asked to be dead to the world, and He killed all their living hopes. They had asked to be made like Him, so He placed them in the fire "as a refiner and purifier of

沉重的心实在是拉倒我们不再圣洁和被神使用的重力。进入应许地的以色列人的失败始于埋怨，或如经文所说：「以色列众人……发怨言」（民14:2）。开始时只是来投诉不满地方的微弱渴望，但他们容许这个继续，直至它开花结果，长成完全的叛逆败落。

我们永不要让我们随意来怀疑神或在任何事上怀疑祂向我们永恒的爱和信实。

选

魔鬼有两个拿手诡计：一、诱导我们沮丧，就在我们至小有一会儿曾不肯服事他人上失败；二、诱导我们怀疑，在那里弄断联于天父信的连系。所以要小心！不要被这诡计得逞。

G.E.M.

我喜爱培育快乐之灵！它重新调度我的生命，使生命保持在完美的调度下，就是撒但也害怕来触碰它。撒但总会留神地在我心充满圣灵的欢欣和喜乐时骚扰我。我的方法就是简单地躲避那伤心之灵，正如我经常躲避撒但一样，但不幸的是我不是总能成功的。

十月十七日

「但我断不以别的夸口，只夸我们主耶稣基督的十字架，因这十字架，就我而论，世界已经钉在十字架上；就世界而论，我已经钉在十字架上。」（加6:14）

为自己而活之人的盼望、承诺和梦想仍管控他们，但主开始垂听他们的祷告。他们祈求悔改的心，献上自己，甘付任何代价，因此祂给他们忧虑；他们祈求纯洁，祂便给他们突如其来的愤怒；他们祈求仁慈，祂便破碎他们的心；他们祈求在地上死，祂却叫他们一切的希望幻灭；他们祈求像祂，因此祂把他们放入火炉中，「如炼净银子的……熬炼他们像金银一样。」（玛

silver” (Mal. 3:3), until they could reflect His image. They had asked to help carry His cross, yet when He held it out to them, it cut and tore their hands.

They found it easier to obey than to suffer, to work than to give up, and to carry the cross than to hang upon it. But now they could not turn back, for they had come too close to the unseen cross of the spiritual life, and its virtues had pierced them too deeply. And the Lord was fulfilling this promise of His to them: “I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all men to myself” (John 12:32).

Who “follow the Lamb wherever he goes” (Rev. 14:4).

Anonymous

October 18

Know for certain that your descendants will be strangers in a country not their own, and they will be ... mistreated four hundred years. But ... afterward they will come out with great possessions. (Genesis 15:13-14)

I can be sure that part of God’s promised blessing to me is delay and suffering. The delay in Abraham’s lifetime that seemed to put God’s promise well beyond fulfillment was then followed by the seemingly unending delay experienced by Abraham’s descendants. But it was indeed only a delay—the promise was fulfilled, for ultimately they did “come out with great possessions.” God is going to test me with delays, and along with the delays will come suffering. Yet through it all God’s promise stands. I have His new covenant in Christ, and His sacred promise of every smaller blessing that I need. The delays and the suffering are actually part of the promised blessings, so may I praise Him for them today. May I “be strong and take heart and wait for the Lord” (Ps. 27:14).

Charles Gallaudet Trumbull

October 19

The ark of the covenant of the Lord went before them. (Numbers 10:33)

Consider when Jeremiah felt God leading him to purchase the field at Anathoth. He did not act on his initial feeling but waited for God to completely fulfill His words to him before taking action. Then once his cousin came to him, bringing the external evidence of

3:3) 直至他们能反照自己；他们祈求有分背主的十字架，当祂举向他们时，它割破他们的手。

他们发现顺服比受苦还容易，担起工作比放弃容易，背起十字架比担起它容易。如今他们不能回头，因他们已来到太接近属灵生命那不可见的十字架，它的益处已深刻他们。主向他们所应许的也达成了。「我若从地上被举起来，就要吸引万人来归我。」(约12:32)

「羔羊无论往哪里去，他们都跟随祂」(启14:4)。

佚名

十月十八日

「你要的确知道，你的后裔必寄居别人的地……那地的人要苦待他们四百年……后来他们必带着许多财物从那里出来。」(创15:13-14)

我肯定的是有部分神应许我的祝福迟来而叫我苦恼。亚伯拉罕生命中的迟延似乎说神的应许离应验很远，而亚伯拉罕得后裔的应验也似乎无尽的延迟。但这真的只是延迟，应许终也应验，至终他们真的「带着许多财物从那里出来。」神用迟延试验我，随着延迟而来的是苦痛。但经过这些之后神一切的应许也真的实现了。我有的是在基督里的新命令，和我所需要每项较小祝福的神圣应许，延迟和苦痛事实上是所应许祝福的一部分，因此我今日就可为这些来赞美祂。我好应「壮胆，坚固你的心。我再说：要等候耶和華。」(诗27:14)

查理士·哥洛地·湛布

十月十九日

「耶和華的约柜在前头行。」(民10:33)

看看杰里迈亚如何感受到神带领他置买亚拿突的那块地。他不是实时在感觉初期作出响应，而是等到祂完全成就祂的话时才采取行动。所以当他侄儿一来找他，作

God's direction by making a proposal for the purchase, he responded and said, "I knew that this was the word of the Lord" (Jer. 32:8).

We are not to ignore the Shepherd's personal voice to us, but like "Paul and his companions" (Acts 16:6) at Troas, we are to listen and also examine His providential work in our circumstances, in order to glean the full mind of the Lord.

A. B. Simpson

Wherever God's finger points, His hand will clear a way.

selected

October 20

The peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus. (Philippians 4:7)

There is a part of the sea known as "the cushion of the sea." It lies beneath the surface that is agitated by storms and churned by the wind. It is so deep that it is a part of the sea that is never stirred. When the ocean floor in these deep places is dredged of the remains of plant or animal life, it reveals evidence of having remained completely undisturbed for hundreds, if not thousands, of years.

The peace of God is an eternal calm like the cushion of the sea. It lies so deeply within the human heart that no external difficulty or disturbance can reach it. And anyone who enters the presence of God becomes a partaker of that undisturbed and undisturbable calm.

Arthur Tappan Pierson

Pilgrim was taken to a large upper room that faced the sunrise. And the name of the room was Peace.

from Pilgrim's Progress

October 21

Now we know that if the earthly tent we live in is destroyed, we have a building from God, an eternal house in heaven, not built by human hands. (2 Corinthians 5:1)

The words of Jesus during His last days on earth vividly express His desire to go "back to the Father"

出置买的提议作为神旨意的外在证明时，他响应说：「我杰里迈亚就知道这是耶和华的话。」(耶 32:8)

我们不是要忽略牧羊人给我们的体己声音，而是要像「保罗和他同伴」(徒16:6)在特罗亚般要听和同时以环境来验证祂的旨意，为的要查明神全盘的意思。

宣信

每当神指点动时，祂的手也必开路。

选

十月二十日

「神所赐出人意外的平安，必在基督耶稣里，保守你们的心怀意念。」(腓4:7)

有海洋的一部分称为「海洋坐垫」的，处于海面之下风浪不能搅动之处，因为在海极深的部分，以致不被搅扰。在这些极深海床之处所捞获的动植物的残余物中，显明他们完全不受干扰上百千年了。

神的平安也像海洋坐垫般的永恒宁静，它位于人心内极深极深处，因此没有外来的困难或干扰能触及它。任何进到神所在那处的人都可有分于不受干扰和不能干扰的平静。

阿瑟·塔斌·皮尔逊

天路客被带进楼上望向日出的一所大房子，这所房子的名字是「平安」。

摘自《天路历程》

十月二十一日

「我们原知道，我们这地上的帐棚若拆毁了，必得神所造，不是人手所造，在天上永存的房屋。」(林后5:1)

耶稣在地上最后几天的话生动表达祂「往父那里去」(约16:28)

(John 16:28). We, as His people, also have a vision of something far beyond the difficulties and disappointments of this life and are traveling toward fulfillment, completion, and an enriched life. We too are going "to the Father." Much of our new home is still unclear to us, but two things are certain. Our "Father's house" (John 14:2) is our home. And it is in the presence of the Lord. As believers, we know and understand that we are all travelers and not permanent residents of this world.

R. C. Gillie

October 22

Now Moses was tending the flock of Jethro his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the far side of the desert and came to Horeb, the mountain of God. There the angel of the Lord appeared to him in flames of fire from within a bush. (Exodus 3:1-2)

The vision of the Angel of the Lord came to Moses while he was involved in his everyday work. That is exactly where the Lord delights in giving His revelations. He seeks a man traveling an ordinary road, and "suddenly a light from heaven" (Acts 9:3) shines on him. And a "stairway resting on the earth" (Gen. 28:12) can reach from the marketplace to heaven, transforming a life from one of drudgery to one of grace.

Those high spiritual times and wonderful communication with the unseen world are not promised to us, but a daily life of communion with Him is. And it is enough for us, for He will give us those times of exceptional revelation if it is the right thing for us.

There were only three disciples allowed to see the Transfiguration, and the same three also experienced the darkness of Gethsemane. No one can stay on the mountaintop of favor forever, for there are responsibilities in the valley. Christ fulfilled His life's work not in the glory but in the valley, and it was there He was truly and completely the Messiah. The value of the vision and the accompanying glory is its gift of equipping us for service and endurance.

selected

October 23

Not one word has failed of all the good promises

的渴望。作祂子民的我们该有越过今生艰苦和失望的视野，我们且正朝实现和完成那丰富的生命而进发。我们是「往父那里去」。新家的大部分东西我们都不清楚，但有两件事是肯定的：一、我们「父的家」(约14:2)就是我们的家；二、这家有主的同在。作为信徒，我们知道和明白我们都是客旅，不是世上的永久住客。

R. C. 基利

十月二十二日

「摩西牧养他岳父米甸祭司叶忒罗的羊群，一日领羊群往野外去，到了神的山，就是何烈山。耶和华的使者从荆棘里火焰中向摩西显现。」(出3:1-2)

摩西得见耶和华的使者时他正进行日常事务，这也正是神喜悦发出祂启示之所。祂寻找那个在寻常路上行走的人，「忽然从天上发光」(徒9:3)照向他。循那「立在地上的梯子」(创28:12)就可以从市集往天上去了，从苦工的生活摇身一变成为蒙恩的生活。

应许我们的并不是那些高超属灵的时刻和与不可见世界的超然经历，而是每天与祂交通的生命。这对我们已足够了，因为祂会在看我们合适时来叫那些额外启示的时刻来到。

只有三个门徒蒙恩得见主变像，也是这相同的三个门徒得经历客西马尼园的黑暗。无人可永远留在称心的峰顶，因山谷下有该尽的责任。基督的生命工作不是在荣耀而是在山谷中作成的，真正成为弥赛亚也是在那里。异象和所附带之荣耀的价值只是用来装备我们事奉和忍耐的礼物吧了。

选

十月二十三日

「凡.....应许赐福的话，一句都没

he gave. (1 Kings 8:56)

Someday we will understand that God has a reason behind every no He gives us through the course of our lives. Yet even in this life, He always makes it up to us. When God's people are worried and concerned that their prayers are not being answered, how often we have seen Him working to answer them in a far greater way! Occasionally we catch a glimpse of this, but the complete revelation of it will not be seen until later.

If only we had the faith not to rush into things but to "be still before the Lord and wait patiently for him" (Ps. 37:7)—waiting for His full explanation that will not be revealed until Jesus Christ comes again!

selected

October 24

I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp. (Isaiah 41:15)

Around the turn of the twentieth century, a bar of steel was worth about \$5. Yet when forged into horseshoes, it was worth \$10; when made into needles, its value was \$350; when used to make small pocketknife blades, its worth was \$32,000; when made into springs for watches, its value increased to \$250, 000. What a pounding the steel bar had to endure to be worth this much! But the more it was shaped, hammered, put through fire, beaten, pounded, and polished, the greater its value. May we use this analogy as a reminder to be still, silent, and long-suffering, for it is those who suffer the most who yield the most. And it is through pain that God gets the most out of us, for His glory and for the blessing of others.

selected

October 25

Until now you have not asked for anything in my name. Ask and you will receive, and your joy will be complete. (John 16:24)

During the American Civil War, a certain man had a son who enlisted in the Union army. Once his son had left, he became deeply interested in the plight of soldiers, often to the neglect of his business, he began spending his time and money to care for the soldiers who came home disabled.

A young private in a faded, worn uniform

有落空。」(王上8:56)

终有一日我们会明白神在祂给我们走过的生命过程中说不出的背后原因，然而在这生命中，祂总让这作为我们的责任。当神的子民担忧他们的祷告未蒙垂听时，我们经常看见祂以一好不知多少倍的方法来回应！偶尔我们得瞥见这个，但这个的完整启示要迟些才能得见。

但愿我们有不冒失的信心，要「默然倚靠耶和华，耐性等候祂。」(诗37:7)等到耶稣基督再来时便得到祂全面解释的揭示！

选

十月二十四日

「看哪，我已使你成为有快齿打粮的新器具。」(赛41:15)

二十世纪末时，一条钢条值五元。若炼制成马蹄铁，它值十元；若作成针，它值三百五十元了；若用来制成折合小袋刀的刀片，它值三万二千元；若制成手表的弹簧时，它的价值会增至二十五万元。这条钢条能得着这巨大的价值要忍受何等的连续锤打！它越被模造、锤打、火炼、打造、重击和打磨，便得越大的价值。让我们以这比拟作为我们要安稳、平静和长久忍耐的提醒，因为那些忍受得最多的人所产生的价值也越大。神是藉着痛苦来从我们身上得着最多，得的是祂的荣耀和别人所得的祝福。

选

十月二十五日

「向来你们没有奉我的名求甚么，如今你们求就必得着，叫你们的喜乐可以满足。」(约16:24)

在美国内战期间，某银行家的儿子征召入联军中。他的儿子一离开，他时常忽略他的生意，却开始花时间和金钱来照顾那些因伤残而归家的士兵。

一个穿着褪色破旧制服的二

stepped into the bank, pulled out a scrap of dirty paper with the following words written in pencil:

Dear Father,

This is one of my friends, who was wounded in the last battle and is coming to you directly from the hospital. Please receive him as you would me.

Charlie

The banker quickly flew away. He took the young man to his own magnificent home and gave him Charlie's room and seat at the dinner table. He cared for him until the food, rest, and love had returned him to health, and then sent him back to his place of service to again risk his life for his country's flag.

selected

Now you will see what I will do. Exodus 6:1

October 26

He went up on a mountainside by himself to pray. When evening came, he was there alone. (Matthew 14:23)

Christ Jesus, in His humanity, felt the need of complete solitude—to be entirely by Himself, alone with Himself. Each of us knows how draining constant interchange with others can be and how it exhausts our energy. God desires that every servant of His would understand and perform this blessed practice, that His church would know how to train its children to recognize this high and holy privilege, and that every believer would realize the importance of making time for God alone.

Oh, the thought of having God all alone to myself and knowing that God has me all alone to Himself!

Andrew Murray

Jesus said, "Go into your room, close the door and pray" (Matt. 6:6), for it is in quiet solitude that we catch the deep and mysterious truths that flow from the soul of the things God allows to enter our lives.

A Meditation

"When he was alone with his own disciples, he explained everything" (Mark 4:34). Let them "go away one at a time ... until only Jesus [is] left" (John 8:9)

等兵步入银行，抽出一细片肮脏的纸条，在上用铅笔的字写着：

亲爱的父亲：

这是我的一个朋友，他在上一场战役中受伤，从医院直接来到你处，请你收纳他如同收纳我一样。

查理

那银行家速离银行，带这年轻人到他华丽的家，给他住上查理的房间，同坐餐桌进餐。他照顾他直至那些食物、休息和爱使他回复健康，之后把他送返军处，再次为国家的旗帜而冒生命的危险。

选

「现在你必看见我.....所行的事。」(出6:1)

十月二十六日

「祂就独自上山去祷告。到了晚上，只有祂一人在那里。」(太14:23)

人子基督耶稣感到有完全独处——只得祂自己，独自一人——的需要。我们每个都知不断与人交往如何筋疲力竭和耗尽精力。神渴望每一个祂的仆人明白和实行这蒙福的操作，也渴望祂的教会知道如何去训练其儿女得认清这高尚和神圣的殊荣，并渴望每一个信徒可明了抽时间与神独处的重要性。

噢，独有神与我一起和神独有我与祂一起，这是何等的蒙福！

慕·安德烈

耶稣说：「进你的内屋，关上门，祷告」(太6:6)，在独处中我们能抓住神容许流进我们生命的高深和神秘真理。

默想

「没有人的时候，就把一切的道讲给门徒听。」(可4:34)让他们「一个一个的出去，只剩下耶稣

with you.

George Matheson

October 27

All your waves and breakers have swept over me. (Psalm 42:7)

Stand firmly in the place where your dear Lord has put you, and do your best there. God sends us trials or tests, and places life before us as a face-to-face opponent. It is through the pounding of a serious conflict that He expects us to grow strong. The tree planted where the fierce winds twist its branches and bend its trunk, often nearly to the point of breaking, is commonly more firmly rooted than a tree growing in a secluded valley where storms never bring any stress or strain. The same is true of human life. The strongest and greatest character is grown through hardship.

selected

October 28

Because of his great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in transgressions And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus. (Ephesians 2:4-6)

This is our rightful place—"seated ... with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus," yet seated and still.

There is tremendous power in stillness. All things come to him who knows how to trust and to be silent, we would "sit down" inwardly before the Lord, allowing the divine forces of His Spirit to silently work out the means to accomplish our goals and aspirations. You may not see or feel the inner workings of His silent power, but rest assured it is always mightily at work. And it will work for you, if you will only quiet your spirit enough to be carried along by the current of its power.

Hannah Whitall Smith

October 29

He will sit as a refiner and purifier of silver. (Malachi 3:3)

It is with the most precious metals that a metallurgist will take the greatest care. He subjects the metal to a hot fire, for only the refiner's fire will melt

一人」(约8:9)和你一起。

乔治·马得胜

十月二十七日

「祢的波浪洪涛漫过我身。」(诗42:7)

在你亲爱的主所安放你之处牢牢站稳·在那里竭尽所能。神赐我们试炼或试验·摆在我们面前的人生就像一个面对面的对手。祂叫我们经历一连串冲击的拍打·是期望我们长得强壮。种植在树枝经常有烈风扭扯和树身压弯以至几乎折断的树·植根常比种植在从来没有风暴带来胁迫和拉扯的幽静山谷的树来得稳固。这于人的生命也是对的·最强和最伟大的性格是经历困难长成的。

选

十月二十八日

「然而神既有丰富的怜悯·因祂爱我们的大爱·当我们死在过犯中的时候·便叫我们与基督一同活过来。祂又叫我们与基督耶稣一同复活·一同坐在天上。」(弗2:4-6)

「与基督耶稣.....一同坐在天上」是我们当然且稳坐的地位·但我们真有这样经验的人何等少!

在静中有惊人的力量·一个懂得信靠的人就在任何事临到时都能平静安稳·我们可在里头「坐在」主面前·蒙圣灵将那圣洁的能力运行出来·以致我们的目标和愿望得以达成。你也许见不到感觉不到祂静中能力的作为·但因确信于祂大能的作为而心安。只要你的灵安静至任让那浪涛之力来带动·这大能大力便会来为你工作。

汉纳·韦滔·史勿夫

十月二十九日

「祂必坐下如炼净银子的。」(玛3:3)

冶金者会以极大的留心来处理那些最贵重的金属·他使那金属经受热火·因为只有炼金者的火才

the metal, release the dross, and allow the remaining, pure metal to take a new and perfect shape in the mold.

A good refiner never leaves the crucible but, as the above verse indicates, “will sit” down by it so the fire will not become even one degree too hot and possibly harm the metal. And as soon as he skims the last bit of dross from the surface and sees his face reflected in the pure metal, he extinguishes the fire.

Arthur Tappan Pierson

October 30

Let us run with patience. (Hebrews 12:1 KJV)

Running suggests the absence of patience, or an eagerness to reach the goal. Yet we often associate patience with lying down or standing still. We think of it as an angel who guards the bed of the disabled. The patience that runs is harder to obtain. Lying down during a time of grief, or being quiet after a financial setback, certainly implies great strength. The power to continue working after a setback suggests even greater strength, and the power to perform your daily tasks with deep sorrow in your spirit. This is a Christlike thing!

Many of us could tearlessly deal with our grief if only we were allowed to do so in private. Yet what is so difficult is that most of us are called to exercise our patience not in bed but in the open street, for all to see. No other way of burying our sorrow is as difficult as this, for it is truly what is meant by running “with patience.”

Dear Son of Man, I see You at Cana of Galilee, turning water into wine so the marriage feast would not be ruined. I see You in the desert, feeding the multitude with bread, simply to relieve a temporary need. Yet all the time, You were bearing a mighty grief—not shared or spoken. Others may ask for a “rainbow in the clouds” (Gen. 9:13), but I would ask for even more from You. Make me, in my cloud, a rainbow bringing the ministry of joy to others. My patience will only be perfect when it works in Your vineyard.

George Matheson

October 31

In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. We

能溶解那金属，释出滓渣，致使所存留的纯正金属适用模中所带来的崭新和完美的形状。

一个好的炼金者不会离开熔罐，却如文首经文所说在熔罐旁「坐」下，不使一度太热而伤害那金属。一旦从金属表面上撇去最后一点渣滓，得从那纯正的金属反照自己的面貌时，他才会把火熄灭。

阿瑟·塔班·皮尔逊

十月三十日

「我们就当存心忍耐，奔……」(来12:1)

奔跑意味着没有忍耐，或者达至目标的殷切；我们却常将忍耐联系上卧下或站稳。我们会想到忍耐就是一个守护在残废之人床边的天使。奔跑的忍耐更难达成。在忧伤之时卧下，或在经济倒退下的安静肯定意味着更大的力量。在倒退下仍继续工作有更大的力量，当心灵中有极深的伤痛下仍去履行日务，这力量像基督。

若容许我们私下落泪，我们多人能够在处理忧伤时不流泪。然而对我们大多数人来说，真正的困难不在床上而在公开的街上来行使忍耐。没有埋藏我们的忧伤比这个更困难，因为这是「存心忍耐」来奔跑的真正意义。

亲爱的人子啊，在加利利的加拿我见祢将水变酒为叫婚宴不被破坏。我也见祢在旷野到用饼喂饱那群众，是为了舒减那临时的需要。然而任何时候祢肩负无人可分享或诉说这极大的忧伤。他人或会祈求「云中的彩虹」(创19:13)，我却向祢求取更多，在我的云中使我成为一道带给别人喜乐之事奉的彩虹。惟有在祢葡萄园的忍耐才会作得完美。

乔治·马得胜

十月三十一日

「况且我们的软弱有圣灵帮助，我

do not know what we ought to pray for, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us with groans that words cannot express. And he who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will. (Romans 8:26-27)

Prayers are "groans that words cannot express." We cannot always express them ourselves, and often all we understand is that God is praying in us for something that only He understands and that needs His touch. So we can simply pour from the fullness of our heart the burden of our spirit and the sorrow that seems to crush us. We can know that He hears, loves, understands, receives, and separates from our prayer everything that is in error, imperfect, or wrong. And then He presents the remainder, along with the incense of the great High Priest, before His throne on high. We may be assured that our prayer is heard, accepted, and answered in His name.

A. B. Simpson

It is not necessary to be continually speaking to God, for there is an unspeakable fellowship that is sweeter than words. A little child can sit all day long beside his mother, totally engrossed in his playing, while his mother is consumed by her work, and although both are busy and few words are spoken by either, they are in perfect fellowship. The child knows his mother is there, and she knows that he is all right.

selected

November 1

When the cloud remained ... the Israelites ... did not set out. (Numbers 9:19)

Floating ahead seems pleasant. Yet having to wait was another story altogether.

"I waited patiently for the LORD; he turned to me and heard my cry" (Ps. 40:1). And what God did for the Old Testament saints, He will do for believers down through the ages, yet He will often keep us waiting.

When God sends no answer and "the cloud remain[s]," we must wait. Yet we can do so with the full assurance of God's provision of manna, water from the rock, shelter, and protection from our enemies.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

们本不晓得当怎样祷告，只是圣灵亲自用说不出来的叹息，替我们祷告。鉴察人心的，晓得圣灵的意思，因为圣灵照着神的旨意替圣徒祈求。」（罗8:26-27）

祷告是「说不出来的叹息」。我们本身不能说这个，人所常能明白的是神在我们里面祈求，只祂明白和需祂触动的东西。因此我们只需将塞满心灵里的重担和那些似乎压扁我们的忧伤尽数倾诉。我们所能知道的就是祂聆听，爱护，明白，接纳和将每样误解、不完全、和错误祈祷的东西分隔出来，之后祂会将余下的，随着那伟大的大祭司所献的香上升到祂宝座面前。我们确实知道我们奉祂名而作的祈祷必蒙垂听，接纳和得回应的。

宣信

要与神有交通和契合是不需要持续不停向神说话，说不出来的契合比言语更甜美。一个小孩子可以整天坐在妈妈身旁，完全埋首玩耍，而妈妈也耗尽心神在她的工作上，虽然他们二人都因忙碌而任何一方也不多说说话，然而他们是在完美的契合中的，那小孩知道妈妈在那里，她也知道他凡事安好。

选

十一月一日

「云彩在帐幕上停留……，以色列人就……不起行。」（民9:19）

起行看起来是欢快的；等待却又是另一回事了。

「我曾耐性等候耶和華，祂垂听我的呼求。」（诗40:1）神作在旧约圣徒身上的，也必作在历世历代信徒身上，但祂常叫我们等待。

若神未垂听，而「云彩在帐幕上停留」时，我们定须等待。然而这等待是有神供应吗哪、盘石出水、荫庇和脱离敌人的确据。

摘自《每日灵修注释》

November 2

Peter was kept in prison, but the church was earnestly praying to God for him. (Acts 12:5)

“But the church was earnestly praying to God for him.” So what was the outcome? The prison was miraculously opened, the apostle freed, the Jews bewildered, and as a display of God’s punishment, wicked King Herod “was eaten by worms and died.” And rolling on to even greater victory, “the word of God continued to increase and spread” (vv. 23-24).

God baptizes us with holy boldness and divine confidence, for He is looking not for great people but for people who will dare to prove the greatness of their God! “But the church was earnestly praying.”

A. B. Simpson

In your prayers, above everything else, beware of limiting God, not only through unbelief but also by thinking you know exactly what He can do. Learn to expect the unexpected, beyond all that you ask or think.

So each time you intercede through prayer, first be quiet and worship God in His glory. Think of what He can do, how He delights in Christ His Son, and of your place in Him—then expect great things.

Andrew Murray

Our prayers are God’s opportunities.

Prayer can make your time of affliction one of strength and sweetness. Prayer can add a heavenly fragrance to your time of joy. Prayer can place an angel by your side whose very touch could shatter a millstone into smaller grains of dust than the flour it grinds, and whose glance could destroy an entire army. Everything that God can do for you. “Ask for whatever you want me to give you” (2 Chron. 1:7).

Frederick William Farrar

November 3

You who bring good tidings to Zion, go up on a high mountain. (Isaiah 40:9)

Toys and trinkets are easily earned, but the most valuable things carry a heavy price. The highest places of power are always bought with blood, and you can attain those pinnacles if you have enough blood to pay. That is the condition of conquering holy heights everywhere. The story of true heroics is always the

十一月二日

「于是彼得被囚在监里。教会却为他切切的祷告神。」(徒12:5)

「教会却为他切切的祷告神」。结果是监门奇迹地开启，使徒得自由，犹太人手足无措，邪恶的希律王亦「被虫所咬，气就绝了」(徒12:23)来显示神的惩罚，而「神的道日见兴旺，越发广传」(徒12:24)是更大胜利的擂鼓。

神用神圣的勇敢和确信替我们施浸，为的不是寻找伟大的人，而是敢于证明他们的神是伟大的人！「教会却为他切切的祷告神。」
宣信

若在你的祷告中察觉在凡事上限制神(不单止藉着不信，且也藉认为你完全知道神所能作的)时，学习期待那意料之外的，就是超过一切你所求所想的。

每次你祷告代求时，先安静向荣耀的神敬拜，想想祂所能作的，祂如何喜悦基督祂的儿子，和你在基督里的位置，之后期待大事吧。
慕·安德烈

我们的祷告替神制造机会。

祷告能使你忧伤的时刻变成得力和甜美。祷告能使你喜乐的时间增添属天的香气。祷告能将天使放在你身旁，他的每一触碰都能碾碎一磨石成为比它所磨面粉更幼细，他的一瞥能摧毁全军。神能为你作每一样的事。「你愿我赐你甚么，你可以求。」(代下1:7)

弗特烈·威廉·法拉

十一月三日

「报好消息给锡安的阿，你要登高山。」(赛40:9)

玩具和小装饰品容易赚取，但最贵重的东西乘载巨大价值。最高位置的权力总要用血买来，若你能付出足够的血，便能获得那些高位，每处征讨神圣高位的常是这样，真正勇士的故事常也是舍身流

story of sacrificial blood. The greatest values and character in life are not blown randomly across our path by wayward winds, for great souls experience great sorrows.

November 4

I was among the exiles by the Kebar River, the heavens were opened and I saw visions of God....There the hand of the Lord was upon [me]. (Ezekiel 1:1, 3)

We have seen the Lord deliver us from captivity and “restore our fortunes, ... like streams in the Negev” (Ps. 126:4).

A person who has experienced great difficulties, over the old and tear-stained pages of his Bible, he has time and again come to the pillars of the house of God and “to Elim, where there were ... palm trees” (Ex. 15:27). And each of those pillars and trees have become a remembrance for him of some critical time in his life.

No calamity will ever bring only evil to us, if we will immediately take it in fervent prayer to God.

Like Jacob, we must cross “the ford of the Jabbok” (Gen. 32:22) if we are ever to arrive at Peniel, where he wrestled with the Lord, was blessed by Him, and could say, “I saw God face to face, and yet my life was spared” (Gen. 32:30).

God will give you “songs in the night” (Job 35:10) and will turn your “blackness into dawn” (Amos 5:8).

Nathaniel William Taylor

November 5

Is anything too hard for the Lord? (Genesis 18:14)

This is God’s loving challenge to you and me each day. He wants us to think of the deepest, highest, and worthiest desires and longings of our hearts.

As long as it aligns with what we know to be His expressed will, if we will let Him, God will do that very thing, even if we know it is such an utter impossibility that we would simply laugh at the absurdity of anyone ever suggesting it could come to pass.

“Is anything too hard for the Lord?” The only thing “too hard for the Lord” is our deliberate and continual disbelief in His love and power, and our ultimate rejection of His plans for us. Nothing is impossible for Jehovah to do for those who trust Him.

血的故事。生命中的伟大价值和品格不是由无定向的风任意地吹过我们走过的路径上的，因为只有伟大的灵魂才能经历伟大的创伤。

十一月四日

「我在迦巴鲁河边被掳的人中，天就开了，得见神的异象.....耶和華的手降在他身上。」（结1:1, 3）

我们已见到耶和華使「被掳的人归回，好像南地的河水复流。」（诗126:4）

曾经历重大困难的人，他老旧的圣经的书页上满有泪痕，他有时来到神家的柱子，来到「了以琳，在那里有.....棕树」（出15:27）。每一根这些柱子和树都成为他人人生某些值得纪念的危急时刻。

从没只带来不幸的困苦，只要我们立即为此热切祷告神。

我们定须如雅各布般经过「雅博渡口」（创32:22）才能到达与神摔跤的毘努伊勒，因而受祝福，和能够说：「我面对面见了神，我的性命仍得保全。」（创32:30）

神必会使你「夜间歌唱」（伯35:10），也必会使你的「死荫变为晨光，」（摩5:8）。

尼坦尼尔·威廉·泰莱

十一月五日

「耶和華豈有难成的事么？」（创18:14）

你我每日接受的挑战出于神的爱，祂想我们想及心中最深、最高和最宝贵的热爱和渴望。

只要与我们所认识祂曾说过的旨意一致，只要我们让祂来作，祂必会作成这个，那怕我们认为绝对没有可能，连我们也会平白地嘲笑任何说这样话路过之人的荒谬。

「耶和華豈有难成的事么？」唯一难成的事是我们在祂的爱和能力上蓄意和持续不信，和极力抗拒祂给我们的计划。对于信祂的人有耶和華作不来的事。

November 6

Those whom I love I rebuke and discipline. (Revelation 3:19)

God selects the best and most notable of His servants for the best and most notable afflictions, for those who have received the most grace from Him are able to endure the most afflictions. He does not haphazardly aim His arrows, for each one is on a special mission and touches only the heart for whom it is intended. It is not only the grace of God but also His glory that is revealed when a believer can stand and quietly endure an affliction.

Joseph Caryl

Dear Lord, do not punish me by removing my cross from me. Instead, comfort me by leading me into submission to Your will and by causing me to love the cross.

a captive's prayer

November 7

Whatever was to my profit I now consider loss for the sake of Christ. (Philippians 3:7)

George Matheson, the blind Scottish preacher, who was so beautifully and significantly honored, wrote the "the most severe mental suffering," hymn in 1882 in five minutes.

There is a legend of an artist who had found the secret of a wonderful red that no other artist could imitate. He never told the secret of the color, but after his death an old wound was discovered over his heart. It revealed the source of the matchless hue in his pictures.

No great achievement can be made, no lofty goal attained, nor anything of great value to the world accomplished, except at the cost of the heart's blood.

November 8

He took Peter, John and James with him and went up onto a mountain to pray. As he was praying, the appearance of his face changed, and his clothes became as bright as a flash of lightning.... Peter and his companions ... saw his glory. (Luke 9:28-29, 32)

If you are pleased with me, teach me your ways.

十一月六日

「凡我所疼爱的，我就责备管教他。」(启3:19)

神拣选祂最好和最触的仆人经历最大和最显著的苦难，因为那些从祂得着最多恩惠的人才能够忍受那些最严峻的苦难。神的箭不会偶发，每一枝箭都有一特别任务，只瞄向那些心会受感动的人。这不单止是神的恩典，且是向能站稳和静静忍受苦难信徒之神的荣耀。

约瑟·卡利奥

亲爱的主啊，不要从我身上移走我的十字架来惩罚我，反而要领我顺服于祢的旨意和使我爱上十字架来安慰我。

《一个被掳者的祈祷》

十一月七日

「只是我先前以为与我有益的，我现在因基督都当作有损的。」(腓3:7)

备受尊崇的瞎眼传道者乔治·马得胜在1882年写了这首五分钟内写成「最严峻精神上痛苦」的圣诗。

传说中有一艺术家找到其它艺术家不能模仿得出奇妙红色的秘诀。他从没有告诉人这颜色的秘密，直至他死后有人发现他心上的伤口，这揭示出他画作中无比颜色的来源。

伟大的成就作不成，崇高的目标达不到，世上任何高价值的东西也作不来，除非付上心血的代价。

十一月八日

「耶稣带着彼得、约翰、雅各布，上山去祷告。正祷告的时候，祂的面貌就改变了，衣服洁白放光。……彼得和他的同伴都……看见耶稣的荣光。」(路9:28-29,32)

「我如今若在祢眼前蒙恩，求祢将

(Exodus 33:13)

The three disciples “saw his glory” and said, “It is good for us to be here” (Luke 9:32-33). Heaven is never far from those who linger on a mountain with their Lord.

Who of us in certain moments of meditation and prayer has not caught a glimpse of the heavenly gates? Who has not in the secret place of holy communion felt a surging wave of emotion— a taste of the blessed joy yet to come?

Every Christian should have his own Mount of Olives. Even Daniel needed to have his Mount of Olives in his room amid the roar of idolatrous Babylon. Peter found a rooftop in Joppa, and Martin Luther found an “upper room” in Wittenberg, a place that is still considered sacred.

And this is the world’s need today—people who have seen their Lord.

from The Lost Art of Meditation

November 9

Men will dwell again in his shade. He will flourish like the grain. He will blossom like a vine. (Hosea 14:7)

The plants in my garden were beaten down by the pelting storm. Yet the night passed, the sun shone again, and the morning brought strength to my favorite plant. The light looked at its flowers and the flowers looked at the light. There was contact and communion, and power passed into the flowers. They lifted their heads, opened their petals, regained their glory, and seemed more beautiful than before.

I cannot explain exactly how we are able to receive the power to serve and to endure through communion with God, but I know it is a fact. God has promised, “I will strengthen you” (Isa. 41:10).

November 10

Against all hope, Abraham in hope believed. (Romans 4:18)

It is simply to your advantage to rely with confidence upon the Word of God. And although He may delay in sending His help, and the evil you are experiencing may seem to become worse and worse, do not be weak. Instead, be strong and rejoice, for God usually steps forward to save us when we least expect it, fulfilling His most glorious promises in a

祢的道指示我。」(出33:13)

「看见耶稣的荣光」的三门徒说：「我们在这里真好」(路9:32-33)。天堂对那些与主在山上徘徊的人来说永不会是远的。

我们可在默想或祈祷的时刻中得瞥见天堂之门，在与主有神圣相交的密室中感受过那股情感汹涌的巨浪，预尝要来的属天喜乐。

每一个基督徒都该有自己的橄榄山。在鼓噪拜偶像的巴比伦国中的但以理需在他房子里有橄榄山。彼得的在约帕的屋顶，马丁·路德的在威腾堡的楼上房子里，那处现今仍被看为神圣之所。

今天世界所需要的，就是曾看见他们主的人。

摘自《失落的默想艺术》

十一月九日

「曾住在祂荫下的必归回，发旺如五谷，开花如葡萄树，他的香气如利巴嫩的酒。」(何14:7)

我花园中的植物被盛怒的暴风雨打倒了。但那晚过后，阳光再次照耀，早晨将力量带给我最喜爱的植物。日光看着花儿，花儿看着日光，当中有接触有交流，能力传送入花儿里。他们抬起他们的头，重新得着他们的荣耀，似乎比之前更美丽。

我不能确切解释我们如何能得事奉的能力和持久与神相交，但我知这是一事实。神曾应许：「我必坚固你。」(赛41:10)

十一月十日

「他(亚伯拉罕)在无可指望的时候，因信仍有指望。」(罗4:18)

以信来靠赖神的话就是对你有益，虽然祂也许会延迟送来帮助，而你所体验的不幸似乎越发变差，但不要软弱，反要刚强和欢欣，因为神会在我们最意想不到的时候步近来拯救我们，以最不可思议的方法来达成祂荣耀的应许。

miraculous way.

He generally waits to send His help until the time of our greatest need, so that His hand will be plainly seen in our deliverance. He chooses this method so we will not trust anything that we may see or feel, as we are so prone to do, but will place our trust solely on His Word—which we may always depend upon, no matter our circumstance.

C. H. Von Bogatzky

Remember, the very time for faith to work is when our sight begins to fail. And the greater the difficulties, the easier it is for faith to work, for as long as we can see certain natural solutions to our problems, we will not have faith. Faith never works as easily as when our natural prospects fail.

George Mueller

November 11

He will be like rain falling on a mown field. (Psalm 72:6)

Amos tells of “the king’s mowings” (Amos 7:1 KJV). Our King also has many scythes and is constantly using them to mow His lawns. In human life, we try to take a brave stand before the scythe of pain, the shears of disappointment, or the sickle of death. And just as there is no way to cultivate a lawn like velvet without repeated mowings, there is no way to develop a life of balance, tenderness, and sympathy for others without enduring the work of God’s scythes.

But do not dread God’s scythe—for it is sure to be followed by His shower.

F. B. Meyer

November 12

These were the potters, and those that dwelt among plants and hedges: there they dwelt with the king for his work. (1 Chronicles 4:23KJV)

We may be called to serve Him in the most unlikely places and under the most adverse conditions. It may be “among plants and hedges” of all kinds—hindrances that surround us, blocking our way. Perhaps we will be one of “the potters,” with our hands full of all types of pottery, accomplishing our daily tasks.

Frances Ridley Havergal

祂常等到我们最大需要时才送来祂的帮助，为叫我们得见祂拯救的手。祂选用这方法，好叫我们不再如倾向的来信靠任何可见可感的任何东西，却独独将我们的信靠放在祂的话语上，就是我们无论在任何环境都可以常常倚靠的。

C.H.旺·保加斯基

谨记，信心生效的非常时期就在当我们的视力开始失效时。困难越大，信心越能生效，因为只要我们还有问题的天然解决办法，我们总不会有信心。信心生效不会像我们天然的前景都失效时来得容易。

慕勒

十一月十一日

「祂必降临，像雨降在已割的草地上。」（诗72:6）

阿摩司论到「为王割菜」（摩7:1）。我们的王有很多常用来修剪祂草地的镰刀。生活上我们尝试勇敢地站着忍受镰刀之痛、失望的割切、死亡的挥镰。若不是一次又一次的修剪，便不能栽植这如天鹅绒的草坪；若没有神持续镰刀的工作，便没办法发展出一镇静、受感和同情他人的生命。

不要恐惧祂的挥镰，因为肯定随之而来的是祂的爱。

迈尔

十一月十二日

「这些人都是窑匠，是尼他应和基低拉（或植物和树藿中）的居民。与王同处，为王作工。」（代上4:23）

我们也可能被召来到最不可能之处，在最不利的环境下服事祂。可能在各种各类的「植物和树藿中」，四围都是障碍物，堵塞我们的路。也许我们是其中一个「窑匠」，满手都是各式各样的陶器，在进行我们每日的生计中。

弗朗西斯·雷利·夏法高

The most saintly souls are often those who have led a quiet inner life of holiness.

Kenelm Digby

November 13

I have chosen him, so that he will direct his children.
(Genesis 18:19)

The Lord can be depended upon, and He desires for us to be just as reliable, determined, and stable. This is simply the meaning of faith.

God is looking for people on whom He can place the weight of His entire love, power, and faithful promises. And His engines are strong enough to pull any weight we may attach to them.

A. B. Simpson

No trial has ever been given to anyone that was greater than that person's strength, through God, to endure it.

November 14

Unless a kernel of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains only a single seed. But if it dies, it produces many seeds. (John 12:24)

In Northampton, Massachusetts, stands the old cemetery where David Brainerd is buried. Brainerd, a pioneer American missionary, died in 1747 at the age of twenty-nine after suffering from tuberculosis. His grave is beside that of Jerusha Edwards, the daughter of Jonathan Edwards, a Puritan theologian of that day.

Jonathan Edwards, that majestic old Puritan saint, who had hoped to call Brainerd his son, began to write the story of that short life in a little book.

In spite of his education, brilliance, and great opportunities, after Henry Martyn reading that little book on the life of Brainerd, threw his own life away! Afterward, what had he accomplished once he set his course toward home from India in 1812? With his health then broken, he dragged himself as far north as the town of Tokat, Turkey, near the Black Sea. There he lay in the shade of a pile of saddles, to cool his burning fever, and died alone at the age of thirty-one.

Leonard Woolsey Bacon

最神圣的生命是那些过着内里圣别的安静生活之人。

凯内尔姆·笛比

十一月十三日

「我眷顾他，为要叫他吩咐他的众子和他的眷属。」(创18:19)

耶和華是足可倚靠的，祂也渴想我们能够一样的可靠，有决断力和稳重，这平白就是信心的意思。

神正寻找那些祂能将祂全部的爱、权柄和信实应许的重任托付的人，祂的引擎有足够能量来拉动我们依附在它上面的任何重量。

宣信

从来没有一个由神给人的试炼是超出那人的承受能力的。

十一月十四日

「一粒麦子不落在地里死了，仍旧是一粒；若是死了，就结出许多子粒来。」(约12:24)

麻萨诸塞州北安普敦市是大卫·布莱纳古旧坟场所在。布莱纳这美国传教士先驱于1747二十九岁之年死于肺结核。他的坟墓就在耶路沙·爱德华兹墓旁，后者是当时清教徒神学家乔纳单·爱德华兹的女儿。

渴望称布莱纳为儿子的庄严老清教徒圣人乔纳单·爱德华兹写一本小书记下这短暂生命的故事。

亨利·马田不理睬他的教育、才华和大好机会，读罢布莱纳生平小书的他便舍弃他自己的生命！之后，他于1812年出发远赴印度，健康破损的他拖着身子北往最远去到黑海附近土耳其的托卡特城。在那里他卧在马鞍堆的荫下来使他那像火灼一样的发烧得以降温，就在三十一岁之年孤独地死去。

瑞安纳·胡士里·培根

November 15

*We were under great pressure. (2 Corinthians 1:8)
... so that Christ's power may rest on me. (2 Corinthians 12:9)*

God allowed the crisis in Jacob's life at Peniel to totally surround him until he ultimately came to the point of making an earnest and humble appeal to God Himself. That night, he wrestled with God and literally came to the place where he could take hold of Him as never before.

Through those difficult years, David also grew in his knowledge of faith and godliness, which were indispensable principles for his glorious career as the king of Israel.

Nothing but the most dangerous circumstances in which Paul was constantly placed could ever have taught him, and thus the church through him, the full meaning of the great promise of God he learned to claim: "My grace is sufficient for you" (2 Cor. 12:9).

Sometimes we may have to wait and realize that "perseverance must finish its work" (James 1:4). But ultimately we will surely find "the stone rolled away" (Luke 24:2) and the Lord Himself waiting to bestow a double blessing on us for our time of testing.

A. B. Simpson

November 16

They overcame him by the blood of the Lamb ...; they did not love their lives so much as to shrink from death. (Revelation 12:11)

When James and John came to Christ with their mother, asking Him to give them the best place in His kingdom, He did not refuse their request. He told them that the place would be given to them if they could do His work, drink His cup, and be baptized with His baptism. (See Mark 10:38.)

Rise today to face the circumstances in which the providence of God has placed you. Your crown of glory is hidden in the heart of these things—the hardships and trials pressing in on you this very hour, week, and month of your life. Yet the most difficult things are not those seen and known by the world but those deep within your soul, unseen and unknown by anyone except Jesus.

selected

November 17

十一月十五日

「我们.....被压太重。」(林后1:8)
「好叫基督的能力覆庇我。」(林后12:9)

神容许雅各布在毘努伊勒的生命被危机重重围困,直至他最终来到对神作出最诚挚和谦卑的祈求那点。那晚他与神摔跤,他便来到那照字面解释从来未曾抓住神的地方。

经过那些艰难的年日,大卫渐渐在对信心和敬虔的认识上加增,这些都是他作为以色列王那荣耀位分所必不可少的素质。

能够叫保罗得教训的没有别的,惟有是他最恒常落到最危险的环境,因此教会因他的缘故学习到神最伟大应许的全面意思,且宣告:「我的恩典够你用的。」

我们也许有时要等候和明白「忍耐也当成功」(雅1:4)。我们至终必发现「石头已经从坟墓滚开」(路24:2),和主等候为我们受试炼的日子加倍施恩。

宣信

十一月十六日

「弟兄胜过他,是因羔羊的血,和自己所见证的道。他们虽至于死,也不爱惜性命。」(启12:11)

当雅和和约翰带同母亲来到基督面前要求祂给他们在祂国中最重要的位置时,祂没有拒绝他们的要求。祂告诉他们那位置是给那些能作祂的工,喝祂的杯和受祂的洗的人。(参可10:38)

今天就起来面对神定旨放置你的环境。你荣耀的冠冕埋藏在这些里面,在艰难和试炼人生中的这刻,这周,这月来迫近。但最困难的不是那些可见和世界已知的,而是那些在你灵魂深处,除了耶稣之外无人见过和知道的。

选

十一月十七日

Listen to what the unjust judge says. And will not God bring about justice for his chosen ones, who cry out to him day and night? Will he keep putting them off? I tell you, he will see that they get justice, and quickly. (Luke 18:6-8)

God's timing is not ours to command. If we do not start the fire with the first strike of our match, we must try again.

When it comes to faith, we have more certainty of success than we could ever have had with flint and steel, for we have God's promises as a foundation.

May we, therefore, never despair. God's time for mercy will come—in fact, it has already come, if our time for believing has arrived. Ask in faith without wavering, but never cease to petition the King simply because He has delayed His reply..

Charles H. Spurgeon

November 18

Blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me. (Luke 7:23 KJV)

The Lord knows what is best for me, and my surroundings are determined by Him. I must believe that when difficulties remain, it is that I may learn to trust Him completely—to trust and not be afraid. And it is through my mental and emotional struggles that I am being trained to tutor others who are being tossed by the storm.

The offense causing me to turn away may be spiritual. I had imagined that once within His fold, I would never again suffer from the stinging winds of temptation. Yet it is best for me the way it is, for when I endure temptation His grace is magnified, my own character matures, and heaven seems sweeter at the end of the day.

Once I arrive at my heavenly home, I will look back across the turns and trials along my path and will sing the praises of my Guide. So whatever comes my way, I will welcome His will and refuse to be offended in my loving Lord.

Alexander Smellie

November 19

Though you have made me see troubles, many and bitter, you will restore my life again. (Psalm 71:20)

God makes you “see troubles.” Sometimes, as part of your education being carried out, you must “go

「你们听这不义之官所说的话。神的选民，昼夜呼吁祂，祂纵然为他们忍了多时，岂不终久给他们伸冤么？我告诉你们，要快快的给他们伸冤了。」（路18:6-8）

神的时间不由我们支配。我们若果第一次擦动火柴不能划出火时，必须再次尝试。

我们若有信心，我们肯定比旧日用火石和火镰更加成功，因为我们有神的应许作为我们的基础。

因此，我们不要绝望，神施怜悯的时间必会来临，事实上若我们相信的时刻已来临，它早已来到。要在信中求，一点不动摇，只要当王迟迟未答复时仍不止歇的求祂。

司布真

十一月十八日

「凡不因我跌倒的，就有福了。」（路7:23）

主知道甚么是对我最好的，和我的周遭是由祂决定的。我定须在困难还在时仍相信，好叫我学习完全信靠祂，信靠而不害怕。我是藉精神和情绪上的挣扎来锻炼自己作那些被风暴动摇之人的导师。

致使我转离神的原因可能是属灵的。我以为只要在祂的羊圈中，我便永不再受试探之风欺哄。然而于我这是最好的方法，因为当我忍受试炼时，祂的恩典是加倍的，我一己的品格得以成熟，在那日结束时天也看起来更加甜美。

当到达天家时，我必回望沿途我曾经过的转捩和试炼，也会颂唱引导者的赞歌。因此无论我前路如何，我必会欣然接受祂的旨意和拒绝得罪我亲爱的主了。

亚历山大·史美利

十一月十九日

「祢是叫我们多经历重大急难的，必使我们复活。」（诗71:20）

神使你经历急难，有时为要成为你受教的一部分，你定须「往地

down to the depths of the earth” (Ps. 63:9). And ultimately, from the depths, He “will restore [your] life again.”

Never doubt God! Never say that He has forsaken or forgotten you or think that He is unsympathetic. He “will restore [your] life again.”

Be steadfast, “because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain” (1 Cor. 15:58). “My tongue will sing of your righteousness” (Ps. 51:14).

selected

November 20

Blessed is the one who waits. (Daniel 12:12)

Waiting may seem like an easy thing to do, but it is a discipline that a Christian soldier does not learn without years of training. Marching and drills are much easier for God’s warriors than standing still.

Wait in faith. Express your unwavering confidence in Him. And believe that even if He keeps you waiting until midnight, He will come at the right time to fulfill His vision for you.

Wait in quiet patience. Never complain about what you believe to be the cause of your problems, as the children of Israel did against Moses. Accept your situation exactly as it is and then simply place it with your whole heart into the hand of your covenant God. And while removing any self-will, say to Him, “Lord, ‘Not my will, but yours be done’ [Luke 22:42]. I do not know what to do, and I am in great need. But I will wait until You divide the flood before me or drive back my enemies. I will wait even if You keep me here many days, for my heart is fixed on You alone, dear Lord. And my spirit will wait for You with full confidence that You will still be my joy and my salvation, ‘for you have been my refuge, [and] a strong tower against the foe’ [Ps. 61:3].”

from Morning by Morning

November 21

Commit your way to the Lord. (Psalm 37:5)

Do this so that you will be free from the confusion, conflicts, and cares that fill the world today.

R. Leighton

底下去」(诗63:9)，最终从那深处祂必使你复活。

永不要怀疑神！永不要说祂已舍弃或忘记你，也不要以为祂是不同情了。祂必会使你复活。

要坚定，「因为知道你们的劳苦，在主里面不是徒然的。」(林前15:58)「我的舌头就高声歌唱祢的公义。」(诗51:14)

选

十一月二十日

「等……的，那人便为有福。」(但12:12)

等待似乎是一件易做的事，但这是基督精兵不花年计的训练学不来的。步操和排练对于神的战士来说比起站稳容易得多。

在信中等待。表达你对祂不动摇的信心，也要相信即使祂要你一直等至午夜，祂必会及时来到来为你成就祂的异象。

在静中忍耐等待。不要像以色列民敌挡摩西般埋怨你想当然的问题成因。接受你所在的处境，随后全心将这交在与你立约之神的手中。除去任何己意下向祂说：「主啊，不要成就我的意思，只要成就祢的意思。」(路22:42)我不知可作甚么，我正大大缺乏。但我会等到祢在我面前将洪水分开，驱散敌人。祢要若在那里多日我必仍等待，因我心单单注目恩主祢。我的灵必完全信靠等待祢，因祢仍是我的喜乐和拯救，「因为祢作过我的避难所，作过我的坚固台，脱离仇敌。」(诗61:3)

摘自《每朝早》

十一月二十一日

「当将你的事交托耶和华。」(诗37:5)

这样作是为了叫你得在今天世界的混乱、冲突、和忧愁中得自由。

R·礼顿

You will find it impossible to “commit your way to the Lord,” unless your way has met with His approval. It can only be done through faith. This committing of your way to Him must be continuous, not just one isolated action.

selected

November 22

Do you believe that I am able to do this? (Matthew 9:28)

God deals with impossibilities. It is never too late for Him to do so, as long as that which is impossible is brought to Him in complete faith by the person whose life and circumstances would be impacted if God is to be glorified. God “will repay you for the years the locusts have eaten” (Joel 2:25), and He is trustworthy to do it unreservedly. He does so not because of what we are but because of who He is. God forgives and heals and restores, for He is “the God of all grace” (1 Peter 5:10). May we praise Him and trust Him.

from Sunday School Times

We have a God who delights in impossibilities and who asks, “Is anything too hard for me?” (Jer. 32:27).

Andrew Murray

November 23

You have shown your people desperate times. (Psalm 60:3)

Rock flowers grow and bloom only on rocks where you can see no soil.

Margaret Bottome

The trials of life are sent to make us, not to break us. Financial troubles may destroy a person’s business but build up his character. And a direct blow to the outer person may be the greatest blessing possible to the inner person. So if God places or allows anything difficult in our lives, we can be sure that the real danger or trouble will be what we will lose if we run or rebel against it.

Maltbie D. Babcock

November 24

你会发觉「将你的事交托耶和
华」是不可能的，除非你与祂同步。
惟有藉信来作成。同时，将你的路
呈献给祂定必要持续，不单只是偶
一为之的举动。

选

十一月二十二日

「你们信我能作这事么？」（太
9:28）

神专门作「不可能」的事。祂
这样作永不太迟，只要将「不可能」
带给祂的人有完全的信，因神的得
荣耀叫他的生命和环境被提升。神
会将「蝗虫那些年所吃的补还你
们。」（珥2:25）在无保留地作这
个上神值得信赖。祂这样作非因我
们而是祂的所是。神原谅，医治和
重建，因为祂是「那赐诸般恩典的
神」（彼前5:10）。让我们称赞祂
和信靠祂。

选自《主日学报》

我们有的神喜作不可能的事，
祂也是问「岂有我难成的事么？」
（耶32:27）的神。

慕·安德烈

十一月二十三日

「祢叫祢的民遇见艰难。」（诗
60:3）

石头花只在你看不见泥土的
石上生长和开花。

玛嘉烈·博滕美

生命的试炼是要作成，而非破
损我们。财务问题也许摧毁人的生
意，却也建立他的品格。一个人外
在正面冲击也许是他内在最大可
能的蒙福。因此神若放置或容许我
们的人生遇上任何困难时，我们可
以肯定的是真正的危险和艰难就
是我们因逃避或反叛时所失去的。

麦比·D·白确

十一月二十四日

Be still, and know that I am God. (Psalm 46:10)

Is there any note in all the music of the world as mighty as the grand pause? Is there any word in the Psalms more eloquent than the word “Selah,” meaning pause? Is there anything more thrilling and awe-inspiring than the calm before the crashing of the storm, or the strange quiet that seems to fall upon nature before some supernatural phenomenon or disastrous upheaval? And is there anything that can touch our hearts like the power of stillness?

There is “the peace of God, which transcends all understanding” (Phil. 4:7); “quietness and trust” (Isa. 30:15) is the source of all strength; a “great peace” that will never “make them stumble” (Ps. 119:165). Deep within the center of the soul is a chamber of peace where God lives and where, if we will enter it and quiet all the other sounds, we can hear His “gentle whisper” (1 Kings 19:12).

And even in the busiest life, there is a place where we may dwell alone with God in eternal stillness.

There is only one way to know God: “Be still, and know.” “The Lord is in his holy temple; let all the earth be silent before him” (Hab. 2:20).

selected

All-loving Father, Your soft whisper of eternal love spoke more sweetly to our bruised and bleeding souls than any winds that breathe across a wind harp. And when we heard Your voice and saw Your face, new life returned to us.

November 25

“Take the arrows....Strike the ground.” He struck it three times and stopped. The man of God was angry with him and said, “You should have struck the ground five or six times.” (2 Kings 13:18-19)

Jehoash, king of Israel did receive more than any human could have offered, but he did not receive God’s best. How important it is for us to learn to pray through our circumstances and to fully examine our hearts with God’s message to us! Otherwise, we will never claim all the fullness of His promise or all the possibilities that believing prayer offers.

A. B. Simpson

「你们要休息，要知道我是神。」
(诗46:10)

世上音乐有否任何音符比全休止更强而有力？在诗篇中否任何字词比起「细拉」更意味深长？有否任何事比起暴风来临前的平静，或一些超自然现象或灾难性的突变前临到大自然出奇的宁静更惊心动魄和激起惊惧？有没有任何东西比静止的能力更能触动我们的心灵？

有「神所赐出人意外的平安」(腓4:7)，「平静安稳」(赛30:15)是一切能力的来源。一个「极大的平安」永不「使他们绊脚」(诗119:165)。灵魂最深处是神所住和所在的平安之所，我们若进去，屏息所有其它声音时，便能听到祂「微小的声音。」(王上19:12)。

就是在最繁忙的生活中，总有一处可与神进到永恒的宁静中。

「要安静，要知道」是认识神的唯一方法。「惟耶和華在祂的聖殿中。全地的人都當在祂面前肅敬靜默。」(哈2:20)

选

全爱的父啊，祢永恒之爱的微声于我们受损流血的生命比任何风奏竖琴更柔美。当我们听见祢的声音和看见祢的脸面时，新生命重新回到我们那里。

十一月二十五日

「『取几枝箭来.....打地吧。』他打了三次，便止住了。神人向他发怒，说：『应当击打五六次。』」(王下13:18-19)

以色列王约阿施所得的真的多过任何人所能给的，但他得不着神最好的东西。透过环境学习祈祷和用神对我们说的信息来全面检视我们的心对我们何等重要！否则我们永不能获得祂全足的应许，也不能得着信心祈祷所有的一切可能性。

宣信

To him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us, to him be glory. Ephesians 3:20-21 "according to his power that is at work within us." He will only do as much for us as we will allow Him to do in us.

The Alliance

November 26

Caleb asked her, "What can I do for you?" She replied, "Do me a special favor. Since you have given me land in the Negev, give me also springs of water." So Caleb gave her the upper and lower springs. (Joshua 15:18-19)

These springs flow through the low places, the difficult places, the desert places, the lonely places, and even the ordinary places of life. Abraham found them amid the hills of Canaan. Moses found them among the rocks of Midian. David found them among the ashes of Ziklag, when his property was gone and his family had been taken captive. And although his "men were talking of stoning him ... David found strength in the Lord his God" (1 Sam. 30:6).

Isaiah found them in the terrible days when King Sennacherib of Assyria invaded Judah. His faith could still sing: "There is a river whose streams make glad the city of God, the holy place where the Most High dwells. God is within her, she will not fall" (Ps. 46:4-5).

The Christian martyrs found them amid the flames, the church reformers amid their enemies and struggles, and we can find them each day of the year if we have the Comforter in our hearts and have learned to say with David, "All my springs of joy are in you" (Ps. 87:7 NASB).

A. B. Simpson

November 27

Nothing is impossible with God. (Luke 1:37)

High in the snow-covered Alpine valleys, the soldanelle plant blooms unblemished. During the past summer the little plant spread its leaves wide and flat on the ground in order to soak up the sun's rays, and it kept that energy stored in its roots throughout the winter. At last the icy covering of the air compartment gave way, and the blossom burst into the sunshine.

「神能照着运行在我们心里的大力充充足足的成就一切，超过我们所求所想的。但愿祂得着荣耀。」(弗3:20-21)「照着运行在我们心里的大力」，祂只会照我们容许祂为我们作的多少来作在我们身上。

宣道报

十一月二十六日

「迦勒问她说：你要甚么。她说：求你赐福给我，你既将我安置在内地，求你也给我水泉。她父亲就把上泉下泉赐给她。」(书15:18-19)

这些泉水流经低下之地、困苦之地、沙漠之地、孤单之地，甚至乎平凡人生之地。亚伯拉罕在迦南山中找到，摩西在米甸石头之间找到，大卫在洗革拉的颓垣败瓦中找到，那时他的家人和财物都被掳去。虽然「众人.....要用石头打死他，大卫却倚靠耶和華他的神，心里坚固。」(撒下30:6)

在亚述王西拿基立攻打犹大的可怖日子中以赛亚找到，他的信心仍能唱：「有一道河，这河的分汊，使神的城欢喜。这城就是至高者居住的圣所。神在其中。城必不动摇。」(诗46:4-5)基督徒殉教士在火焰中找到，更正教者在敌人和挣扎中找到，我们在年中的每一日也能找到，只要有保惠师在心中，学懂与大卫同说：「我(喜乐)的泉源都在祢里面。」(诗87:7)

宣信

十一月二十七日

「因为出于神的话，没有一句不带能力的。」(路1:37)

在铺满冷雪的阿尔卑斯山谷高地，洁白无瑕的高山钟花海甘蓝在过去的夏天把它的叶片广阔地平放在地上，为的是吸收阳光，贮存在根部的能量使它熬过冬天。最终，空气中的冷意让路，花儿在阳光下盛放。红紫花瓣如水晶的质地

The crystalline texture of its mauve-colored petals sparkled like the snow itself, as if it still bore the marks of the journey it had endured.

For even if we took our circumstances and cast all the darkness of human doubt upon them and then hastily piled as many difficulties together as we could find against God's divine work, we could never move beyond the blessedness of His miracle-working power. May we place our faith completely in Him, for He is the God of the impossible.

selected

November 28

Where morning dawns and evening fades you call forth songs of joy. (Psalm 65:8)

The clear, pure light of the morning made me yearn for the truth in my heart, which alone could make me pure and clear as the morning itself and tune my life to the concert pitch of nature around me. And the breeze that blew from the sunrise made me hope in God, who had breathed into my nostrils the breath of life. He had so completely filled me with His breath, mind, and Spirit that I would only think His thoughts and live His life. Within His life I had found my own, but now it was eternally glorified.

What would we poor humans do without our God's nights and mornings!

George MacDonald

November 29

Later on, however ... (Hebrews 12:11)

A German baron who, at his castle on the Rhine, stretched a wind harp in the air from tower to tower. Yet as the soft breezes swirled around the castle, no music was born.

One night a fierce storm arose, and the wind harp was filling the air with melodies that rang out even above the noise of the storm. It had taken a fierce storm to produce the music!

Haven't we all known people whose lives have never produced any pleasing music during their days of calm prosperity?

You can always count on God to make the "later on" of difficulties a thousand times richer and better than the present, if we overcome them correctly. "No discipline seems pleasant at the time.... Later on, however, it produces a harvest of righteousness and

就像冰雪般闪耀，就像它仍刻有它所经炼过旅程的痕迹。

就算我们将我们将人所顾虑的一切黑暗全投进我们所处环境，之后草率地将尽多与神的圣工相反的困难堆在一起，这也永不能超越神奇妙工作能力的恩福。让我们将我们的信完全放在祂身上，因为祂是不可能之事的神。

选

十一月二十八日

「祢使日出日落之地都欢呼。」(诗 65:8)

清晨清纯之光使我心憧憬真理，独有它能使我像清晨般纯净透彻，调校我人生之音配合四周自然管弦乐的音域。日出吹来的微风使我对神心生盼望，是祂将生命气息吹进我鼻孔。祂曾以祂的呼气、心思和圣灵使我完全得充满，叫我因此只想祂想，和活出祂的生命。在祂的生命中我找到我自己的生命，如今是永远荣耀的了。

若没有我们神的晚上和早晨，我们可怜的人类会如何？

乔治·麦当劳

十一月二十九日

「.....后来却.....」(来12:11)

莱茵城堡的德国男爵在塔楼与塔楼之间拉设风之竖琴。然而若只有柔弱微风吹过城堡时，音乐是不能生成的。

一个晚上有厉害风暴来临，风之竖琴的琴音使空中满布旋律音调，乐声比暴风之声更响亮，原来要凶猛的暴风才能生出音乐！

我们岂不知人在平顺的日子是永不能生出任何悦耳音乐的。

我们的困难若解决得正确，总能认定神的「后来」比「如今」的解决丰富和好千倍。「凡管教的事当时不觉得快乐.....后来却结出平安的果子，就是义。」(来12:11)

peace” (Heb. 12:11). What a yield!

November 30

Should you then seek great things for yourself? Seek them not. For I will bring disaster on all people, declares the Lord, but wherever you go I will let you escape with your life. (Jeremiah 45:5)

“escape with your life” means your life will be snatched from the jaws of the Enemy, as David snatched the lamb from the lion. It does not mean you will be spared the heat of the battle and confrontation with your foes, but it means “a table before [you] in the presence of [your] enemies” (Ps. 23:5), a shelter from the storm, a fortress amid the foe, and a life preserved in the face of continual pressure. It means comfort and hope from God, such as Paul received when he and his friends “were under great pressure, far beyond [their] ability to endure, so that [they] despaired even of life” (2 Cor. 1:8). And it means the Lord’s divine help, such as when Paul’s “thorn in the flesh” (2 Cor. 12:7 KJV) remained, but the power of Christ came to rest upon him, and he learned that God’s “grace is sufficient” (2 Cor. 12:9).

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

The Savior endured an especially difficult test in the wilderness while in the presence of Satan for forty days and nights, the three Hebrew young men were kept for a time in the flames of “the furnace heated seven times hotter than usual” (Dan. 3:19); after surviving an entire night sitting among the lions, “when Daniel was lifted from the den, no wound was found on him, because he had trusted in his God” (Dan. 6:23). They were able to endure in the presence of their enemies because they dwelt in the presence of their God.

December 1

There remains, then, a Sabbath-rest for the people of God. (Hebrews 4:9)

That rest includes victory: “The Lord gave them rest on every side....The Lord handed all their enemies over to them” (Josh. 21:44). “Thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ” (1 Cor. 15:57).

A prominent believer once told of his mother,

何等的果子！

十一月三十日

「你为自己图谋大事么？不要图谋，我必使灾祸临到凡有血气的。但你无论往哪里去，我必使你以自己的命为掠物，这是耶和华说的。」（耶45:5）

「你以自己的命为掠物」是说你的生命从敌人的牙缝中夺回，如大卫从狮子的口夺回羊羔一样。这不是说你可免于战火和与敌对，而是说「在敌人面前为你摆设筵席」（诗23:5），暴风中的荫庇所，敌人中的坚城，面对不断压力下生命得保存。它说到从神来的安慰和盼望，也就是「遭遇苦难，被压太重，力不能胜，甚至连活命的指望都绝了」（林后1:8）中保罗所得到的。它是说到耶和华的帮助，就如保罗说「加在我肉体上的一根刺」（林后12:7）仍在，但基督的能力来安息在他处，他便学会了神的「恩典是够用的」（林后12:9）。

摘自《地上若天的日子》

救主在旷野四十昼夜接受撒但尤其厉害的试探；那三个希伯来少年人被关在「比寻常更加七倍烧热的」（但3:19）火焰中一段时间；整夜坐在狮子群中仍存活下，「但以理从坑里被系上来，身上毫无伤损，因为信靠他的神。」（但6:23）他们能在敌人面前忍耐到底是因为他们安居在他们的神的同在中。

十二月一日

「这样看来，必另有一安息日的安息，为神的子民存留。」（来4:9）

这安息包含得胜，「耶和华.....使他们四境平安.....耶和华把一切仇敌都交在他们手中。」（书21:44）

「感谢神，使我们藉着我们的主耶稣基督得胜。」（林前15:57）

一个杰出信徒有一次谈及他

who was a very anxious and troubled Christian. Then one morning his mother came to breakfast with a smile adorning her face. She began describing a dream she had in the night.

In her dream she noticed that more bundles were being dropped along the way by numerous repulsive-looking creatures that seemed quite demonic in nature. Like everyone else in her dream, she also carried her needless load. After a while, she looked up and saw a Man whose face was loving and bright. She realized it was her Savior. He smiled sadly and said, "My dear child, these bundles you carry are not from me. You need to drop them, and you will feel as if 'I carried you on eagles' wings' [Ex. 19:4]."

December 2

... *perfect through suffering*. (Hebrews 2:10)

A mother brought a crippled boy with a hunched back into her home as a companion for her own son. She warned her son to be very careful not to refer to the other boy's deformity. But after listening to her son play with him for a few minutes, she heard him ask his companion, "Do you know what that is on your back? It is the box that holds your wings, and someday God is going to break it open, and you will fly away to be an angel."

Someday God is going to reveal this fact to every Christian: the very things they now rebel against are the instruments He has used to perfect their character and to mold them into perfection, so they may later be used as polished stones in His heaven yet to come.

Cortland Myers

Suffering is a wonderful fertilizer for the roots of character. The great objective of this life is character, for it is the only thing we can carry with us into eternity. And gaining as much of the highest character possible is the purpose of our trials.

Austin Phelps

The mountain of vision is won by no other road than the one covered with thorns.

December 3

"Is your husband all right? Is your child all right?" "Everything is all right," she said. (2 Kings 4:26)

For sixty-two years and five months George

那十分焦虑和忧愁的基督徒母亲。但有一个早上母亲脸上装着微笑来进早餐，她描述晚上所发的梦。

在梦中她发觉沿途上有很多似乎有魔鬼属性丑恶的生物丢下更多的捆包。她在梦中像其它人一样背负那些不需负的重担。一会儿后她抬头望见一人，祂脸面慈祥 and 光明，她立时知道这是她的救主。祂便伤心地微笑着说：「孩子啊，这些你背的捆包不是我的。你需丢下他们，你必会感觉到「我如鹰将你们背在翅膀上」（出19:4）。

十二月二日

「因受苦难得以完全。」(来2:10)

一个妇人收养一个跛脚驼背的男孩回去作她儿子的陪伴。她千叮万嘱儿子要当心不要提及那男孩的残障。但儿子与他玩了一会儿后便听见他问同伴：「你知否在你背上的是甚么？这是一个盛着你双翼的盒子，有一日神会打开它，那你便会像天使般飞翔。」

有一日神会向每个基督徒揭露这事实：他们今日所抗拒的东西是神用来使他们品格完美和模造成完全工具的，因此他们不久在要来的神国中作打磨好的活石。

哥兰·迈亚斯

受苦是品格之根的奇妙肥料。品格是我们今生的伟大目标，因为这是我们唯一随身带进永恒的东西，而我们所受试炼的目的就是尽可能获取最多的崇高品格。

岳士亭·斐尔泼斯

饱览山顶风景的路径别无他选，惟有那一条铺满荆棘之路。

十二月三日

「你丈夫平安么？孩子平安么？」她说：平安。」(王下4:26)

结婚六十二年零五个月的慕

Mueller's wife, in his ninety-second year, left. He turned to the ever present Jesus and said, "Lord Jesus, I am alone. Yet I am not alone, for You are with me and are my Friend. Now, Lord, please comfort me, strengthen me, and give to Your poor servant everything that You see I need."

George Mueller

December 4

He went up on a mountainside by himself. (Matthew 14:23)

One of the blessings of the old-time Sabbath day was the calmness, restfulness, and holy peace that came from having a time of quiet solitude away from the world. There is a special strength that is born in solitude. Strength is found not in busyness and noise but in quietness. For a lake to reflect the heavens on its surface, it must be calm. Our Lord loved the people who flocked to him, but there are numerous accounts in the Scriptures of His going away from them for a brief period of time. On occasion He would withdraw from the crowd and quite often would spend His evenings alone in the hills. Most of His ministry was performed in the towns and cities by the seashore, but He loved the hills more and at nightfall would frequently seclude Himself in their peaceful heights. The one thing we need today more than anything else is to spend time alone with our Lord, sitting at His feet in the sacred privacy of His blessed presence. Oh, how we need "the secret place" (Ps. 91:1 KJV) as part of our lifestyle!

selected

December 5

I know, O Lord, that a man's life is not his own; it is not for man to direct his steps. (Jeremiah 10:23)

Lead me in a straight path. (Psalm 27:11)

Many people want to direct God instead of surrendering themselves to be directed by Him. They want to show Him the way instead of submissively following where He leads.

Madame Guyon

December 6

I am coming soon. Hold on to what you have, so that no one will take your crown. (Revelation 3:11)

In July 1829 it pleased God to reveal to George

穆勒太太在他九十二岁之年离他而去。他在房子里对常在的耶稣说：「主耶稣，我孤单；却也不孤单，因祢与我一起，祢是我朋友。主啊来安慰我，加我力量，给我这可怜的仆人祢看为需要的每样东西。」

慕勒

十二月四日

「祂就独自上山去祷告。」(太 14:23)

古时安息日其中一样福就是平静、安息和神圣的平安，是来自远离世界而有一刻独处的宁静。独处能产生特别的能力。力量不在忙碌中，而是在宁静中找到。若一湖面能反映天空，定必是平静的。我们的主喜爱人们拥挤祂，但在圣经多处记载祂有短暂远离他们的一刻。有时祂从群众中抽离，颇常在山间度过那些晚上。祂大部分的事奉是在海边的城镇或城市中进行，但祂更喜爱来到山上，在高山的和平安静中常使自己独自度过深宵。今天我们所需比一切更要紧的是与我们的主单独相交，在祂赐恩同在的神圣之地，坐在祂脚前。噢，我们所需的是以那「隐密处」(诗 91:1)作为我们人生的一部分！

选

十二月五日

「耶和華阿，我曉得人的道路不由自己，行路的人也不能定自己的腳步。」(耶 10:23)

很多人想指揮神而不是降服自己來被神指揮，他們想向神指示當行的路而不是順服地跟隨祂的帶領。

蓋恩夫人

十二月六日

「我必快來，你要持守你所有的，免得人奪去你的冠冕。」(啟 3:11)

在1829年7月神樂意在慕勒心

Mueller's heart the truth regarding the return of the Lord Jesus and to show him that he had made a great mistake by sitting back and watching for the complete conversion of the world. Deep within his soul, he was moved to feel compassion for perishing sinners and for a world lulled to sleep by the wicked Enemy. And he began to think, 'Should I not do whatever I can for the Lord Jesus and try to awake His slumbering church before He returns?'"

There may still be many difficult years of hard work ahead of us before the fulfillment of His prophetic return, but the signs of His coming today are very encouraging.

Thomas De Witt Talmage

December 7

You will see neither wind nor rain, yet this valley will be filled with water, and you, your cattle and your other animals will drink. This is an easy thing in the eyes of the Lord; he will also hand Moab over to you. (2 Kings 3:17-18)

"The next morning ... there it was ... ! And the land was filled with water....The sun was shining on the water....[And it] looked red—like blood" (vv. 20, 22).

The greatest triumph of a person's faith is to "be still, and know that [He is] God" (Ps. 46:10). The greatest victory of faith is to stand at the shore of the impassable Red Sea and to hear the Master say, "Stand firm and you will see the deliverance the Lord will bring you today" (Ex. 14:13), and "Move on" (Ex. 14:15).

It is the role of faith not to question but to simply obey. Are you desiring some spiritual blessing? Then dig the ditches and God will fill them. But He will do this in the most unexpected places and in the most unexpected ways. May the Lord grant us the kind of faith that acts "by faith, not by sight" (2 Cor. 5:7), and may we expect Him to work although we see no wind or rain.

A. B. Simpson

December 8

As God's chosen people ... clothe yourselves with ... kindness. (Colossians 3:12)

In this world, there are many lives that painfully creak and grate as they go about their daily work.

中显明主耶稣再来的真理，和叫他见到他犯了一个大错，就是退去留意世人全部的对话。在他灵魂的深处，因见到失丧的罪人和被那恶毒的敌人催眠沉睡的世人而感到同情。他开始想：「我岂不应为主耶稣竭尽所能，和尽力去在祂回来之前唤醒祂沉睡的教会么？」

在祂预言的再来得应验之前还有很多艰难工作的岁月在我们前头，而且祂再来的征兆今天看来是十分振奋人心的。

多玛士·底域·他马治

十二月七日

「你们虽不见风，不见雨，这谷必满了水，使你们和牲畜有水喝。在耶和华眼中这还算为小事，祂也必将摩押人交在你们手中。」(王下 3:17-18)

「次日早晨，.....遍地就满了水.....次日早晨，日光照在水上.....对面水红如血。」(王下 3:20, 22)

人信心最伟大的胜利就在于「你们要休息，要知道我是神」(诗 46:10)上，信的最大胜利就在于站在不可能渡过的红海岸边听神所说：「只管站住，看耶和华今天向你们所要施行的救恩」(出 14:13)，和「往前走」(出 14:15)。

信的角色不是发问而是单单顺从。你是否渴慕属灵祝福？那么挖沟来让神充满他们吧，但祂要在最意想不到的地方和以最意想不到的方法来作。愿神赐我们那种信心，「是凭着信心，不是凭着眼见。」(林后 5:7)，让我们在看不见风和雨的情形下来期待祂来作工。

宣信

十二月八日

「所以你们既是神的选民，.....就要穿怜悯。」(西 3:12)

在今世有很多人是痛苦地呻吟作声来作他们的日务。他们似乎

Often it seems that nothing goes right with them and that they need lubricating with “the oil of joy” (Ps. 45:7), gentleness, or thoughtfulness. If you offer your oil to the person nearest you, it may just lubricate the entire day for him. Your oil of cheerfulness will mean more than you know to someone who is downhearted. Or the oil may be a word of encouragement to a person who is full of despair. Never fail to speak it, for our lives may touch others only once on the road of life, and then our paths may diverge, never to meet again. The oil of kindness has worn the sharp, hard edges off many a sin-hardened life and left it soft and pliable, ready to receive the redeeming grace of the Savior. A pleasant word is a bright ray of sunshine on a saddened heart. Therefore give others the sunshine and tell Jesus the rest.

Be devoted to one another in brotherly love.
Romans 12:10

December 9

Our light and momentary troubles are achieving for us an eternal glory that far outweighs them all. (2 Corinthians 4:17)

These “momentary troubles are achieving for us” something very precious. They are teaching us not only the way to victory but, better still, the law of victory—there is a reward for every sorrow, and the sorrow itself produces the reward.

Joy sometimes needs pain to give it birth.

Fanny Crosby could never have written the beautiful words “I shall see Him face to face” if not for the fact that she had never gazed upon green fields, evening sunsets, nor even the twinkle in her mother’s eye. It was the loss of her own vision that helped her to gain her remarkable spiritual discernment and insight.

“Weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning” (Ps. 30:5).

from Songs in the Night

December 10

But if we are afflicted, it is for your comfort and salvation; if we are comforted, it is for your comfort that you experience in your patient endurance of the same sufferings that we also suffer. And our hope for

处处碰壁，正需要温柔、体贴的「喜乐油」(诗45:7)滋润。你若将你的油给你最接近的人，这可能正能滋润他的一整天。欢快的油对于那些消沉的人是超乎你所能理解的。这油可以是充满失望之人的一句鼓励的话。不要不说，因为在人生路上遇见的人可能只有一次，从此便要分道扬镳，永不再会。仁慈的油能磨掉众多犯罪极深生命的尖锐和坚硬的边棱，变得柔滑和松软，随时准备好接受救主的救恩。一句欢愉的话就像破损心灵的一袭阳光。所以先将阳光给人，后才把耶稣介绍。

「爱弟兄，要彼此亲热。」(罗12:10)

十二月九日

「我们这至暂至轻的苦楚，要为我们成就极重无比永远的荣耀。」(林后4:17)

那些「至暂的苦楚为我们成就」的东西十分宝贵。他们不单止教导我们得胜的方法，更重要的是那得胜之律——每个忧伤总有回报，是忧伤本身产生出回报。

有时需要痛苦来生出喜乐。

若非芬妮·哥斯比从未亲见翠绿田野、日落黄昏、甚至连母亲的眨眼，便永不能写出「我必能面对面见」这优美词句。就是失去一己视力来帮助她获得这出类拔萃属灵的识别能力和灵感。

「一宿虽然有哭泣，早晨便必欢呼。」(诗30:5)

摘自《夜间歌唱》

十二月十日

「我们受患难呢，是为叫你们得安慰得拯救。我们得安慰呢，也是为叫你们得安慰。这安慰能叫你们忍受我们所受的那样苦楚。我们为你

you is steadfast because we know that as you share in our sufferings, so also you will share in our comfort. (2 Cor 1:6-7)

Are there not some in your circle to whom you naturally betake yourself in times of trial and sorrow? They always seem to speak the right word, to give the very counsel you are longing for; you do not realize, however, the cost which they had to pay ere they became so skillful in binding up the gaping wounds and drying tears. But if you were to investigate their past history you would find that they have suffered more than most. They have watched the slow untwisting of some silver cord on which the lamp of life hung. They have seen the golden bowl of joy dashed to their feet, and its contents spilt. They have stood by ebbing tides, and drooping gourds, and noon sunsets; but all this has been necessary to make them the nurses, the physicians, the priests of men. Do not fret, or set your teeth, or wait doggedly for the suffering to pass; but get out of it all you can, both for yourself and for your service to your generation, according to the will of God.

Selected

December 11

Praise the Lord, all you servants of the Lord who minister by night in the house of the Lord....May the Lord, the Maker of heaven and earth, bless you from Zion. (Psalm 134:1, 3)

It is easy for me to worship in the summer sunshine. But when the songbirds cease and the fruit falls from the trees, will my heart continue to sing? Will I remain in God's house at night? Will I love Him simply for who He is? Am I willing to "keep watch for one hour" (Mark 14:37) with Him in His Gethsemane? Will I help Him carry His cross up the road of suffering to Calvary? Will I stand beside Him in His dying moments, with Mary, His mother, and John, the beloved disciple? Would I be able, with Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus, to take the dead Christ from His cross?

My faith has seen Him in His lowest state, and yet my heart has recognized His majesty through His humble disguise. And at last I truly know that I desire not the gift but the Giver.

George Matheson

们所存的盼望是确定的，因为知道你们既是同受苦楚，也必同得安慰。」(林后1:6-7)

在你圈子中有否一些人当你遇上试炼和忧伤时你便自然投身他们而去？他们似乎常能说合适的话，给予你正想望的辅导。但你不会明了他们能熟练地包裹爆烈的伤口和拭干眼泪所曾付出的代价。他们曾看着悬在生命之灯的银芯慢慢熄灭，他们曾见着喜乐金碗的破裂，太阳正值当午便落下。但这些都是使他们成为护士、医生和牧者的必需。不要烦躁，也不要咬牙切齿，顽强地等待苦痛的过去，而是按神的旨意尽你所能从痛苦中出来，是为你自己也同时是为你所服事的世代。

选

十二月十一日

耶和华的仆人们，夜间站在耶和华的殿中的，你们当称颂耶和華.....愿造天地的耶和華，从锡安赐福给你们。」(诗134:1,3)

在阳光普照的夏日下敬拜于我是容易的；当唱鸟住声，树果掉下，我的心会否继续歌唱？会否留在神的殿中守夜？会否只因祂所是而爱祂？愿否跟祂在客西马尼园「儆醒片时」(可14:37)？愿否在受苦的路上背起祂的十字架往各各他？在祂快要死亡一刻我愿否与祂的母亲马利亚和祂所爱的门徒约翰站在祂旁边？我能否与亚利马太的约瑟和尼哥底母从十字架取下死去基督的身体来？

我在信中得见最卑微的祂，就算在祂谦卑的遮弊下我心还能辨识祂的尊荣，至终我真知道我所渴慕的不是恩赐而是赐恩者了。

乔治·马得胜

December 12

I am already being poured out like a drink offering, and the time has come for my departure. I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. (2 Timothy 4:6-7)

When we arrive at our heavenly home, we will tell of the goodness and faithfulness of God, who brought us through every trial along the way. I would not like to stand with the multitude clothed in robes made “white in the blood of the Lamb” (Rev. 7:14)

May we be content to share in the battle, for we will soon wear a crown of reward and wave a palm branch of praise.

Charles H. Spurgeon

An American Civil War wounded soldier was not thinking of his gaping wound but was only remembering that he had won the ground near the top of the mountain. “I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.”

What nobler medal of honor could any godly person seek than the scars of service, personal loss for the crown of reward, disgrace for the sake of Christ, and being worn out in the Master’s service!

December 13

I will give you the treasures of darkness. (Isaiah 45:3)

In the famous lace shops of Brussels, lace is always more beautifully and delicately woven when the weaver himself is in the dark, with only his work in the light.

Sometimes the darkness in our lives is worse, because we cannot even see the web we are weaving or understand what we are doing. Therefore we are unable to see any beauty or any possible good arising from our experience. Yet if we are faithful to forge ahead and “if we do not give up” (Gal. 6:9), someday we will know that the most exquisite work of our lives was done during those days when it was the darkest.

J. R. Miller

December 14

One of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray....” He said to them, “When you pray, say: “... Your kingdom come.” (Luke 11:1-2)

十二月十二日

「我现在被浇奠，我离世的时候到了。那美好的仗我已经打过了，当跑的路我已经跑尽了，所信的道我已经守住了。」（提后4:6-7）

当我们来到我们的天家时，便会谈到沿途领我们经过每个试炼之神的美善和信实。我不喜欢与「用羔羊的血把衣裳洗白净」（启7:14）之群众站在一起。

让我们满足于有战事的分享，皆因我们必快得戴上作为奖赏的冠冕和摇动那赞美的棕树枝。

司布真

一个美国内战受伤的士兵没有想到他的伤口，只想到他近山顶处所赢得的土地。「那美好的仗我已经打过了，当跑的路我已经跑尽了，所信的道我已经守住了。」

敬虔人追求的荣耀勋章中没有比事奉中的伤痕、为得赐冠冕而有的个人损失、为基督受的耻辱和服事主而得的劳累更尊贵！

十二月十三日

「我要将暗中的宝物.....赐给你。」（赛45:3）

在布鲁塞尔著名的饰带商店中，饰带若要编织得更美丽和更精巧，就只有织造者坐在黑暗中，聚精会神在光线中工作。

有时我们生命中的黑暗更恶劣，因我们连所织造的也看不见，也不明白在作甚么。因此我们不能从经验中得见任何美丽或美善之物。我们若忠诚地前进，「若不灰心」（加6:9），终有一日我们可知道我们生命中最精美的工夫就是在我们最黑暗的日子中所作的。

J.R.米勒

十二月十四日

「有个门徒对他说：求主教导我们祷告。耶稣说：你们祷告的时候，要说.....愿祢的国降临。」（路11:1-2）

How do we pray when we follow the desires of our own hearts? We say, "Lord, bless me, then my family, my church, my city, and my country." We start with those closest to us and gradually move outward, ultimately praying for the expansion of God's kingdom throughout the world.

Our Master's prayer, however, begins where we end. He taught us to pray for the world first and our personal needs second. Only after our prayer has covered every continent, every remote island of the sea, every person in the last hidden tribe, and every desire and purpose of God for the world are we taught to ask for a piece of bread for ourselves.

Dr. Francis

"His kingdom will never end" (Luke 1:33), an old Moravian version says, "His Kingdom shall have no frontier." Missionary work should never be an afterthought of the church, because it is Christ's forethought.

Henry Jackson Van Dyke

December 15

Trust in him. (Psalm 37:5)

The word "trust" is the heart of faith and is the Old Testament word given to the infant, or early, stages of faith. The word "faith" conveys more an act of the will, while the word "belief" conveys an act of the mind or intellect, but trust is the language of the heart.

Trust implies more than this, for it sees and feels and it leans on those who have a great, living, and genuine heart of love. Therefore let us "trust also in Him" (Ps. 37:5 KJV), through all the delays, in spite of all the difficulties, and in the face of all the rejection we encounter in life. And in spite of our feelings and evidence to the contrary, and even when we cannot understand our way or our situation, may we still "trust also in him; [for] he shall bring it to pass."

December 16

There was also a prophetess, Anna....She never left the temple but worshiped night and day, fasting and praying. (Luke 2:36-37)

People who pray in spurts are never likely to attain to the kind of prayer described in the Scriptures as "powerful and effective" (James 5:16).

当我们随心所欲时会怎样祈祷呢？我们说：「主啊，赐福我，之后赐福我的家庭、我的教会、我的城市、和我们国家。」我们从最亲近我们的人开始，逐渐向外移，最终扩展至神遍布世界的神之国。

但我们主的祷告以我们的结尾为开始。祂教导我们先为世界祈祷，我们个人需要次之。我们的祷告要覆盖每个洲、每个海外的离岛、最后隐秘民族的每一个人、和神为世人的每个渴想和目的而教导我们为我们自己求取一片面包。

弗朗西斯博士

「祂的国也没有穷尽。」(路 1:33) 一个古老的莫拉维亚版本说：「祂的国也没有疆界。」传教工作从不是教会的后知后觉，而是基督的先知先觉。

亨利·积臣·凡第

十二月十五日

「倚靠祂。」(诗 37:5)

「倚靠」一词是信的中心，也是说到信心的早期或雏阶的旧约词汇。「信靠」多传递意志之举，而「相信」传递心思或理智之举，但「倚靠」发自内心。

倚靠所指比这更多，因它看见和感受到，依附那些有伟大、活泼和真心去爱的人。因此，不管一切的延迟，不计较困难，和面对人生所遇的一切反对，让我们「也倚靠祂」。不论我们的感觉如何，证据如何相反，甚至当我们不能明白我们的前路和处境时，让我们仍「倚靠祂」，因祂必会带领我们经过。」

十二月十六日

「又有女先知名叫亚拿，.....并不离开圣殿，禁食祈求。」(路 2:36-37)

突发祈祷的人永不可能达至圣经所描述「大有功效」(雅 5:16) 的祈祷。有功效的祈祷唾手可得，

Great power in prayer is within our reach, but we must work to obtain it. We should never even imagine that Abraham could have interceded so successfully for Sodom if he had not communed with God throughout the previous years of his life. Jacob's entire night of wrestling at Peniel was certainly not the first encounter he had with his God. And we can even look at our Lord's most beautiful and wonderful prayer in John 17, before His suffering and death, as the fruit of His many nights of devotion, and of His rising often before daybreak to pray. The prayer of Elijah, which stopped the rain from heaven and later opened heaven's floodgates, was only one example of a long series of his mighty pleadings with God.

The great intercessors, who are seldom mentioned in connection with the heroes and martyrs of the faith, were nevertheless the greatest benefactors of the church.

Charles H. Spurgeon

December 17

May God himself, the God of peace, sanctify you through and through. May your whole spirit, soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. The one who calls you is faithful and he will do it. (1 Thessalonians 5:23-24)

I began following this truth "without holiness no one will see the Lord" (Heb. 12:14), and encouraging everyone with whom I spoke to do the same.

John Wesley in 1771

When I gave Jesus my will, He came to my heart and removed everything that would not stay pleasant, patient, and kind. And then He shut the door.

George Fox

At this very moment, my entire heart does not have even a hint of thirst after my acceptance by God. I am alone with Him and He fills every void. I do not have one wish, one will, or one desire, except in Him.

Lady Huntington

Suddenly I felt as if a hand—not weak but omnipotent, and not of wrath but of love—were laid

但我们须努力才能获得。我们永不要以为亚伯拉罕在没有经年累月与神的相交下能成功地代求。雅各布整夜在毘努伊勒与神摔跤肯定不是他首次与神的接触。在约17章我们的主在受苦前最美丽和奇妙的祈祷中我们得见，这是祂多晚与神亲近的果子，祂常时在日出之前便起来祷告。伊莱贾叫天不下雨和后来叫天开启那暴雨天门的祈祷只是向神发出那有力的恳求长长系列中的一个例子。

很少与信心英雄和殉教士相提并论的代祷者却是使教会获益最多的人。

司布真

十二月十七日

「愿赐平安的神，亲自使你们全然成圣。又愿你们的灵、与魂、与身子，得蒙保守，在我主耶稣基督降临的时候，完全无可指摘。那召你们的本是信实的，祂必成就这事。」
(帖前5:23-24)

我多年来遵照「非圣洁没有人能见主」(来12:14)这真理而行，并鼓励每个我交通的人这样。

约翰·卫斯理1771年

当我将我的意志交给耶稣时，祂进入我心来除去一切叫我不快乐、不耐和仁慈的东西，之后祂也把门关上了。

乔治·霍克斯

在我被神接纳那一刻，我整个心一丝干渴也没有了。独有祂与我一起，祂把我的每个空虚都充满。我一个愿望、一个渴望也没有，惟独想要祂。

肯定顿夫人

忽尔我感觉到有一只手放在我的额上，不是软弱而是全能的

on my forehead. Yet I did not feel it as much outwardly as inwardly. It seemed to be pressing in on my entire being and sending a holy, sin-consuming energy throughout me. As it moved downward, my heart as well as my head was aware of the presence of this soul-cleansing energy. Under its power I fell to the floor, and in the joyful wonder of the moment, I cried out in a loud voice. This hand of power continued to work without and within me, and wherever it moved, it seemed to leave the glorious influence of the Savior's image. And for several minutes, the deep ocean of God's love swallowed me, as all its waves and billows rolled over me.

Bishop Hamline

December 18

In all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. (Romans 8:37)

The gospel and the gift of God are structured so wonderfully that the very enemies and forces that are marshaled to fight against us actually help pave our way to the very gates of heaven and into the presence of God.

When Dr. Moon, of Brighton, England, was suddenly struck with blindness, he said, "Lord, I accept this 'talent' of blindness from You. Help me to use it for Your glory so that when You return, you may receive it 'back with interest' [Matt. 25:27]." Then God enabled him to invent the Moon Alphabet for the blind, through which thousands of blind people were enabled to read the Word of God and thereby come to the glorious saving knowledge of Christ.

selected

December 19

This will result in your being witnesses to them. (Luke 21:13)

Life is a steep climb, and it is always encouraging to have those ahead of us "call back" and cheerfully summon us to higher ground. We all climb together, so we should help one another. And as our view becomes better as we gain altitude, and as we discover things of importance, we should "call back" our encouragement to others.

手，不是愤怒而是爱的手，但我不能知道这是外在的还是内里的。它似乎是按压在我的整个人身上，送来一个神圣、消灭罪的能量贯彻全身。当它向下移时，我的心和我的头是觉知有这洁除灵魂之能力的存在。在它的能力之下我倒在地上，在这欣喜的一刻中，我大声喊叫出来。这能力之手继续在我身外身内来工作，无论它到何处，似乎都要留下救主形像的荣耀印记。为期几分钟，神爱的极深洋海把我吞噬，它的所有浪涛漫过我全身。

含连主教

十二月十八日

「然而靠着爱我们的主，在这一切的事上，已经得胜有余了。」(罗8:37)

神的福音和恩赐是建构得那么奇妙，以致排山倒海地来与我们作战的仇敌和势力却成为我们引往天门和神所在之路的帮助。

当英国布列顿的满恩博士突然瞎眼时，他说：「主啊，我接受这从祢而来的『才干』。帮助我用这来荣耀祢，因此当祢再来时，祢收回它时是附有利息的(太25:27)。」之后神使他发明给盲人用的满恩氏字母，使成千上万的盲人能够阅读神的话语和得着对基督荣耀拯救的认识。

选

十二月十九日

「但这些事终必为你们的见证。」(路21:13)

生命是陟坡攀登，前头之人的「向后呼叫」总鼓舞我们，且鼓起我们的勇气乐意向高处行。我们既一起攀登，好应互相帮助。我们上得越高，观景越壮丽。当我们发现重要事物时，好应向后呼叫来鼓励后上之人。

December 20

I am not alone, for my Father is with me. (John 16:32)

The person who will ultimately soar like an eagle to the heights of the cloudless day and live in the sunshine of God must be content to live a relatively lonely life.

No one ever comes into the full realization of the best things of God in his spiritual life without learning to walk alone with Him. We see Abraham alone “in the land of Canaan, while Lot lived among the cities ... near Sodom” (Gen. 13:12). Moses, although educated in all the wisdom of Egypt, had to spend forty years alone with God in the desert. And Paul, who was filled with all the knowledge of the Greeks and who sat “at the feet of Gamaliel” (Acts 22:3 KJV), was required, after meeting Jesus, to go “immediately into Arabia” (Gal. 1:17) to learn of the desert life with God.

We must dare to be alone, in the way that Jacob had to be alone for the Angel of God to whisper in his ear, “Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel” (Gen. 32:28); in the way that Daniel had to be left alone to see heavenly visions; and in the way that John had to be banished to the Isle of Patmos to receive and record “the revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him” (Rev. 1:1).

He has “trodden the winepress alone” (Isa. 63:3) for us. Therefore, are we prepared for a time of “glorious isolation” rather than to fail Him?

December 21

I will give him ... the land he set his feet on, because he followed the Lord wholeheartedly. (Deuteronomy 1:36)

Every difficult task that comes across your path—every one that you would rather not do, that will take the most effort, cause the most pain, and be the greatest struggle—brings a blessing with it.

Every difficult stretch of road on which you see the Master's footprints and along which He calls you to follow Him leads unquestionably to blessings.

J. R. Miller

December 22

A thick and dreadful darkness came over him. (Genesis 15:12)

十二月二十日

「其实我不是独自一人，因为有父与我同在。」（约16:32）

那些终能如鹰在无云日子高飞，活在神的欢快中的人定必要乐于在一个相对孤单的生命中活。

人若未学会单独与祂同行，便永不能在他的属灵生命中全然明白神最佳美的事物。我们见到亚伯拉罕孤单地「住在迦南地，罗得住在平原的城邑……直到所多玛」（创13:12）。摩西虽在埃及的一切智慧中受教育，却四十年之久单独与神在旷野中。而那个充满一切希腊知识和「在迦玛列门下」（徒22:3）的保罗遇上耶稣后，便「往亚拉伯去」（加1:17）学习与神一起的旷野生活。

我们须敢于按雅各布的方法孤单，天使在他耳中低语：「你的名不要再叫雅各布，要叫以色列」（创32:28）；学但以理般离群独处来看见天上的异象；学约翰般被放逐到拔摩海岛得听和记录「耶稣基督的启示，就是神赐给祂的启示」（启1:1）。

祂已为我们「独自踞酒醺」（赛63:3），因此，我们准备好度「荣耀隔离」的时光还是要叫祂失望？

十二月二十一日

「我要将他所踏过的地赐给他……因为他专心跟从我。」（申1:36）

每一项你路上遇见的困难工作，就是你宁愿，要花你最大精力，造成最大痛苦，要最大奋斗的工作，其实也是带来福分的工作。

每段你见到主人足迹难行的路程，也是祂呼召你来跟随祂的路程，毫无疑问也会带来祝福。

J.R.米勒

十二月二十二日

「忽然有惊人的大黑暗落在他身上。」（创15:12）

Abraham “fell into a deep sleep” (v. 12). During his sleep, his soul was oppressed with “a thick and dreadful darkness,” which seemed to smother him and felt like a nightmare in his heart.

And know that He who endured the “dreadful darkness” of Calvary and the feeling of having been forsaken on the cross is ready to accompany you “through the valley of the shadow of death” (Ps. 23:4) until you can see the sun shining on the other side.

May we realize that “we have this hope as an anchor for the soul, firm and secure” and that “it enters the inner sanctuary behind the curtain” (Heb. 6:19). And may we know that although it is unseen within His sanctuary, our anchor will be grounded and will never yield. It will hold firm until the day He returns, and then we too will follow it into the safe haven guaranteed to us in God’s unchangeable Word.

F. B. Meyer

Your unbelieving heart cries out, as Gideon once did, “If the Lord is with us, why has all this happened to us?” (Judg. 6:13). God has allowed the difficulty to come upon you, in order to bring you closer to Himself. It has come not to separate you from Jesus but to cause you to cling to Him more faithfully, more firmly, and more simply.

F. S. Webster

December 23

The journey is too much for you. (1 Kings 19:7)

What did God do with Elijah, His tired servant? He allowed him to sleep and then gave him something good to eat. Elijah had done tremendous work and in his excitement had run “ahead of Ahab[’s chariot] all the way to Jezreel” (1 Kings 18:46). But the run had been too much for him and had sapped his physical strength, ultimately causing him to become depressed. Just as others in this condition need sleep and want their ailments treated, Elijah’s physical requirements needed to be met. There are many wonderful people who end up where Elijah did—“under a juniper tree” (1 Kings 19:4 KJV)! “Get up and eat, for the journey is too much for you.”

Therefore may we never confuse physical weariness with spiritual weakness.

December 24

「埃布尔兰沉沉的睡了」。当他睡着时，他的魂受压于惊人的大黑暗中，似乎要使他透不过气来，像是心中的噩梦似的。

要认识那位忍受加略山「惊人黑暗」和在十字架上被离弃之感觉的那位已准备好陪伴你「经过死荫的幽谷」（诗23:4），直至你能见到那一边的普照阳光。

让我们认识「我们有这指望如同灵魂的锚，又坚固又牢靠，且通入幔内的至圣所。」（来6:19）让我们也认识在祂至圣所内虽看不见，但我们的锚必抛牢和永不误事。它必会牢靠直至祂回来之日，我们之后便跟随它进入那神不变的话语所向我们保证的安全港口。

迈尔

你不信的心像基甸有一次曾呼喊的说：「耶和華若与我们同在，我们何至遭遇这一切事呢？」（士6:13）神容许困难来到你处，为带你与祂更亲近。它的来到不是来使你与耶稣分离，而是使你更忠诚，更牢固和更单纯地连于祂。

F.S.韦伯士打

十二月二十三日

「你当走的路甚远。」（王上19:7）

神向祂的疲倦仆人伊莱贾作甚么？祂容许他睡一觉，后给他好东西吃。伊莱贾作罢伟大工作，在兴奋中跑在亚哈的马车前头一直到耶斯列（王上18:46）。这次跑步对他来说过多了，致使他力气衰竭，至终他变得沮丧。伊莱贾如同其它人一样需要睡眠和处理失调之处，他在这情况下身体得着所需满足。有很多行大事的人最终来到伊莱贾所到之地，「一棵罗腾树下」（王上19:4）。「起来吃吧，因为你当走的路甚远。」

因此让我们不要将身体的疲累和灵性的软弱混为一谈。

十二月二十四日

He went out to the field one evening to meditate.
(Genesis 24:63)

Meditation is the Sunday of the mind. A Sunday is a time in which it will do no work but instead will simply be still, look heavenward, and spread itself before the Lord like Gideon's fleece, allowing itself to be soaked with the moisture of the dew of heaven, and plan nothing but simply lie on the green lap of nature and "rest a while" (Mark 6:31 KJV).

Time spent in this way is not lost time. A fisherman does not say he is losing time when he is mending his nets, nor does a gardener feel he has wasted his time by taking a few minutes to sharpen the blades on his mower. And people living in cities today would do well to follow the example of Isaac and as often as possible visit the fields of the countryside, away from the hustle and bustle of the city. After having grown weary from the heat and noise of the city, communion with nature is very refreshing and will bring a calming, healing influence. A walk through a field, a stroll by a seashore, or a hike across a meadow sprinkled with daisies will purge you of the impurities of life and will cause your heart to beat with new joy and hope.

December 25

"They will call him Immanuel" —which means, "God with us." (Matthew 1:23)

Prince of Peace. (Isaiah 9:6)

A minister falling asleep in his study on Christmas morning and then dreaming of a world into which Jesus had never come. And when he came back and sat down in his library, he realized that every book about our Savior had disappeared. A messenger asked him to visit a friend's poor dying mother. He opened his Bible to look for a familiar promise, but it ended with Malachi. There was no gospel and no promise of hope and salvation.

Two days later he stood beside her coffin and conducted her funeral service, but there was no message of comfort, no words of a glorious resurrection, and no thought of a mansion awaiting her in heaven. There was only "dust to dust, and ashes to ashes," and one long, eternal farewell. Finally he realized that Christ had not come, and burst into tears, weeping bitterly in his sorrowful dream.

「天将晚，艾萨克出来在田间默想。」(创24:63)

默想是我们思想的星期日。这个时间是不用工作，只是静止不动，往上仰望，在主面前像基甸的羊毛般摊放着，让它泡满天上的露水，只要单单卧在大自然的青草地上「歇一歇」(可6:31)。

这样的使用时间不是浪费。渔夫不会说补网是浪费时间，园丁不会觉得花几分钟来磨利剪草机的刀叶是浪费时间。今时今日活在城市中的人若能学效艾萨克的榜样，尽量抽时间到田间，远离城市的挤逼和喧闹是好的。经过城市的热哄而变得疲累时，亲一亲大自然是使人十分苏醒，也会带来宁静和医治效果的。在田间走动，在海滨流连，或是在满布雏菊的草原远足，会洗清生命的杂质，使你心跳动着新的喜乐和盼望。

十二月二十五日

「人要称祂的名为以马内利。(以马内利翻出来，就是神与我们同在。)」(太1:23)

「和平的君。」(赛9:6)

有一传道者在他圣诞节早晨的讲台上睡着了，之后梦到耶稣未曾来过的世界。当他回家坐在藏书室，发现所有关于基督的书都失踪。有传讯人求他去探望一个朋友将亡的可怜母亲。他打开圣经来找寻一个熟悉的应许，但这圣经在玛拉基书便完结了，没有福音书，没有盼望和救恩的应许。

两日后他站在棺木旁主持她的殡葬仪式，但当中没有安慰的信息，没有荣耀复活的说话，没有天上等待她去的住处。只有「尘归尘，土归土」和一长长的永别。最后他知悉基督没有来过，便号咷大哭，在他难过的梦中苦苦哭泣。

Then suddenly he awoke with a start, and a great shout of joy and praise burst from his lips as he heard his choir singing these words in his church nearby:

Let us be glad and rejoice today, because He has come. And let us remember the proclamation of the angel: "I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all the people. Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is Christ the Lord" (Luke 2:10-11).

December 26

Sit here while I go over there and pray. (Matthew 26:36)

In the Garden of Gethsemane, eight of the eleven remaining disciples were left behind to do nothing.

You and I have certainly had that experience and felt the same disappointment. Perhaps you have seen a great opportunity for Christian service arise, and some people are sent immediately to the work, while still others are being trained to go. Yet you are forced to do nothing but sit and wait. Or perhaps sickness and poverty has come your way, or you have had to endure some terrible disgrace. Whatever your situation, you have been kept from service, and now you feel angry and do not understand why you should be excluded from this part of the Christian life.

Remember, it is Christ himself who says to you, "Sit here." Your place in the garden has also been set apart. God has selected it especially for you, and it is not simply a place of waiting. There are some lives He brings into this world neither to do great work nor to bear great burdens. Their job is simply to be—they are the neuter verbs, or the flowers in the garden that have no active mission. They have won no major victories and have never been honored with the best seats at a banquet—they have simply escaped the sight of people like Peter, James, and John.

However, Jesus is delighted by the sight of them, for through their mere fragrance and beauty, they have brought Him joy.

selected

December 27

His neck was put in irons. (Psalm 105:18)

The irons of sorrow and loss, the burdens carried as a youth, and the soul's struggle against sin all

之后，他突然被邻近教堂诗班的歌声惊醒，便冲口而出高呼欢欣和赞美：

让我们今天就喜乐欢欣吧，因为祂已来到，也让我们谨记天使的宣布：「我报给你们大喜的讯息，是关乎万民的。因今天在大卫的城里，为你们生了救主，就是主基督。」（路2:10-11）

十二月二十六日

「你们坐在这里，等我到那边去祷告。」（太26:36）

在客西马尼园中，十一个门徒中有八个留下无所事事。

你和我也肯定曾经历过和感受过相同的失望。或者你见到一个大好服事基督的职事来到，有一些人立即被派去工作，而有人仍在接受训练中，而你却只是强逼坐下等待，一事也不能作。又或者疾病和穷困在你路上拦阻，又或者你必须忍受一些凌厉的耻辱。无论你在甚么处境，你不能事奉，如今你感到愤怒，不明为何你被排拒于这基督徒生命的分儿外。

谨记是基督亲自对你说「坐在这里」的。你在园子的位置已被设置，这是神特特为你所拣选的，这不只是一个等待的地方。有一些祂带进这世界的生命既不是作大事，也不是担负大痛苦的，他们的工作就是简单作他们的不及物动词，或是作园中没有积极行动的花儿。他们未曾赢取主要的胜利，未曾争取到筵席上的首席，他们只是在值得注目之彼得、雅各布和约翰以外的人。

但是，耶稣却喜悦见到他们，因为他们藉着香气和美丽将喜乐带给祂。

选

十二月二十七日

「他被铁链捆绑。」（诗105:18）

忧伤和损失的铁链，少年时背负的重担，和与罪搏斗全都促成铁

contribute to developing an iron tenacity and strength of purpose, as well as endurance and fortitude.

God is looking for iron saints, and since there is no way to impart iron into His people's moral nature except by letting them suffer, He allows them to suffer.

Your time is not wasted, for God is simply putting you through His iron regimen. Your iron crown of suffering precedes your golden crown of glory, and iron is entering your soul to make it strong and brave.

F. B. Meyer

December 28

Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! (Philippians 4:4)

And when He hears you sing, He will bend down with a smile on His kind face. As He cheerfully listens, He will say, "Sing on, dear child. I hear you and I am coming to deliver you. I will carry that load for you. So just lean hard on Me, and the road will get smoother by and by."

December 29

Come on ... ! We have seen that the land is very good. Aren't you going to do something? Don't hesitate to go there and take it over....God has put into your hands, a land that lacks nothing whatever. (Judges 18:9-10)

"Come on!" "The children of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, took their inheritance" (Josh. 16:4 KJV). "The house of Jacob will possess its inheritance" (Obad. 17). "The upright shall have good things in possession" (Prov. 28:10 KJV).

Appropriating faith is taking a pencil and underlining every 'me,' 'my,' and 'mine' in the Bible."

Pick any word you want that He has spoken and say, "That word is my word." Put your finger on a promise and say, "It is mine." "My son, ... you are always with me, and everything I have is yours" (Luke 15:31).

December 30

So Peter was kept in prison, but the church was earnestly praying to God for him. (Acts 12:5)

So the church gave themselves to fervent and persistent prayer. And God sent an angel, who "struck Peter on the side and woke him up" (v.7).

的顽强和决心的力度，也促成忍耐力和刚毅。

神是寻找铁的圣徒，没有方法可以将铁注入祂子民的属灵品格中，除非让他们受苦，是祂容许他们受苦的。

你的时间没浪费，因神只是把你放进祂铁的政权中。你受苦的铁冠冕在你荣耀金冠冕之先，铁进入你的灵魂来使你强壮和勇敢。

迈尔

十二月二十八日

「你们要靠主常常喜乐。我再说：你们要喜乐。」(腓4:4)

当祂听到你的歌声时，祂会以慈爱脸上的微笑来俯听。当祂欢欣聆听时，必会说：「亲爱的孩子，继续唱，我听见你，我来拯救你。我必替你背负那重担，因此只要紧紧靠着我，前路必会越来越平顺。」

十二月二十九日

「起来.....我们已经窥探那地，见那地甚好。你们为何静坐不动呢？要急速前往得那地为业，.....神已将那地交在你们手中。那地百物俱全，一无所缺。」(士18:9-10)

「起来！」「约瑟的儿子玛拿西、以法莲就得了他们的地业。」(书16:4)「雅各布家必得原有的产业。」(俄17)「惟有完全人，必承受福分。」(箴28:10)

取用信就是用铅笔间低圣经的每个「我」和「我的」。

选拣你想要而又是祂曾说过的字来说：「这个属我。」指着一个应许说：「这个属我。」「儿阿，你常和我同在，我一切所有的，都是你的。」(路15:31)

十二月三十日

「于是彼得被囚在监里。教会却为他切切的祷告神。」(徒12:5)

神便差派一个天使，「拍彼得的肋旁，拍醒了他」(徒12:7)。之后天使领他「过了第一层，第二

Then the angel led him past “the first and second guards and [they] came to the iron gate leading to the city. It opened for them by itself” (v. 10). There is a secret for you to learn—the secret of believing prayer. Then when you come to the iron gate, it will open.

How much wasted energy and painful disappointment will be saved once you learn to pray as the early church did in the “upper room” (Acts 1:13 KJV)!

C. H. P.

Emergencies call for intense prayer. When the person himself becomes the prayer nothing can resist its touch, and was aligned with Him against the powers of evil. This kind of prayer is greatly needed today.

from The Bent-knee Time

“Groans that words cannot express” (Rom. 8:26) are often prayers that God cannot refuse.

Charles H. Spurgeon

December 31

Thus far has the Lord helped us. (1 Samuel 7:12)

“Be strong and take heart” (Ps. 27:14), and with thanksgiving and confidence lift your voice in praise, for: The Lord who “thus far” has helped you Will help you all your journey through.

Charles H. Spurgeon

Let us also call out to one another through the darkness until the night becomes alive with the sound of many voices, encouraging God’s weary travelers. And may the echoes grow into a storm of hallelujahs that will break in thundering waves around His sapphire throne. Then as the morning dawns, we will find ourselves on the shore of the “sea of glass” (Rev. 4:6), crying out with the redeemed hosts of heaven, “To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be praise and honor and glory and power, for ever and ever!” (Rev. 5:13).

AND AGAIN THEY SHOUTED: “HALLELUJAH!”
Revelation 19:3

层监牢，就来到临街的铁门。那门自己开了。」（徒12:10）你有一要学的秘诀——信靠祷告的诀窍，那么，当你来到铁门时，它会「自己开了」。

你一旦学会了初期教会在「楼房」上的祷告（徒1:13），便省却多少浪费的精力和痛苦的失望！

C.H.P.

危急事故需求迫切的祷告。当当事人成为祷告者时，便没有东西能阻止其与神接触，与神站在同一对抗邪恶势力的阵在线，这也是今时今日极之需要的祈祷。

摘自《屈膝时刻》

「说不出的叹息」（罗8:26）常是神不能拒绝的祈祷。

司布真

十二月三十一日

「到如今耶和华都帮助我们。」（撒上7:12）

「当壮胆，坚固祢的心。」（诗27:14）用感恩和信心来高声赞美，因为那位「到如今」的主曾帮助你，必会一路上帮助你。

司布真

让我们在黑暗中彼此叫唤名字，直至多人的声音使这夜回复生机，鼓励着疲乏的神之旅者。让这唱和演变成阿利路亚的爆发，发出雷声般的声浪来环绕着祂蓝宝石的宝座。之后到朝早黎明时，我们必发现我们来到「玻璃海」（启4:6）的岸边，与天上被救赎的群众一起高呼：「但愿颂赞、尊贵、荣耀、权势，都归给坐宝座的和羔羊，直到永永远远。」（启5:13）

他们再次高呼：「阿利路亚。」（启19:3）

Streams in the Desert 2

荒漠甘泉下

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非拉铁非书简 (Books of Philadelphia) 14B 《荒漠甘泉》下

因方便印刷，本书分为上下二册。

信主初期，教会兄姊都鼓励以本书作为灵修辅助读物。这确实是不可多得的属灵宝藏，作者阅读众多属灵书籍，将感动她的结集成书。

信主多年，才懂得某些真理，才感受到作者灵命之深。坊间已有本书的不同译本，惟望神也用上本书，叫读者们一同沾上前人的信心。

「人因为先知的名接待先知，必得先知所得的赏赐；人因为义人的名接待义人，必得义人所得的赏赐。」(太10:41) 这给我们读属灵书籍的亮光。属灵人得神的话，便是先知。听他们的话就是听神的话，世上肯听先知的少之又少。听后要「接待」，留在生命中。让神的话发光发力，认罪除黑暗，得力奔天路，与先知同等赏赐，这是「上算」。以属灵人为义人，一同走义路，得本于信以至于信，丰盛生命的赏赐。

在这荒漠中真需要神供给的甘泉，若神许可，还有别的灵修辅助读物会跟大家分享。

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